

# **Materials Science Study Guide**

A Learning Companion for University Students

Chapters 1–11 · Structures, Defects, Phase Diagrams & Mechanical Behavior

For learning and self-study. All figures drawn by the author.

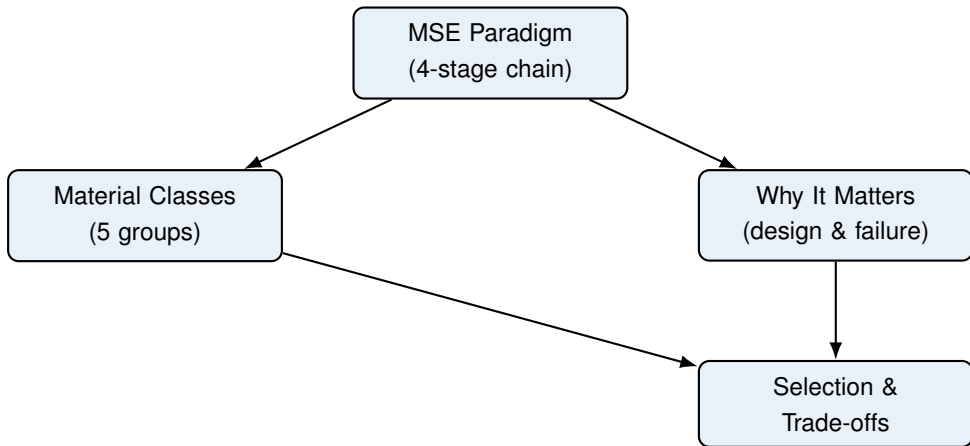
# Contents

|           |                                                    |            |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>1</b>  | <b>Introduction &amp; the MSE Paradigm</b>         | <b>3</b>   |
| <b>2</b>  | <b>Atomic Structure and Interatomic Bonding</b>    | <b>12</b>  |
| <b>3</b>  | <b>The Structure of Crystalline Solids</b>         | <b>24</b>  |
| <b>4</b>  | <b>Imperfections in Solids</b>                     | <b>35</b>  |
| <b>5</b>  | <b>Diffusion</b>                                   | <b>49</b>  |
| <b>6</b>  | <b>Mechanical Properties of Metals</b>             | <b>62</b>  |
| <b>7</b>  | <b>Dislocations and Strengthening Mechanisms</b>   | <b>74</b>  |
| <b>8</b>  | <b>Phase Diagrams</b>                              | <b>87</b>  |
| <b>9</b>  | <b>Phase Transformations</b>                       | <b>101</b> |
| <b>10</b> | <b>Applications and Processing of Metal Alloys</b> | <b>115</b> |
| <b>11</b> | <b>Structures and Properties of Ceramics</b>       | <b>128</b> |
| <b>A</b>  | <b>Master Formula Index</b>                        | <b>142</b> |
| <b>B</b>  | <b>Answer Key</b>                                  | <b>144</b> |

# Chapter 1

## Introduction & the MSE Paradigm

### 1. Roadmap



This chapter builds the foundation: the framework that links *processing* to *performance*, the five material families, and why this knowledge prevents engineering disasters.

### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **State and trace** the MSE paradigm: processing → structure → properties → performance.
2. **Classify** any engineering material into the five families and justify a choice for a given application.
3. **Compute** theoretical density from unit-cell data (preview of Ch 3).
4. **Explain** why materials failures (Liberty ships, bridges) motivate the field.

### 3. Why This Matters

Materials selection decides cost, safety, and performance of every product. Roughly every major engineering disaster (Liberty ships, Silver Bridge, Challenger O-rings) was fundamentally a *materials* failure. Roughly 10–15% of exam

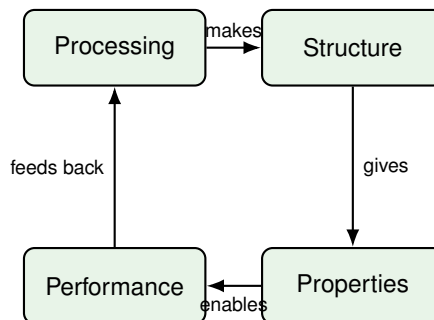
points test classification and the MSE chain directly, and they underpin every later chapter.

## 4. Intuition First

### Intuition First

Think of a material like a recipe. *Processing* is how you cook it; *structure* is the microscopic arrangement of ingredients (crumbs, layers, bubbles); *properties* are what you can measure (crispy, soft, strong); *performance* is whether it satisfies the eater. Change the cooking, and you change the crumb structure, which changes the crispiness. You can never change a property without first changing the structure.

## 5. Visual



**Figure 1.1.** Figure 1.1 — The Materials Science & Engineering paradigm: a closed loop from processing to performance.

### The MSE Paradigm

Four linked stages: **processing** creates a **structure**; structure determines **properties**; properties enable **performance** in service. The chain also runs backward as a feedback loop.

**Structure across length scales.** Structure is studied at nested scales: sub-atomic (electrons/bonds) → atomic (crystal lattice) → microscopic (grains, phases) → macroscopic (components). A change at any scale propagates outward.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **MSE chain:** Processing → Structure → Properties → Performance.
- **5 families:** Metals, Ceramics, Polymers, Composites, Advanced materials.
- **Metals:** electron-sea bonding → conductive, ductile, stiff.
- **Ceramics:** ionic/covalent → hard, brittle, insulating, high  $T_m$ .
- **Polymers:** covalent chains → light, flexible, low  $T_{max}$ .
- **Composites:**  $\geq 2$  phases → tailored, anisotropic.
- **Advanced:** semiconductors, biomaterials, nanomaterials, smart materials.

## 7. Compare Box

### Metals vs Ceramics vs Polymers

| Metals            | Ceramics             | Polymers              |
|-------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Electron-sea bond | Ionic/covalent bond  | Covalent chains       |
| Conductive        | Insulating           | Insulating            |
| Ductile           | Brittle              | Flexible/viscoelastic |
| High $T_m$        | Very high $T_m$      | Low $T_{max}$         |
| e.g. steel, Al    | e.g. $Al_2O_3$ , SiC | e.g. PE, nylon        |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **“Processing changes properties directly.” Why wrong:** it acts *through* structure; the intermediate step is what you are tested on.
- **Calling a composite an alloy. Why wrong:** an alloy is a single-phase solid solution of metals; a composite mixes *distinct* phases (e.g. CFRP = carbon fiber + polymer).
- **Assuming all ceramics insulate electricity. Why wrong:** some are ionic conductors or semiconductors ( $\text{ZrO}_2$ , SiC).
- **Confusing “advanced” with “stronger.” Why wrong:** advanced means a *special function* (e.g. semiconductors), not necessarily higher strength.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                            | Meaning                       | Units           | Variables                                                               | Assump-<br>tions          | Limitations               | Eng.<br>meaning               |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------|
| $\rho = \frac{nA}{V_c N_A}$        | Theoretical density from cell | $\text{g/cm}^3$ | n atoms/cell, A at. wt (g/mol), $V_c$ cell vol ( $\text{cm}^3$ ), $N_A$ | Perfect crystal, no voids | Ignores defects/-porosity | Screening mass-critical parts |
| $\rho = \frac{\sum m_i}{\sum V_i}$ | Bulk/-measured density        | $\text{g/cm}^3$ | measured mass, volume                                                   | Homogeneous sample        | Needs accurate volume     | Quality/void check            |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Example

**Problem:** Which material family fits a part needing high electrical conductivity, moderate strength, and ductility?

**Thinking:** Conductivity + ductility points to the electron-sea bond.

**Solution:** A **metal** (e.g. copper or aluminum). Ceramics/polymers insulate; composites are not intrinsically conductive.

## Intermediate

### Example

**Problem:** A bicycle frame needs high strength-to-weight, moderate stiffness, low cost. Choose among: alumina ceramic, 6061 aluminum, nylon, tool steel.

**Thinking:** Rank by  $\sigma/\rho$  and service temperature. Ceramic is brittle (rotating load  $\rightarrow$  catastrophic); nylon too weak/soft; tool steel too heavy.

**Solution:** **6061 aluminum alloy** — good specific strength, stiff enough, low cost.

## Advanced

### Example

**Problem:** Copper has  $n = 4$  atoms/cell,  $A = 63.55$  g/mol, FCC with  $a = 0.3615$  nm. Compute theoretical  $\rho$ .

**Thinking:**  $V_c = a^3$ ; convert  $\text{nm}^3 \rightarrow \text{cm}^3$ .

**Solution:**

$$V_c = (0.3615 \times 10^{-7} \text{ cm})^3 = 4.724 \times 10^{-23} \text{ cm}^3$$

$$\rho = \frac{4(63.55)}{(4.724 \times 10^{-23})(6.022 \times 10^{23})} = \frac{254.2}{28.45} = 8.94 \text{ g/cm}^3$$

Matches the handbook value (8.96), confirming an FCC assignment.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

The paradigm is a *design tool*, not just theory. To improve a part you choose the lever:

- Want higher strength? Change **structure** via processing (grain refinement, alloying, heat treatment).
- Want a new function? Design a **new structure** (nanocomposite, metamaterial).

Reverse-engineering a competitor's part means reading its microstructure to infer its processing history.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Aerospace:** Ti–6Al–4V fan blades (light + creep-resistant at 500°C).
- **Electronics:** silicon (advanced/semiconductor) enables all ICs.
- **Transport:** CFRP in Boeing 787 cuts mass ~ 20% vs aluminum.
- **Medicine:** Ti and Co–Cr biomaterials for implants (biocompatible).

## 13. Summary

Materials are classified into five families whose properties follow from bonding and structure. The MSE paradigm — Processing → Structure → Properties → Performance — is the lens for every design and failure question. The single most useful equation here is  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$ , which links atomic structure to a measurable bulk property.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. The fourth stage of the MSE paradigm, after properties, is \_\_\_\_\_.
2. Name the five material families: \_\_\_\_\_.
3. True / False: An alloy is a type of composite. \_\_\_\_\_
4. A material with ionic bonds, high hardness, and brittleness is a \_\_\_\_\_.
5. CFRP stands for \_\_\_\_\_.

## 15. Practice Problems

- ★ Which is **not** a primary classification of engineering materials?
- (a) Metals
  - (b) Ceramics
  - (c) Semiconductors



(d) Polymers

(p. 144)

★ In the MSE paradigm, which stage directly determines properties?

- (a) Processing
- (b) Structure
- (c) Performance
- (d) Cost

(p. 144)

★★ A jet-engine turbine blade needs high strength at 900°C and creep resistance. Best choice?

- (a) Nylon
- (b) Alumina
- (c) Nickel superalloy
- (d) Aluminum 6061

(p. 144)

★★ Carbon-fiber-reinforced polymer (CFRP) is an example of:

- (a) A metal-matrix composite
- (b) A polymer-matrix composite
- (c) A ceramic-matrix composite
- (d) A metal alloy

(p. 144)

★★★ For an unknown metal,  $n = 2$  atoms/cell,  $A = 55.85$  g/mol,  $a = 0.2866$  nm (BCC). Compute theoretical density and name the likely metal. (p. 144)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does the MSE paradigm say about changing a property?

**Back:** You must change the *structure* (via processing); properties follow structure.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Name the 5 material families.

---

**Back:** Metals, Ceramics, Polymers, Composites, Advanced materials.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Alloy vs composite?

---

**Back:** Alloy = single-phase metal solid solution; composite =  $\geq 2$  distinct phases (e.g. CFRP).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why are ceramics brittle?

---

**Back:** Ionic/covalent bonds are directional and lack slip systems; cracks propagate easily.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Formula for theoretical density?

---

**Back:**  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What made Liberty ships fail?

---

**Back:** Ductile-to-brittle transition of steel below  $\sim 10^\circ\text{C}$  + weld flaws  $\rightarrow$  brittle fracture.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

### Cheat Sheet

**MSE chain:** Processing  $\rightarrow$  Structure  $\rightarrow$  Properties  $\rightarrow$  Performance.

**Families & bonding:**

- Metals — electron sea: conductive, ductile.
- Ceramics — ionic/covalent: hard, brittle, insulator.
- Polymers — covalent chains: light, flexible, low  $T_{\max}$ .
- Composites —  $\geq 2$  phases: tailored, anisotropic.
- Advanced — semiconductors, biomaterials, nano, smart.

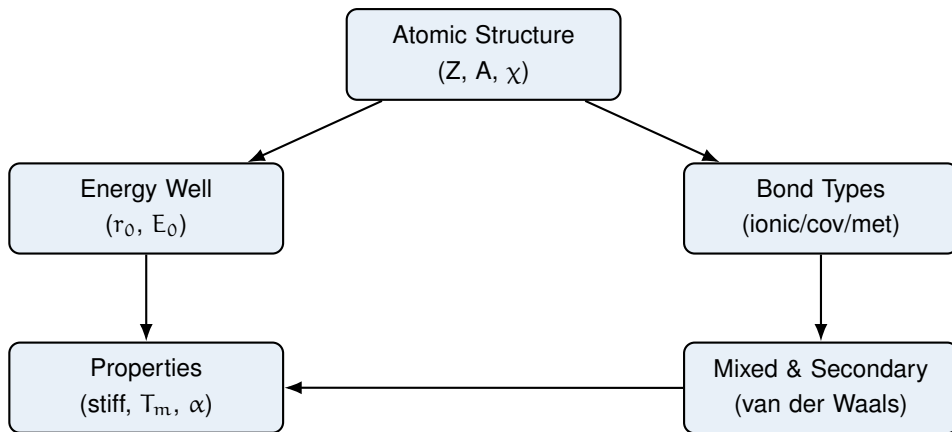
**Density:**  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$  (g/cm<sup>3</sup>).

**Failure lesson:** most disasters are materials failures.

# Chapter 2

## Atomic Structure and Interatomic Bonding

### 1. Roadmap



This chapter connects the atom (number of protons, mass, electronegativity) to the energy well that forms between atoms, then to the three primary bond types, mixed/secondary bonding, and finally to the bulk properties engineers actually measure.

### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Define** the key atomic parameters  $Z$ ,  $A$ ,  $N_A$ , and electronegativity  $\chi$ .
2. **Predict** the dominant bond type from the Pauling electronegativity difference  $\Delta\chi$ .
3. **Sketch** the interatomic energy–separation curve and label  $r_0$ ,  $E_0$ , and the properties derived from it.
4. **Contrast** ionic, covalent, metallic, and secondary bonds by mechanism and property signature.
5. **Estimate** ionic character from  $\Delta\chi$  using Pauling’s exponential relation.
6. **Compute** theoretical density  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$  from atomic structure.

### 3. Why This Matters

Bonding is the root cause of every mechanical, thermal, and electrical property you will study for the rest of the course. Roughly 10–15% of exam points test bond-type prediction and the energy-well interpretation directly, and these ideas feed crystal structure, defects, phase diagrams, and mechanical behavior. In engineering, the choice between a covalent ceramic cutting tool, a metallic wire, and a polymeric gasket is decided entirely by what holds the atoms together.

### 4. Intuition First

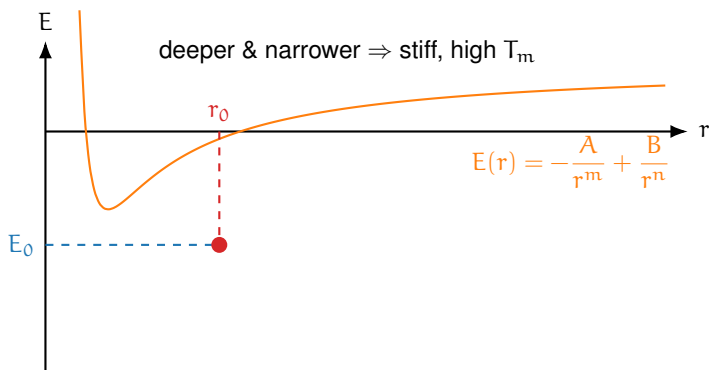
#### Intuition First

Imagine two magnets floating near each other. Pull them together and they snap, push them too close and they shove back. Atoms behave the same way: an attractive pull (opposite charges) and a repulsive push (crowded electron clouds) compete. At one special distance they settle into a stable hug, the *equilibrium spacing*  $r_0$ . The depth of that hug is the *bond energy*  $E_0$  — how hard you must pull to tear the atoms apart. A deep, narrow hug means a stiff, high-melting material; a loose, wide one means something soft that melts easily.

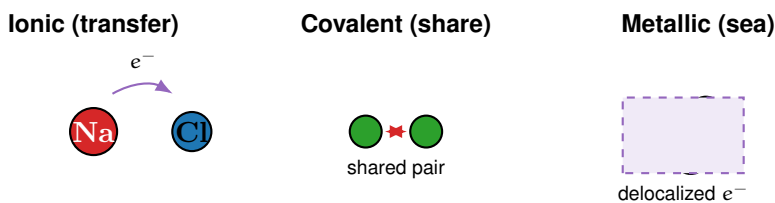
Now picture *how* the hug forms. One atom can **hand over** an electron (ionic), **share** one (covalent), or throw all valence electrons into a common **sea** everyone swims in (metallic). The hand-over and share are directional and rigid; the sea lets atoms slide past each other, which is why metals bend instead of shattering.

### 5. Visual

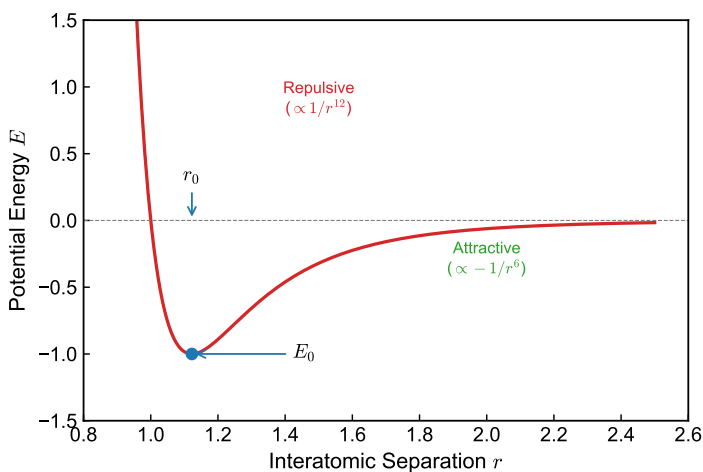
(one figure per key concept)



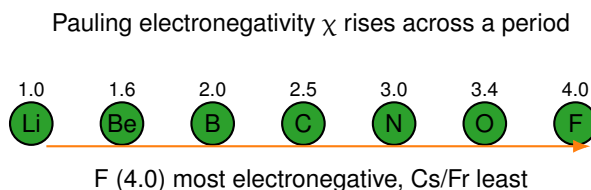
**Figure 2.1.** Figure 2.1 — The interatomic energy–separation curve. Attraction ( $-A/r^m$ ) and repulsion ( $+B/r^n$ ) sum to a well with minimum at  $(r_0, E_0)$ .



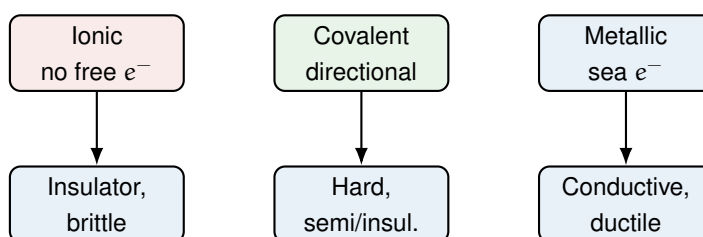
**Figure 2.2.** Figure 2.2 — Three primary bonding mechanisms: electron transfer (ionic), electron sharing (covalent), and a shared electron sea (metallic).



**Figure 2.3.** Figure 2.3 — The Lennard-Jones interatomic potential: net energy (orange) is the sum of attractive ( $-1/r^6$ , green) and repulsive ( $+1/r^{12}$ , red) terms, with minimum at  $(r_0, E_0)$ .



**Figure 2.4.** Figure 2.3 — Pauling electronegativity increases left-to-right across a period and decreases down a group; the gap  $\Delta\chi$  decides bond type.



**Figure 2.5.** Figure 2.4 — Bond mechanism (top) maps directly to the property signature engineers select on (bottom).

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **Atomic number  $Z$ :** number of protons (defines element).
- **Atomic mass  $A$ :** g/mol; charge number  $Z$  of protons.
- **Avogadro  $N_A$ :**  $6.022 \times 10^{23}$  atoms/mol.
- **Electronegativity  $\chi$ :** Pauling pull on bonding electrons.
- **Bond-rule thresholds:**  $\Delta\chi > 1.7$  ionic; 0.4–1.7 polar covalent;  $< 0.4$  nonpolar covalent/metallic.
- $r_0$ : equilibrium spacing;  $E_0$ : bond energy at  $r_0$ .
- **Well depth**  $\propto |E_0| \rightarrow$  melting point; **curvature at  $r_0$**   $\rightarrow$  elastic modulus; **asymmetry**  $\rightarrow$  thermal expansion.
- **Primary bonds:** 100–1000 kJ/mol; **secondary:** 0.1–40 kJ/mol.

## 7. Compare Box

| Ionic vs Covalent vs Metallic vs Secondary                         |                                                                  |                                                      |                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ionic                                                              | Covalent                                                         | Metallic                                             | Secondary                                                  |
| Electron transfer<br>Non-directional                               | Electron sharing<br>Highly directional                           | Delocalized sea<br>Non-directional                   | Dipole attraction<br>Non-directional                       |
| Insulator (solid)<br>Hard, brittle<br>NaCl, MgO<br>100–1500 kJ/mol | Insulator/semicon.<br>Very hard<br>diamond, Si<br>300–800 kJ/mol | Conductor<br>Ductile<br>Fe, Cu, Al<br>100–800 kJ/mol | Insulator<br>Weak, soft<br>H-bond, London<br>0.1–40 kJ/mol |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **“Ionic compounds conduct electricity as solids.” Why wrong:** the ions are locked in the lattice; conduction only occurs when molten or dissolved in water.
- **Confusing bond energy with elastic modulus. Why wrong:** both come from the  $E(r)$  well, but modulus is the *curvature* at  $r_0$ , not the well depth  $E_0$ .
- **Forgetting metallic bonding still “shares” electrons. Why wrong:** only the electrons are delocalized into a sea; the attraction is still Coulombic.
- **Using  $\Delta\chi$  alone to call a ceramic “purely ionic.” Why wrong:** most ceramics are mixed ionic–covalent; use  $F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(\Delta\chi/2)^2}$  for the actual fraction.



## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                        | Meaning                   | Units           | Variables                                              | Assump-<br>tions               | Limitations                         | Eng.<br>meaning                   |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| $E_N = -\frac{A}{r^m} + \frac{B}{r^n}$         | Net interatomic potential | J or eV         | A, B constants;<br>$m \approx 1$ ,<br>$n \approx 6-12$ | Pair potential, isolated atoms | No many-body/ environmental effects | Shape of the well sets properties |
| $r_0 = \sqrt[m-n]{\frac{nB}{mA}}$              | Equilibrium separation    | m or nm         | from $dE_N/dr = 0$                                     | Same as above                  | No temperature, no defects          | Atomic spacing in a solid         |
| $F = -k_0 \frac{(Z_1 e)(Z_2 e)}{r^2}$          | Coulombic attraction      | N               | $k_0$ const, Z valence, e charge                       | Point charges, vacuum          | Screened in real solids             | Source of bond strength           |
| $F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(\Delta\chi/2)^2}$ | Ionic character fraction  | –               | $\Delta\chi$ Pauling gap                               | Pauling approximation          | Empirical only                      | Predicts ceramic behavior         |
| $\rho = \frac{nA}{V_c N_A}$                    | Theoretical density       | $\text{g/cm}^3$ | n atoms/cell, A at. wt, $V_c$ cell vol                 | Perfect crystal, no voids      | Ignores defects/- porosity          | Mass screening of parts           |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Example

**Problem:** For Na ( $\chi = 0.93$ ) and Cl ( $\chi = 3.16$ ), predict the dominant bond type.

**Thinking:** Compare  $\Delta\chi$  to the thresholds in the memory box.

**Solution:**

$$\Delta\chi = 3.16 - 0.93 = 2.23$$

$$\Delta\chi > 1.7 \Rightarrow \text{ionic bond (NaCl)}.$$

## Intermediate

## Example

**Problem:** MgO:  $\chi_{\text{Mg}} = 1.31$ ,  $\chi_{\text{O}} = 3.44$ . Find the ionic-character fraction.

**Thinking:** Use Pauling's relation, then read the property signature.

**Solution:**

$$\Delta\chi = 3.44 - 1.31 = 2.13$$

$$F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(2.13/2)^2} = 1 - e^{-1.134} = 1 - 0.322 = 0.678 \approx 68\%.$$

MgO is strongly ionic (hard, high- $T_m$  insulator) — consistent with the 63–67% table values.

## Advanced

## Example

**Problem:** Copper is FCC:  $n = 4$  atoms/cell,  $A = 63.55$  g/mol,  $a = 0.3615$  nm. Compute theoretical  $\rho$ .

**Thinking:**  $V_c = a^3$ ; convert  $\text{nm}^3$  to  $\text{cm}^3$  using  $(10^{-7} \text{ cm/nm})^3$ .

**Solution:**

$$V_c = (0.3615 \times 10^{-7} \text{ cm})^3 = 4.724 \times 10^{-23} \text{ cm}^3$$

$$\begin{aligned} \rho &= \frac{nA}{V_c N_A} = \frac{4(63.55)}{(4.724 \times 10^{-23})(6.022 \times 10^{23})} \\ &= \frac{254.2}{28.45} = 8.94 \text{ g/cm}^3. \end{aligned}$$

Matches the handbook value ( $8.96 \text{ g/cm}^3$ ), confirming FCC and the metallic bond's close packing.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Bonding is the first lever in material selection. To raise stiffness or melting point you need deeper wells (stronger bonds) — which is why cutting tools use covalent diamond or ionic  $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$  rather than metals. To get formability you need non-directional bonding, so you pick a metal. Thermal-expansion mismatch between a covalent ceramic and a metallic lead frame cracks electronics packages; understanding the well's asymmetry explains *why* ceramics expand less. Mixed ionic-covalent character also controls dielectric constant and corrosion resistance in ceramics.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Cutting tools:** covalent diamond / cubic-BN or ionic-covalent  $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$ , SiC for extreme hardness.
- **Electrical wiring:** metallic Cu, Al (ductile + conductive).
- **Thermal barrier coatings:** ionic  $\text{ZrO}_2$  / YSZ (low  $k$ , high  $T_m$ ).
- **Transparent windows:** ionic sapphire ( $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$  single crystal, optical + refractory).
- **Semiconductors:** covalent Si, GaAs (band gap tuned by doping).
- **Polymer chains & water:** secondary H-bonds set  $T_g$  and boiling point.

## 13. Summary

Atoms attract and repel to form an energy well with equilibrium spacing  $r_0$  and bond energy  $E_0$ ; the well shape dictates stiffness, melting point, and thermal expansion. The three primary bonds — ionic (transfer), covalent (share), metallic (sea) — give distinct property signatures, while secondary van der Waals and hydrogen bonds dominate polymers and water. Most real ceramics are mixed ionic-covalent, with ionic character set by the Pauling gap  $\Delta\chi$ . The single most useful equation this chapter is  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$ , linking atomic structure to a measurable bulk property.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. The bond-energy minimum occurs at separation \_\_\_\_\_.
2. The elastic modulus comes from the \_\_\_\_\_ of the  $E(r)$  well at  $r_0$ .
3. True / False: A larger  $\Delta\chi$  means a more ionic bond. \_\_\_\_\_
4. A ductile, conductive material is held by \_\_\_\_\_ bonds.
5. Pauling's ionic fraction:  $F_{\text{ionic}} = \text{_____}$ .

## 15. Practice Problems

★ Which bond type is characterized by directionality and very high stiffness?

- (a) Ionic
- (b) Covalent
- (c) Metallic
- (d) Secondary

(p. 144)

★ Given  $\chi_{\text{Na}} = 0.93$  and  $\chi_{\text{Cl}} = 3.16$ , the Na–Cl bond is:

- (a) Ionic
- (b) Covalent
- (c) Metallic
- (d) Secondary

(p. 144)

★★ Which material property is determined by the *curvature* of the  $E(r)$  well at  $r_0$ ?

- (a) Elastic modulus
- (b) Melting point
- (c) Thermal expansion
- (d) Conductivity

(p. 144)

★★ A material with very high melting point, no electrical conductivity, and brittle fracture is most likely bonded by:

- (a) Metallic
- (b) Ionic
- (c) Secondary
- (d) Hydrogen

(p. 144)

★★★ Copper is ductile because its bonding is:

- (a) Non-directional (metallic)
- (b) Directional covalent
- (c) Ionic with repulsion
- (d) Secondary only

(p. 144)

★★★ For SiC,  $\chi_{\text{Si}} = 1.90$ ,  $\chi_{\text{C}} = 2.55$ . Compute  $\Delta\chi$  and the ionic-character fraction, then name the dominant bond character. (p. 144)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does a deep, narrow energy well imply?

**Back:** Stiff material (high modulus) and high melting point.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Threshold  $\Delta\chi$  for an ionic bond?

**Back:**  $\Delta\chi > 1.7$  is predominantly ionic.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why are metals ductile?

---

**Back:** Non-directional metallic (electron-sea) bonds let atoms slide without breaking.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Modulus vs bond energy from the well?

---

**Back:** Modulus = curvature at  $r_0$ ; bond energy = well depth  $E_0$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Pauling ionic-character formula?

---

**Back:**  $F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(\Delta\chi/2)^2}$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Theoretical density formula?

---

**Back:**  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A) \text{ g/cm}^3$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why do ionic solids not conduct?

---

**Back:** Ions are fixed in the lattice; only molten/dissolved ions carry current.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

### Cheat Sheet

**Bond-rule:**  $\Delta\chi > 1.7$  ionic; 0.4–1.7 polar cov.;  $< 0.4$  nonpolar cov./metallic.

**Well:**  $r_0$  = spacing,  $E_0$  = bond energy; depth  $\rightarrow T_m$ , curvature  $\rightarrow E$ , asymmetry  $\rightarrow \alpha$ .

**Bonds:**

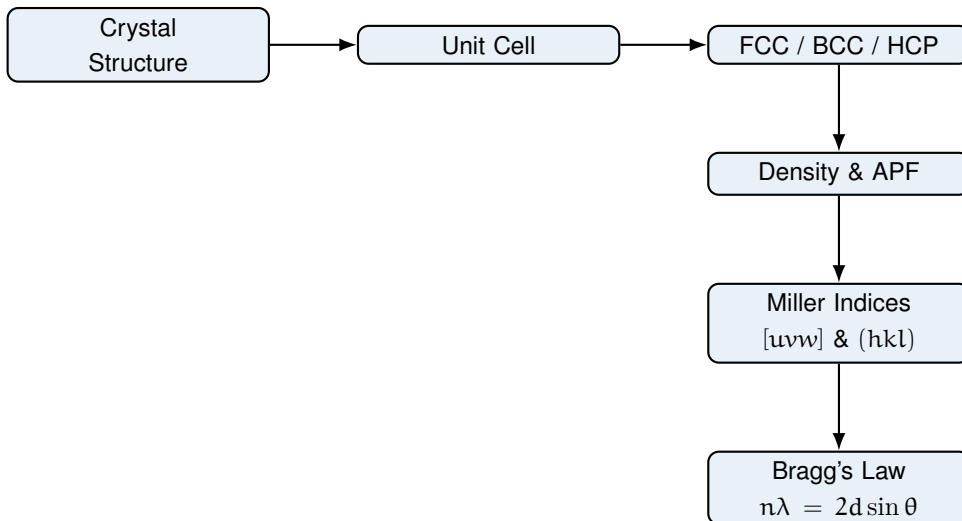
- Ionic: transfer, insulator, brittle, hard (NaCl, MgO).
- Covalent: share, directional, hard (diamond, Si).
- Metallic: sea, conductive, ductile (Fe, Cu, Al).
- Secondary: dipole, weak 0.1–40 kJ/mol (H-bond, London).

**Key formulas:**  $E_N = -A/r^m + B/r^n$ ;  $F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(\Delta\chi/2)^2}$ ;  $\rho = nA/(V_c N_A)$ .

# Chapter 3

## The Structure of Crystalline Solids

### 1. Roadmap



### 2. Learning Objectives

1. Sketch the BCC, FCC, and HCP unit cells and state where atoms sit.
2. Compute atoms per cell, coordination number, and atomic packing factor (APF).
3. Calculate theoretical density from crystal-structure data.
4. Index crystallographic directions  $[uvw]$  and planes  $(hkl)$ .
5. Use the cubic interplanar spacing  $d_{hkl}$  and Bragg's law for X-ray diffraction.
6. Distinguish FCC and BCC reflection (selection) rules for XRD.

### 3. Why This Matters

Crystal structure is the foundation of every mechanical, electrical, and thermal property you will meet later in the course. Whether a metal is ductile or brittle, how tightly atoms pack, and whether a semiconductor wafer will diffract a beam all trace back to the arrangement of atoms in the unit cell. On exams this



chapter is a guaranteed source of calculation problems: density, APF, Miller indices, and Bragg analysis appear every year. In engineering it decides alloy choice, heat-treatment response, and failure analysis of load-bearing parts. Master the geometry here and the rest of materials science becomes far easier to learn and to apply.

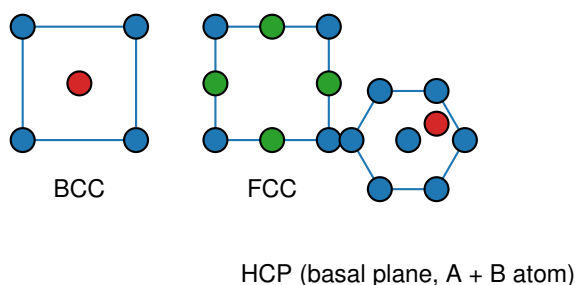
## 4. Intuition First

### Intuition First

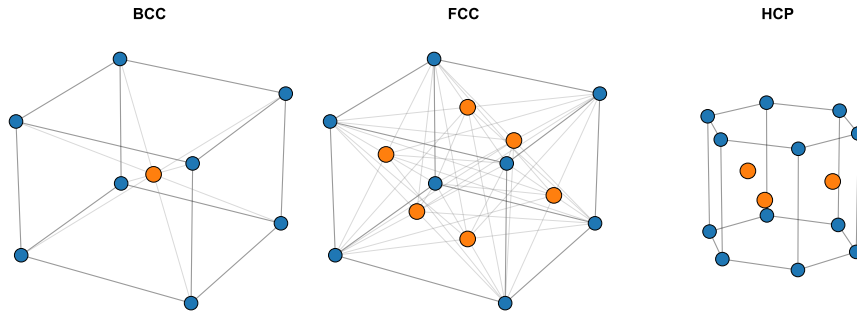
Imagine packing oranges in a crate. If you place each layer so that every orange nestles into the hollows of the layer below, you fill more of the box than if you line them up in a simple square grid. That single habit of “nestling tightly” is the whole origin of crystal structures. A *crystal* is just a 3D repeating pattern of atoms; the smallest brick that repeats to build the whole pattern is the *unit cell*. The three metal structures differ only in how the layers offset: FCC and HCP both nestle perfectly (same efficiency), while BCC leaves a little more empty space. Density is simply “how much atom mass sits inside one brick divided by the brick’s volume.”

## 5. Visual

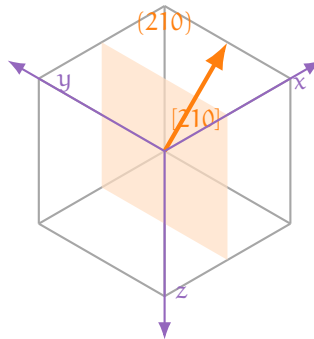
(one figure per key concept)



**Figure 3.1.** Figure 3.1 — 2D projections of the BCC, FCC and HCP unit cells. Blue = corner atoms; red = body-center; green = face-center atoms.

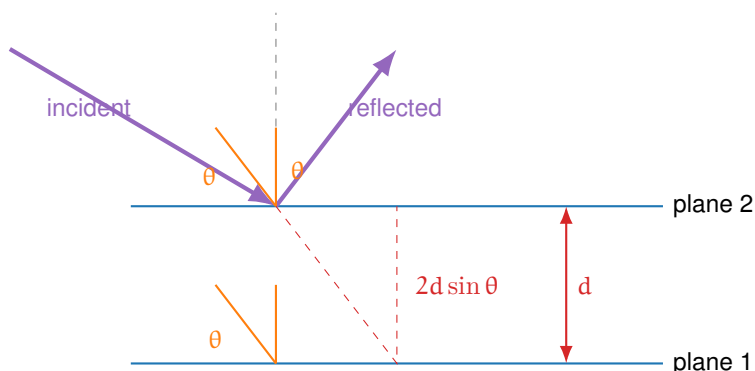


**Figure 3.2.** Figure 3.2 — Three-dimensional unit cells (3D, per the crystal-cell override of `FIGURE_GUIDE`): BCC (body-centered atom in orange), FCC (face-centered atoms in orange), and HCP.



Miller direction  $[210]$  (arrow) and plane  $(210)$  (face) in a 3D unit cell.

**Figure 3.3.** Figure 3.3 — A Miller direction  $[210]$  (orange arrow) and a Miller plane  $(210)$  (orange face) shown inside a 3D unit cell. In cubic crystals the direction is perpendicular to its like-indexed plane.



$$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$$

**Figure 3.4.** Figure 3.4 — Bragg diffraction geometry. An X-ray wave reflects from successive lattice planes (spacing  $d$ ) at a glancing angle  $\theta$ ; the extra path travelled between planes is  $2d \sin \theta$ , and constructive interference occurs when  $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$ .

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **FCC:** 4 atoms/cell; CN 12;  $a = 2\sqrt{2}R$ ; APF 0.74; Al, Cu, Ni, Pt, Au.
- **BCC:** 2 atoms/cell; CN 8;  $a = 4R/\sqrt{3}$ ; APF 0.68;  $\alpha$ -Fe, Cr, W, Mo.
- **HCP:** 6 atoms/cell (hex. prism); CN 12; ideal  $c/a = \sqrt{8/3} \approx 1.633$ ; APF 0.74; Mg, Zn, Ti, Co.
- **Density:**  $\rho = nA/(V_C N_A)$  with  $N_A = 6.022 \times 10^{23}$  atoms/mol.
- **APF:** fraction of cell volume filled by hard spheres; FCC = HCP > BCC > SC.
- **Bragg:**  $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$ ; FCC reflects when  $h, k, l$  all even or all odd; BCC when  $h + k + l$  even.

## 7. Compare Box

| FCC vs BCC vs HCP |                   |                             |
|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
| FCC               | BCC               | HCP                         |
| 4 atoms/cell      | 2 atoms/cell      | 6 atoms/cell                |
| CN = 12           | CN = 8            | CN = 12                     |
| APF 0.74          | APF 0.68          | APF 0.74                    |
| $a = 2\sqrt{2}R$  | $a = 4R/\sqrt{3}$ | $a = 2R, c/a \approx 1.633$ |
| Cubic             | Cubic             | Hexagonal                   |
| Close-packed      | Not close-packed  | Close-packed                |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Unit error in density:** forgetting  $1 \text{ nm} = 10^{-7} \text{ cm}$  (not  $10^{-9}$ ). Volume must be in  $\text{cm}^3$  when  $\rho$  is in  $\text{g}/\text{cm}^3$ . **Why:** this single power-of-ten error ruins the answer.
- **Confusing direction and plane:** writing  $[210]$  for a plane or  $(210)$  for a direction. **Why:** square brackets are directions, parentheses are planes.
- **Same reflection rule for FCC and BCC.** **Why:** FCC needs all even or all odd ( $hkl$ ); BCC needs  $h + k + l$  even. Mixing them mis-indexes the whole XRD pattern.
- **Mismatched units in Bragg's law.** **Why:**  $\lambda$  and  $d$  must share the same unit;  $\theta$  is the glancing angle, not  $2\theta$ .

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                                                | Meaning                  | Units                  | Variables                                     | Assump-<br>tions                      | Limitations                 | Eng.<br>meaning             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| $n_{\text{FCC}} = 4,$<br>$n_{\text{BCC}} = 2,$<br>$n_{\text{HCP}} = 6$ | Atoms per unit cell      | –                      | n atoms                                       | Hard-sphere atoms                     | –                           | Counts for density          |
| $\text{APF} = \frac{n(4/3)\pi R^3}{V_{\text{C}}}$                      | Packing efficiency       | –                      | R radius, $V_{\text{C}}$ cell vol.            | Spheres touch along close-packed dir. | Ideal spheres only          | Higher APF = denser packing |
| $\rho = \frac{nA}{V_{\text{C}} N_{\text{A}}}$                          | Theoretical density      | $\text{g}/\text{cm}^3$ | A atomic wt., $N_{\text{A}}$ Avogadro         | Cubic cell, no defects                | Vacancies lower real $\rho$ | Alloy density control       |
| $a = 2\sqrt{2}R$ (FCC),<br>$a = 4R/\sqrt{3}$ (BCC)                     | Lattice param. vs radius | nm                     | a lattice param.                              | Touching along body/face diagonal     | Single-element only         | Sizing from R               |
| $d_{\text{hkl}} = \frac{a}{\sqrt{h^2 + k^2 + l^2}}$                    | Interplanar spacing      | nm                     | a, Miller indices                             | Cubic crystals                        | Not for non-cubic           | Indexes XRD peaks           |
| $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$                                            | Bragg's law              | nm                     | $\lambda$ wavelength, $\theta$ glancing angle | Elastic, ordered planes               | Ignore disorder             | XRD structure ID            |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Atoms in an FCC Cell

**Problem:** How many atoms are in one FCC unit cell?

**Thinking:** Count contributions. Each of the 8 corners is shared by 8 cells; each of the 6 face centers is shared by 2 cells.

**Solution:**

$$n = 8 \left( \frac{1}{8} \right) + 6 \left( \frac{1}{2} \right) = 1 + 3 = 4.$$

## Intermediate

## Density of Copper

**Problem:** Cu is FCC with  $R = 0.128$  nm and  $A = 63.55$  g/mol. Find  $\rho$ .

**Thinking:** Get  $a$  from the FCC relation, cube it, convert to  $\text{cm}^3$ , then use  $\rho = nA/(V_C N_A)$  with  $n = 4$ .

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned} a &= 2\sqrt{2}R = 2\sqrt{2}(0.128) = 0.362 \text{ nm}, \\ V_C &= a^3 = (0.362 \times 10^{-7} \text{ cm})^3 = 4.75 \times 10^{-23} \text{ cm}^3, \\ \rho &= \frac{4(63.55)}{(4.75 \times 10^{-23})(6.022 \times 10^{23})} = \mathbf{8.89 \text{ g/cm}^3}. \end{aligned}$$

(Measured  $8.96 \text{ g/cm}^3$ ; small gap from vacancies and thermal expansion.)

## Advanced

## Indexing an Unknown XRD Pattern (BCC Fe)

**Problem:** A cubic metal gives  $2\theta = 44.8^\circ, 65.2^\circ, 82.6^\circ$  with  $\lambda = 0.1542$  nm. Identify it.

**Thinking:** Compute  $\sin^2 \theta$  for each peak; their ratios reveal  $h^2 + k^2 + l^2$ . BCC allows only even  $h + k + l$ , giving 2, 4, 6, ... (ratio 1 : 2 : 3).

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned} \sin^2(22.4^\circ) : \sin^2(32.6^\circ) : \sin^2(41.3^\circ) &= 0.145 : 0.290 : 0.435 = 1 : 2 : 3, \\ d_{110} &= \frac{0.1542}{2 \sin 22.4^\circ} = 0.2027 \text{ nm}, \\ a &= d_{110}\sqrt{2} = \mathbf{0.2866 \text{ nm}} \Rightarrow \mathbf{BCC \text{ Fe}}. \end{aligned}$$

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Atomic packing decides how a metal deforms. FCC metals (Cu, Al, Ni, Au) have 12 nearest neighbors and many close-packed slip systems, so they are ductile and form easily. BCC metals ( $\alpha$ -Fe, Cr, W) have a less symmetric slip set, giving higher strength but more brittle behavior at low temperature. HCP metals (Mg, Zn, Ti) slip on few systems and are often hard to forge. Engineers exploit this: they pick FCC copper for wire, BCC steel for strength, and titanium alloys for aerospace where weight and strength both matter. The same geometry that we count in a unit cell ultimately limits a bridge, an engine block, or a turbine blade.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **X-ray diffraction (XRD):** phase identification and quality control in metallurgy and semiconductor fabs.
- **Alloy design:** density prediction for automotive and aerospace weight reduction.
- **Additive manufacturing:** crystal-structure checks on printed Ti-6Al-4V parts.
- **Thin-film electronics:** orienting FCC Cu interconnects and Al metallization.
- **Materials verification:** matching measured density and XRD peaks to a known structure in failure analysis.

## 13. Summary

Crystalline solids repeat a unit cell, and the three common metal cells differ only in how atoms nestle. FCC and HCP are the most efficient (APF 0.74, CN 12), while BCC is slightly looser (APF 0.68, CN 8). You can turn geometry into numbers: atoms per cell give density  $\rho = nA/(V_C N_A)$ , and the cubic interplanar spacing  $d_{hkl} = a/\sqrt{h^2 + k^2 + l^2}$  feeds Bragg's law  $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$  for X-ray identification. FCC and BCC show different reflection rules, which is the key to reading a

diffraction pattern. The single most important equation of the chapter is Bragg's law, because it links measurable diffraction angles back to the atomic lattice.

**Key Formula**

$$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$$

**14. Quick Review****Quick Review**

1. An FCC unit cell contains \_\_\_\_\_ atoms and has coordination number \_\_\_\_\_.
2. True / False: HCP has the same atomic packing factor as FCC. \_\_\_\_\_
3. The relation between lattice parameter and radius for BCC is  $a =$  \_\_\_\_\_.
4. True / False: In Bragg's law,  $\theta$  is the angle between the incident beam and the crystal plane. \_\_\_\_\_
5. For a BCC crystal, the sum  $h + k + l$  of a reflecting plane must be \_\_\_\_\_.
6. One-sentence summary: \_\_\_\_\_

**15. Practice Problems**

★ How many atoms are in one BCC unit cell?

- (a) 1    (b) 2    (c) 4    (d) 6

(p. 145)

★ The atomic packing factor of FCC is:

- (a) 0.52    (b) 0.68    (c) 0.74    (d) 0.82

(p. 145)

★★ Copper is FCC with  $R = 0.128$  nm. Its lattice parameter  $a$  is approximately:

- (a) 0.256 nm    (b) 0.362 nm    (c) 0.512 nm    (d) 0.296 nm

(p. 145)



★★ A peak at  $2\theta = 44.8^\circ$  for BCC Fe arises from the reflecting plane:

- (a) (100)    (b) (110)    (c) (111)    (d) (200)

(p. 145)

★★★ For FCC Al ( $a = 0.405$  nm,  $\lambda = 0.1542$  nm), the first three XRD peaks correspond to which planes?

- (a) (100), (110), (111)  
 (b) (111), (200), (220)  
 (c) (110), (200), (211)  
 (d) (100), (200), (300)

(p. 145)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What are the atoms per cell for FCC, BCC, and HCP?

**Back:** FCC = 4, BCC = 2, HCP = 6 (hexagonal prism).

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is the atomic packing factor (APF)?

**Back:** The fraction of unit-cell volume occupied by hard-sphere atoms:  $n(4/3)\pi R^3/V_C$ . FCC and HCP = 0.74; BCC = 0.68.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Write Bragg's law and name each symbol.

**Back:**  $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$ ;  $n$  order,  $\lambda$  wavelength,  $d$  interplanar spacing,  $\theta$  glancing angle.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** How do you index a crystallographic direction  $[uvw]$ ?

---

**Back:** Take vector components in lattice units, clear fractions, enclose in square brackets; use  $\bar{u}$  for negative.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What are the XRD reflection rules for FCC and BCC?

---

**Back:** FCC:  $h, k, l$  all even or all odd. BCC:  $h + k + l$  is even.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Give the cubic interplanar spacing formula.

---

**Back:**  $d_{hkl} = a/\sqrt{h^2 + k^2 + l^2}$ , valid only for cubic crystals.

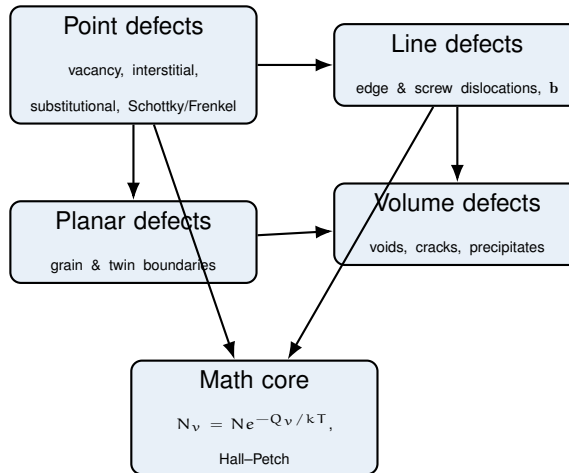
**17. Cheat Sheet****Cheat Sheet**

- **FCC:**  $n = 4$ , CN 12, APF 0.74,  $a = 2\sqrt{2}R$ , Al Cu Ni Pt Au.
- **BCC:**  $n = 2$ , CN 8, APF 0.68,  $a = 4R/\sqrt{3}$ ,  $\alpha$ -Fe Cr W Mo.
- **HCP:**  $n = 6$ , CN 12, APF 0.74,  $c/a \approx 1.633$ , Mg Zn Ti Co.
- **Density:**  $\rho = nA/(V_C N_A)$ ; use  $\text{cm}^3$ ,  $1 \text{ nm} = 10^{-7} \text{ cm}$ .
- **APF:**  $n(4/3)\pi R^3/V_C$ .
- **Direction**  $[uvw]$ : vector comps  $\rightarrow$  clear fractions  $\rightarrow$  brackets.
- **Plane**  $(hkl)$ : intercepts  $\rightarrow$  reciprocals  $\rightarrow$  clear fractions  $\rightarrow$  parentheses.
- **Spacing:**  $d_{hkl} = a/\sqrt{h^2 + k^2 + l^2}$  (cubic only).
- **Bragg:**  $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$ ; FCC all-even/all-odd, BCC  $h + k + l$  even.

# Chapter 4

## Imperfections in Solids

### 1. Roadmap



Real crystals are never perfect. Every deviation from an ideal lattice — an empty site, an extra atom, a slipped plane, a misoriented grain — is a *defect*, and these defects control diffusion, strength, conductivity, and failure. This chapter classifies defects by dimensionality (0-D, 1-D, 2-D, 3-D), gives the equation for equilibrium vacancy concentration, defines the Burgers vector that characterizes dislocations, and links grain size to strength through the Hall–Petch relation.

### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Classify defects** by dimensionality: point (0-D), line (1-D), planar (2-D), and volume (3-D), with examples of each.
2. **Compute equilibrium vacancy concentration** using the Arrhenius expression  $N_v = N \exp(-Q_v/kT)$  and convert temperature to Kelvin.
3. **Describe edge and screw dislocations**, locate the dislocation line, and state the direction of the Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$  relative to it.
4. **Apply Hume-Rothery rules** to predict extensive vs. limited substitutional solid solubility.

5. **Explain Schottky and Frenkel defects** in ionic crystals and their link to diffusion and conductivity.
6. **Use the Hall–Petch relation**  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$  to relate grain size to yield strength.

### 3. Why This Matters

Defects are not annoying flaws to be eliminated; they are the levers engineers pull. Vacancies make diffusion and heat treatment possible, dislocations make metals ductile instead of brittle, and grain boundaries make steel strong. On exams this chapter is high-yield: it feeds directly into diffusion, phase transformations, and mechanical behavior, and it appears as both formula questions (vacancy count, Hall–Petch) and concept questions (edge vs. screw, Schottky vs. Frenkel). In industry, controlling defects is how we make everything from turbine blades to semiconductor dopants.

### 4. Intuition First

#### Intuition First

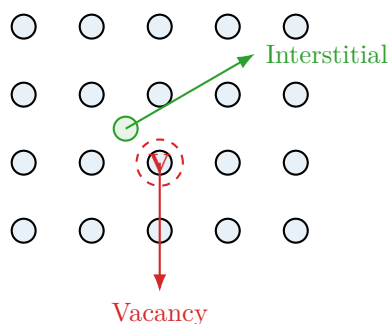
Imagine a perfectly packed parking lot: every spot filled, every car aligned. A *vacancy* is an empty spot. A *self-interstitial* is a car parked on the grass between two spots — it does not fit, so it costs a lot of energy. A *substitutional impurity* is a different car in one spot; a *small interstitial impurity* (like a bicycle) fits in the gap.

Now picture a bookshelf. An *edge dislocation* is one extra shelf inserted halfway down, so the rows above are pushed out of line. A *screw dislocation* is the result of shearing the block with a screwdriver so the pages form a spiral ramp. Both let the whole stack deform a little at a time instead of breaking all at once.

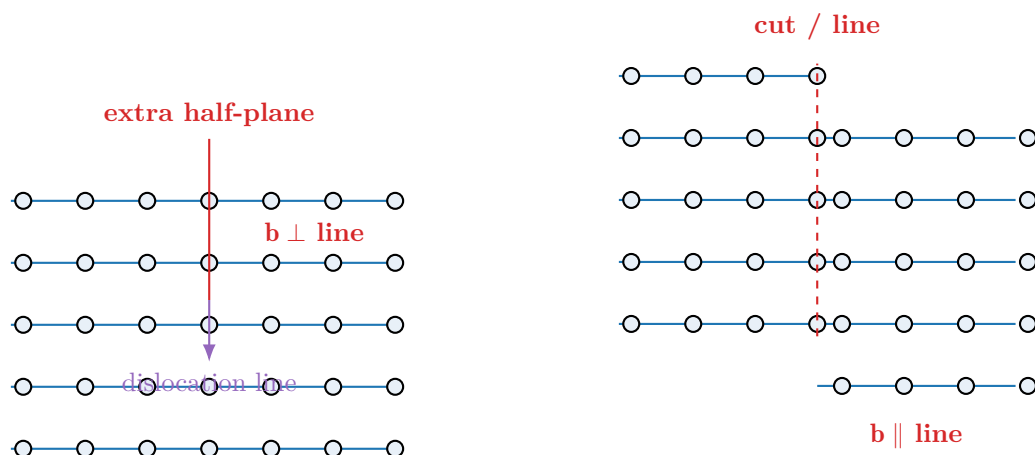
A *grain boundary* is the messy line where two crystals meet at different angles, like two crowds drifting together. The mismatch stores energy and blocks movement — which is exactly why smaller grains make a material stronger.

### 5. Visual

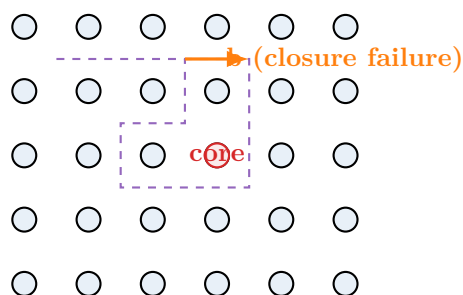
(one figure per key concept)



**Figure 4.1.** Figure 4.1 — A vacancy (missing host atom, red) and a self-interstitial (extra atom in an interstitial site, green).



**Figure 4.2.** Figure 4.2 — Edge dislocation (left): an extra half-plane ends at the dislocation line,  $\mathbf{b}$  perpendicular to the line. Screw dislocation (right): the lattice shears into a spiral ramp,  $\mathbf{b}$  parallel to the line.



**Figure 4.3.** Figure 4.3 — Burgers circuit: a closed loop of lattice steps fails to close by the Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$  when traced around a dislocation core.



**Figure 4.4.** Figure 4.4 — A high-angle grain boundary (left) joins two mis-oriented crystals; a coherent twin boundary (right) is a low-energy *mirror-image* relationship: the lattice on one side is the exact reflection of the other across the twin (composition) plane, and the atoms on the plane are shared.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **Equilibrium vacancies:**  $N_v/N = \exp(-Q_v/kT)$ . Always  $> 0$  for  $T > 0$ ; vanishes near 0 K.
- **Edge dislocation:** extra half-plane;  $\mathbf{b} \perp$  dislocation line; line is the half-plane edge.
- **Screw dislocation:** spiral shear;  $\mathbf{b} \parallel$  dislocation line; glide can cross-slip.
- **Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$ :** lattice distortion magnitude & direction; closure failure of a Burgers circuit.
- **Dislocation density  $\rho$ :**  $\text{m}/\text{m}^3$ ; annealed  $\sim 10^{10} - 10^{12}$ , cold-worked  $\sim 10^{15} - 10^{16}$ .
- **Hume-Rothery:**  $< 15\%$  size, same structure, similar electronegativity, same valence  $\Rightarrow$  wide solubility.
- **Hall-Petch:**  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ ; smaller grains  $\Rightarrow$  stronger.
- **Schottky:** paired vacancies (cation+anion), neutral. **Frenkel:** vacancy + interstitial, neutral.
- **Slip systems:** FCC  $\{111\} = 12$ , BCC  $\{110/112/123\} = 48$ , HCP basal  $\{0001\} = 3$ .

## 7. Compare Box

### Edge vs. Screw Dislocation

| Edge dislocation                       | Screw dislocation                                      |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Extra half-plane of atoms inserted.    | Lattice sheared into a spiral ramp.                    |
| $\mathbf{b} \perp$ dislocation line.   | $\mathbf{b} \parallel$ dislocation line.               |
| Glides parallel to $\mathbf{b}$ .      | Glides perpendicular to $\mathbf{b}$ ; can cross-slip. |
| Climbs by vacancy absorption/emission. | No climb (no half-plane).                              |

### Vacancy vs. Interstitial

| Vacancy                        | Interstitial                             |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| A lattice site left empty.     | An atom in a normally empty gap site.    |
| Low formation energy (common). | High formation energy (rare for self).   |
| Promotes diffusion.            | Small impurity atoms (C, H, N) fit well. |

### Schottky vs. Frenkel (ionic)

| Schottky defect                 | Frenkel defect                        |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Cation vacancy + anion vacancy. | Cation vacancy + cation interstitial. |
| Charge neutrality preserved.    | Charge neutrality preserved.          |
| e.g. NaCl, MgO.                 | e.g. AgCl, CaF <sub>2</sub> .         |
| $n \propto \exp(-E_s/2kT)$ .    | $n \propto \exp(-E_f/2kT)$ .          |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Forgetting Kelvin:** The vacancy formula uses absolute temperature  $T$  in kelvin. Plugging in 900 (Celsius) instead of 1173 K gives a wildly wrong answer. **Why:** the exponent  $-Q_v/kT$  is dimensionless and only correct in K.
- **Mixing Burgers-vector direction:** Students write  $\mathbf{b} \parallel$  line for edge and  $\perp$  for screw. **Why:** it is the opposite — edge is  $\perp$ , screw is  $\parallel$ .
- **Thinking dislocations make crystals *weaker*:** Dislocations let deformation happen at low stress, but high  $\rho$  *strengthens* (work hardening). **Why:** more dislocations obstruct each other;  $\tau \propto Gb\sqrt{\rho}$ .
- **Using  $R$  with per-atom  $Q_v$ :** If  $Q_v$  is in eV/atom, the constant is Boltzmann  $k$ ; if in J/mol, use gas constant  $R$ . **Why:** unit mismatch silently breaks the exponent.
- **Assuming Hall–Petch always holds:** At very small (nanoscale) grains the inverse relation can reverse (gb sliding). **Why:** the  $\rho$  (dislocation) term weakens as grains shrink.
- **Confusing Schottky and Frenkel:** Schottky removes two atoms to surfaces; Frenkel merely moves one atom to an interstitial. **Why:** both keep neutrality but differ in atom count and density change.



## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                              | Meaning                    | Units    | Variables                        | Assump-<br>tions            | Limitations            | Eng.<br>meaning               |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|
| $N_v = N e^{-Q_v/kT}$                | Equilibrium vacancy number | $m^{-3}$ | $N$ sites/ $m^3$ , $Q_v$ eV/atom | Thermal equilibrium, dilute | Not valid near melting | Vacancies drive diffusion     |
| $N_v/N = e^{-Q_v/kT}$                | Vacancy fraction           | –        | –                                | Same as above               | –                      | Fraction grows with T         |
| $N_v = N e^{-Q_v/RT}$                | Vacancy number (molar)     | $m^{-3}$ | $R = 8.314$ J/molK               | $Q_v$ in J/mol              | –                      | Use with molar $Q_v$          |
| $n_s = N e^{-E_s/2kT}$               | Schottky pairs             | $m^{-3}$ | $E_s$ pair energy                | Ionic, neutral pairs        | Stoichiometric limit   | Controls ceramic conductivity |
| $n_f = \sqrt{NN_i} e^{-E_f/2kT}$     | Frenkel defects            | $m^{-3}$ | $N_i$ interstitial sites         | Ionic, one species moves    | Low-T approx           | AgCl, CaF <sub>2</sub> doping |
| $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ | Hall-Petch strength        | MPa      | $d$ grain dia.                   | Polycrystal, glide          | Fails at nm grains     | Smaller grain = stronger      |
| $\tau \propto G b \sqrt{\rho}$       | Dislocation strengthening  | MPa      | $\rho$ density                   | Random forest               | No dynamic recov.      | Work hardening                |
| $D = D_0 e^{-Q/RT}$                  | Arrhenius diffusivity      | $m^2/s$  | $D_0$ , $Q$                      | Thermally activated         | Not for short-circuit  | Heat-treatment design         |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Vacancy Fraction in Copper at 900°C

**Problem:** Given  $Q_v = 0.9$  eV/atom for Cu, find  $N_v/N$  at  $T = 900^\circ\text{C}$ .

**Thinking:** Convert Celsius to kelvin first ( $T = 900 + 273 = 1173$  K), then evaluate the exponent with  $k = 8.62 \times 10^{-5}$  eV/K.

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{N_v}{N} &= \exp\left(-\frac{Q_v}{kT}\right) = \exp\left(-\frac{0.9}{(8.62 \times 10^{-5})(1173)}\right) \\ &= \exp(-8.91) = 1.35 \times 10^{-4}. \end{aligned}$$

So about 1 in 7400 sites is vacant at this temperature.

## Intermediate

## Absolute Vacancy Count in Copper

**Problem:** For FCC Cu,  $a = 0.362$  nm,  $A = 63.55$  g/mol. Find  $N_v$  (vacancies/m<sup>3</sup>) at 1173 K with the fraction above.

**Thinking:** Compute atomic site density  $N = n/V_C$  for FCC ( $n = 4$ ), then multiply by the fraction.

**Solution:**

$$V_C = (0.362 \times 10^{-9})^3 = 4.75 \times 10^{-29} \text{ m}^3,$$

$$N = \frac{4}{4.75 \times 10^{-29}} = 8.42 \times 10^{28} \text{ atoms/m}^3,$$

$$N_v = (1.35 \times 10^{-4})(8.42 \times 10^{28}) = 1.14 \times 10^{25} \text{ vacancies/m}^3.$$

At 300 K the fraction is  $\exp(-34.8) = 7.7 \times 10^{-16}$ , effectively zero.

## Advanced

## Hall–Petch Grain Refinement

**Problem:** A steel has  $\sigma_0 = 100$  MPa,  $k_y = 0.8$  MPa·mm<sup>1/2</sup>. Compare yield strength at  $d = 10$   $\mu\text{m}$  and  $d = 1$   $\mu\text{m}$ .

**Thinking:** Convert  $\mu\text{m}$  to mm ( $10$   $\mu\text{m} = 0.01$  mm,  $1$   $\mu\text{m} = 0.001$  mm), then apply  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ .

**Solution:**

$$d = 10 \text{ } \mu\text{m} : \sigma_y = 100 + 0.8 (0.01)^{-1/2} = 100 + 0.8 \times 10 = 108 \text{ MPa.}$$

$$d = 1 \text{ } \mu\text{m} : \sigma_y = 100 + 0.8 (0.001)^{-1/2} = 100 + 0.8 \times 31.6 = 125 \text{ MPa.}$$

Refining the grain tenfold raises yield strength by about 16% through added boundary area.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Dislocations are why metals are ductile and why pure metals are soft. A perfect crystal would need  $\sim G/10$  shear stress to slip; real crystals yield near  $G/10^3$ – $G/10^4$  because dislocations move a little at a time. Engineers exploit this two ways. First, *work hardening*: cold rolling multiplies  $\rho$  from  $10^{10}$  to  $10^{16}$   $\text{m}^2/\text{m}^3$ , so flow stress  $\tau \propto Gb\sqrt{\rho}$  rises a thousandfold. Second, *grain refinement*: every grain boundary is a wall dislocations cannot cross, so the Hall–Petch law lets us strengthen steel just by making grains smaller — the basis of high-strength low-alloy steels and nanocrystalline alloys. The same defects that "weaken" a perfect lattice are the knobs we turn to design toughness, formability, and strength.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Heat treatment & diffusion:** Vacancy concentration sets the rate of carburizing, nitriding, and annealing; higher  $T$  means more vacancies and faster case hardening.
- **Work-hardened sheet metal:** Beverage cans and auto body panels gain strength from dislocation density without adding alloy.
- **Grain-refined steels:** Controlled rolling and recrystallization tune  $d$  for pipelines and bridges (Hall–Petch).
- **Semiconductor doping:** Interstitial and substitutional impurities (P, B in Si) are placed via diffusion driven by point defects.
- **Ceramic ionic conductors:** Schottky/Frenkel defects govern oxygen-ion conduction in SOFC electrolytes (YSZ).
- **Powder metallurgy:** Voids and inclusions (volume defects) are controlled to avoid fracture-initiation sites.

## 13. Summary

Real solids contain defects at four scales. *Point defects* (vacancy, self-interstitial, substitutional and interstitial impurity, plus Schottky/Frenkel pairs in ionic crys-

tals) exist in thermodynamic equilibrium; their concentration follows  $N_v = N \exp(-Q_v/kT)$  and rises steeply with temperature. *Line defects* — edge and screw dislocations — carry plastic slip; the Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$  is perpendicular to the line for edge and parallel for screw. *Planar defects* (grain and twin boundaries) store energy and block slip, giving the Hall–Petch strengthening  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ . *Volume defects* (voids, cracks, precipitates) act as stress concentrators and fracture sites. The single equation to memorize is the equilibrium vacancy relation; it underpins diffusion, heat treatment, and conductivity.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. A \_\_\_\_\_ is a lattice site left empty; a \_\_\_\_\_ is an extra atom in a gap site.
2. True / False: An edge dislocation has  $\mathbf{b}$  parallel to its line. \_\_\_\_\_
3. In the Hall–Petch relation, decreasing grain size  $d$  \_\_\_\_\_ (increases / decreases) yield strength.
4. A Schottky defect in NaCl consists of a \_\_\_\_\_ vacancy plus an \_\_\_\_\_ vacancy.
5. Hume-Rothery requires atomic radii to differ by less than \_\_\_\_\_% for wide solubility.
6. FCC crystals have \_\_\_\_\_ slip systems, making them \_\_\_\_\_ (ductile / brittle).
7. One-sentence summary: Defects are the \_\_\_\_\_ that control diffusion, strength, and conductivity in real materials.

## 15. Practice Problems

★ The equilibrium concentration of vacancies in a metal:

- (a) Increases exponentially with temperature.
- (b) Decreases with temperature.
- (c) Is independent of temperature.
- (d) Is zero below the melting point.

★ In an edge dislocation, the Burgers vector is:

- (a) Parallel to the dislocation line.
- (b) Perpendicular to the dislocation line.
- (c) Zero.
- (d) Equal to the lattice parameter.

(p. 145)

★★ According to the Hall–Petch relation, refining grain size from 10  $\mu\text{m}$  to 1  $\mu\text{m}$  will:

- (a) Decrease strength.
- (b) Increase strength.
- (c) Not affect strength.
- (d) Eliminate dislocations.

(p. 145)

★★ Which is **not** a Hume-Rothery rule for solid solubility?

- (a) Similar atomic radii ( $< 15\%$  difference).
- (b) Same crystal structure.
- (c) High melting point.
- (d) Similar electronegativity.

(p. 145)

★★ A low-angle grain boundary consists of:

- (a) Amorphous material.
- (b) An array of dislocations.
- (c) Precipitates.
- (d) Twin boundaries.

(p. 145)

★★★ A Schottky defect differs from a Frenkel defect in that it:

- (a) Involves only cation vacancies.
- (b) Creates a vacancy-interstitial pair of the same ion.
- (c) Removes a cation-anion pair from the lattice.
- (d) Changes the crystal structure.

(p. 145)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is a vacancy, and does it exist at 0 K?

**Back:** A lattice site with the atom missing. It exists in equilibrium only for  $T > 0$ ; at 0 K the equilibrium concentration is zero.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Edge vs. screw: direction of the Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$ ?

**Back:** Edge:  $\mathbf{b}$  perpendicular to the dislocation line. Screw:  $\mathbf{b}$  parallel to the line.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Write the equilibrium vacancy concentration formula.

**Back:**  $N_v = N \exp(-Q_v/kT)$ , with  $N$  atomic sites/ $\text{m}^3$ ,  $Q_v$  activation energy (eV/atom or J/mol),  $k$  or  $R$  the gas constant,  $T$  in kelvin.

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does the Hall–Petch relation say?

**Back:**  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ : smaller average grain diameter  $d$  gives higher yield strength.

### Flash Card

**Front:** State the Hume-Rothery rules for wide solubility.

**Back:** Atomic radii within 15%, same crystal structure, similar electronegativity, same valence.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Define Schottky and Frenkel defects (ionic crystals).

---

**Back:** Schottky: paired cation + anion vacancies (neutral). Frenkel: one cation vacancy + one cation interstitial (neutral).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why are FCC metals ductile but HCP often brittle?

---

**Back:** FCC has 12 slip systems; HCP has only 3 (basal). More slip systems let dislocations accommodate shape change.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is dislocation density  $\rho$ , and its typical range?

---

**Back:** Total dislocation length per unit volume ( $\text{m}/\text{m}^3$ ). Annealed  $\sim 10^{10}$ – $10^{12}$ ; heavily deformed  $\sim 10^{15}$ – $10^{16}$ .

## 17. Cheat Sheet

### Cheat Sheet

#### Defect families (by dimension)

0-D point: vacancy, interstitial, substitutional/impurity, Schottky/Frenkel.

1-D line: edge (extra half-plane,  $\mathbf{b} \perp$  line), screw (spiral,  $\mathbf{b} \parallel$  line).

2-D planar: grain boundary (high energy), twin boundary (low energy, mirror), low-angle = dislocation array.

3-D volume: void, crack, precipitate, inclusion.

#### Key formulas

$N_v/N = \exp(-Q_v/kT)$  (use K!  $k = 8.62 \times 10^{-5}$  eV/K, or R with J/mol)

Schottky:  $n \propto \exp(-E_s/2kT)$ ; Frenkel:  $n \propto \exp(-E_f/2kT)$

Hall-Petch:  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$  (smaller  $d \rightarrow$  stronger)

$\tau \propto Gb\sqrt{\rho}$  (more dislocations  $\rightarrow$  stronger)

#### Memory numbers

Dislocation density: annealed  $10^{10} - 10^{12}$ ; cold-worked  $10^{15} - 10^{16}$  m/m<sup>3</sup>.

Slip systems: FCC 12, BCC 48, HCP 3.

Hume-Rothery size limit: < 15% radius difference.

#### Quick contrasts

Edge glide  $\parallel \mathbf{b}$ ; screw glide  $\perp \mathbf{b}$  and can cross-slip.

Schottky = pair removed; Frenkel = one atom relocated to interstitial.

Climb (edge only) needs vacancies + temperature (creep).

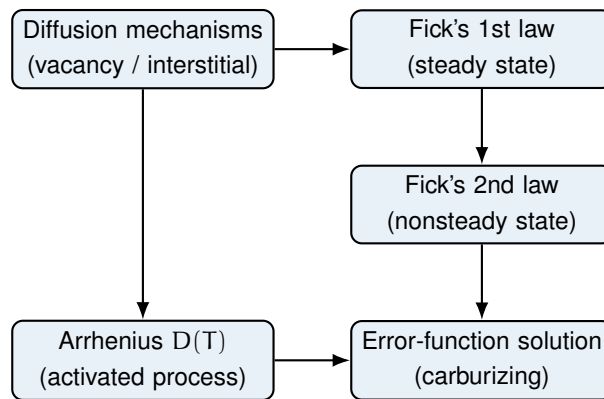


# Chapter 5

## Diffusion

### 1. Roadmap

A concept map showing how the ideas in this chapter connect. Diffusion is the movement of atoms driven by a concentration gradient. The two laws describe the flux, the Arrhenius relation gives the temperature dependence, and the error-function solution lets us predict case depths in real treatments.



### 2. Learning Objectives

1. Distinguish vacancy diffusion from interstitial diffusion and state which is faster and why.
2. Apply Fick's first law to steady-state diffusion through a membrane.
3. Apply Fick's second law and the error-function solution to nonsteady-state diffusion.
4. Use the Arrhenius relation  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$  to find  $D$  at any temperature.
5. Solve carburizing problems for case depth, concentration, or required time.

### 3. Why This Matters

Diffusion appears on nearly every materials-science exam because it links atomic motion to properties we can engineer. Case-hardening of gears, doping of semiconductor wafers, and the densification of ceramics during sintering are all diffusion-

controlled processes. Understanding the two Fick laws and the Arrhenius temperature dependence is the difference between predicting a heat-treatment time and guessing it in the lab.

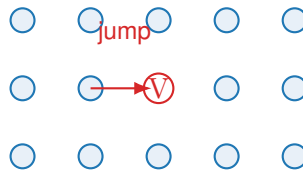
## 4. Intuition First

### Intuition First

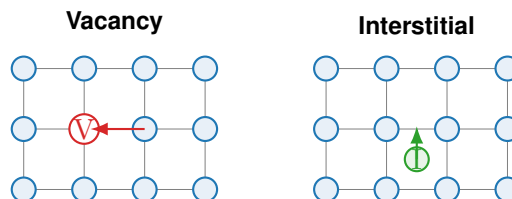
Imagine a crowded room where people enter on the left and leave on the right. Nobody is told to move, yet the crowd flows from the crowded side to the empty side simply because random steps are more likely to go toward open space. That net drift is diffusion. Atoms do the same: thermal vibration makes each atom take random hops, but where the concentration is lower there are more empty sites to hop into, so the net flux points “downhill” in concentration. The negative sign in Fick’s first law is just this downhill rule. If the two ends stay fixed, the profile never changes (steady state); if one end is being filled or drained, the profile moves with time (nonsteady state).

## 5. Visual

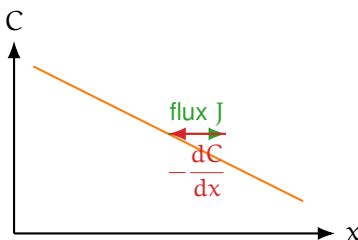
(one figure per key concept)



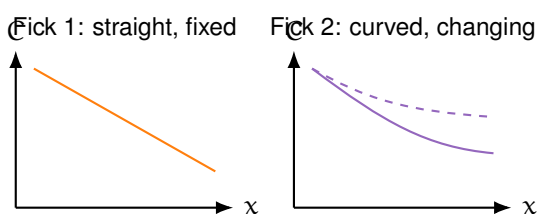
**Figure 5.1.** Figure 5.1 — Atomic jump mechanism: an atom hops into an adjacent vacancy, effectively moving the vacancy the other way.



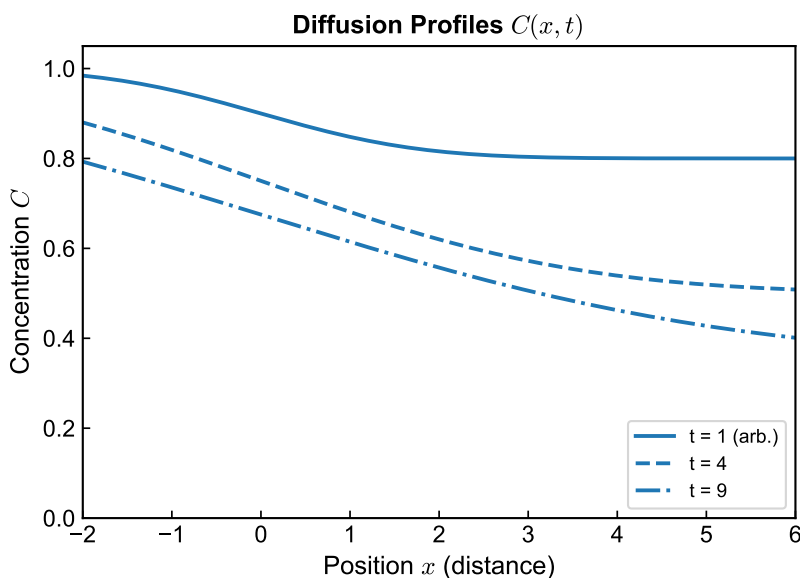
**Figure 5.2.** Figure 5.2 — Vacancy diffusion needs an empty lattice site; interstitial diffusion uses the gaps between host atoms, so it is faster.



**Figure 5.3.** Figure 5.3 — Concentration gradient schematic. The flux points down the gradient (positive  $x$ ), while the gradient  $dC/dx$  is negative.



**Figure 5.4.** Figure 5.4 — Fick's first law: a straight profile that does not change with time. Fick's second law: a profile whose slope changes with time (dashed = earlier, solid = later).



**Figure 5.5.** Figure 5.5 — Typical concentration profiles: steady-state linear profile and a nonsteady-state carburizing profile versus depth.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **Diffusion** = mass transport by atomic motion driven by a concentration gradient.
- **Vacancy diffusion**: atom swaps with an empty site; dominant for substitutional alloys (Cu in Ni).
- **Interstitial diffusion**: small atoms (C, H, N) hop between gaps; faster, lower  $Q_d$ .
- **Fick 1**:  $J = -D \, dC/dx$  (steady state, profile fixed).
- **Fick 2**:  $\partial C/\partial t = D \, \partial^2 C/\partial x^2$  (transient).
- **Error fn**:  $(C - C_0)/(C_S - C_0) = 1 - \text{erf}(x/2\sqrt{Dt})$ .
- **Arrhenius**:  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$ ; plot  $\ln D$  vs  $1/T$  gives slope  $-Q_d/R$ .
- **Diffusion length**:  $\sqrt{Dt}$  is the characteristic penetration depth.

## 7. Compare Box

### Vacancy vs Interstitial Diffusion

| Vacancy diffusion                                                 | Interstitial diffusion                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Atom moves into an adjacent empty lattice site                    | Small atom moves through the gaps between host atoms |
| Requires vacancies to be present                                  | No vacancy needed; sites widely available            |
| Slower; higher activation energy $Q_d$                            | Faster; lower activation energy $Q_d$                |
| Dominant in substitutional alloys (e.g. Cu in Ni, self-diffusion) | Dominant for small atoms (C, H, N in Fe)             |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Forgetting to convert °C to Kelvin** ( $T_K = T_C + 273$ ) in the Arrhenius equation. **Why:** the gas constant  $R$  is per Kelvin, so Celsius gives a wrong exponent by orders of magnitude.
- **Confusing the sign in Fick's first law.** **Why:** the minus sign means flux is opposite the gradient (downhill); dropping it predicts flow from low to high concentration.
- **Treating  $D$  as a constant when it varies with composition.** **Why:** the error-function solution assumes constant  $D$ ; real systems need an averaged or effective value.
- **Reading  $\sqrt{Dt}$  as an exact front.** **Why:** it is only a characteristic penetration depth, not the position of a sharp concentration step.
- **Using the steady-state law for a growing case.** **Why:** carburizing deepens with  $\sqrt{t}$ , which needs Fick's second law, not the straight-line first law.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                                                   | Meaning                                  | Units                            | Variables                               | Assump-<br>tions              | Limitations           | Eng.<br>meaning             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|
| $J = -D \frac{dC}{dx}$                                                    | Flux down the gradient (steady state)    | $\text{kg}/(\text{m}^2\text{s})$ | J flux, D diffusivity, C conc.          | Steady state; constant D      | No time dependence    | Linear membrane permeation  |
| $J = D \frac{C_A - C_B}{\Delta x}$                                        | Flux through flat membrane               | $\text{kg}/(\text{m}^2\text{s})$ | $\Delta x$ thickness                    | Linear gradient; steady state | Neglects edge effects | Gas / carbon through a wall |
| $\frac{\partial C}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 C}{\partial x^2}$     | Rate of change of concentration          | $\text{kg}/(\text{m}^3\text{s})$ | t time, x position                      | Constant D; 1-D               | No sources/sinks      | Transient profiles          |
| $\frac{C - C_0}{C_S - C_0} = \text{erf}\left(\frac{x}{2\sqrt{Dt}}\right)$ | Semi-infinite solid, fixed surface $C_S$ | dimensionless                    | $C_0$ initial, $C_S$ surface            | Constant $C_S$ , D            | Semi-infinite only    | Carburizing case depth      |
| $D = D_0 \exp\left(-\frac{Q_d}{RT}\right)$                                | Diffusivity vs temperature               | $\text{m}^2/\text{s}$            | $D_0$ prefactor, $Q_d$ act. energy      | Thermally activated           | Single mechanism      | Predict D at any T          |
| $J = \mathcal{P} \frac{dC}{dx}$                                           | Permeability form ( $L = D/\Delta x$ )   | $\text{kg}/(\text{m}^2\text{s})$ | $\mathcal{P} = D/\Delta x$ permeability | Steady state                  | Thin membrane         | Throughput of a barrier     |

## 10. Worked Examples

## Basic

## Steady-state flux through a plate

**Problem:** Carbon in  $\gamma$ -Fe at  $1000^\circ\text{C}$  diffuses through a steel plate 2 mm thick. Surface concentrations are held at 1.2 wt% (high side) and 0.2 wt% (low side). Use  $D = 1.4 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$ . Find the flux  $J$ .

**Thinking:** This is steady state, so Fick's first law with a linear gradient applies:  $J = D(C_A - C_B)/\Delta x$ . Keep concentration in wt% units consistently; the wt% difference cancels with any consistent conversion.

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned} J &= D \frac{C_A - C_B}{\Delta x} = (1.4 \times 10^{-11}) \frac{1.2 - 0.2}{2 \times 10^{-3}} \\ &= (1.4 \times 10^{-11}) \frac{1.0}{2 \times 10^{-3}} = 7.0 \times 10^{-9} \text{ (wt\%} \cdot \text{m/s)}. \end{aligned}$$

## Intermediate

## Diffusivity at a different temperature

**Problem:** For C in  $\gamma$ -Fe,  $D = 1.4 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$  at  $1000^\circ\text{C}$ . Given  $D_0 = 2.0 \times 10^{-5} \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$  and  $Q_d = 142 \text{ kJ/mol}$ , find  $D$  at  $800^\circ\text{C}$ .

**Thinking:** Use the Arrhenius form directly from the prefactor  $D_0$  and activation energy  $Q_d$ . Temperature must be in Kelvin ( $800^\circ\text{C} = 1073 \text{ K}$ ).

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned} \ln D &= \ln D_0 - \frac{Q_d}{R} \cdot \frac{1}{T} \\ &= \ln(2.0 \times 10^{-5}) - \frac{142000}{8.314} \cdot \frac{1}{1073} \\ &= -10.82 - 15.91 = -26.73, \\ D &= e^{-26.73} = 2.7 \times 10^{-12} \text{ m}^2/\text{s}. \end{aligned}$$

For comparison, at  $1000^\circ\text{C}$  (1273 K)  $D = 1.4 \times 10^{-11}$ ; dropping  $200^\circ\text{C}$  reduces  $D$  by a factor of about 5.

## Advanced

## Carburizing time for a target case depth

**Problem:** A 0.20 wt% C steel is carburized at 1000°C in a C-rich atmosphere ( $C_S = 1.2$  wt%) with  $D = 1.4 \times 10^{-11}$  m<sup>2</sup>/s. How long to reach 0.40 wt% C at a depth of 0.5 mm?

**Thinking:** Nonsteady state with fixed surface concentration calls for the error-function solution. Solve for  $z = x/(2\sqrt{Dt})$ , read erf from the table, then invert for t.

**Solution:**

$$\frac{C - C_0}{C_S - C_0} = \frac{0.40 - 0.20}{1.2 - 0.20} = \frac{0.20}{1.00} = 0.20,$$

$$1 - \text{erf}(z) = 0.20 \Rightarrow \text{erf}(z) = 0.80.$$

From the error-function table,  $\text{erf}(0.90) = 0.7970$  and  $\text{erf}(0.95) = 0.8209$ ; interpolating gives  $z \approx 0.906$ .

$$t = \frac{x^2}{4Dz^2} = \frac{(5 \times 10^{-4})^2}{4(1.4 \times 10^{-11})(0.906)^2} = \frac{2.5 \times 10^{-7}}{4.60 \times 10^{-11}} \approx 5435 \text{ s} \approx \mathbf{90 \text{ min.}}$$

## 11. Engineering Insight

## Engineering Insight

The single most useful design rule is case depth  $\propto \sqrt{Dt}$ . Because  $D$  rises steeply with temperature through the Arrhenius relation, a modest temperature increase slashes the time needed for the same case depth far more than simply extending the hold. In semiconductor doping, this same  $\sqrt{Dt}$  controls the junction depth that sets device geometry: a few minutes at 1100°C can place a p–n junction a micron below the surface. Engineers therefore trade temperature against time, but must respect the material's microstructural limits (grain growth, distortion) when pushing  $T$  higher.



## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Carburizing:** carbon diffuses into low-C steel at 900–1050°C for 2–24 h, giving a hard, wear-resistant case over a tough core. Case depth  $\propto \sqrt{Dt}$ .
- **Nitriding:** nitrogen diffuses into steel at  $\sim 500^\circ\text{C}$  to form hard nitrides (AlN, CrN); harder but thinner than a carburized case.
- **Semiconductor doping:** controlled diffusion of P, B, As into Si at 1000–1200°C creates p–n junctions (drive-in diffusion profile  $C_S \operatorname{erfc}(x/2\sqrt{Dt})$ ).
- **Sintering:** a powder compact is heated below  $T_m$ ; atoms diffuse across particle boundaries to close pores and densify ceramics and PM parts.
- **Homogenization:** a high-temperature hold after casting smooths dendritic microsegregation; time scales as  $t \approx \lambda^2/(\pi^2 D)$  where  $\lambda$  is the dendrite spacing.

## 13. Summary

Diffusion is atomic transport down a concentration gradient. Vacancy diffusion dominates substitutional alloys and is slower; interstitial diffusion of small atoms (C, H, N) is faster. Fick's first law  $J = -D \, dC/dx$  describes steady state, while Fick's second law  $\partial C/\partial t = D \, \partial^2 C/\partial x^2$  describes nonsteady state, whose fixed-surface solution uses the error function. The diffusivity follows Arrhenius behavior  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$ , so a small temperature rise hugely increases  $D$ . The most important engineering equation is the carburizing profile, where the characteristic depth is  $\sqrt{Dt}$ . Master these five relations and most exam problems reduce to reading a table and inverting an exponent.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. Interstitial diffusion is \_\_\_\_\_ (faster / slower) than vacancy diffusion because it has \_\_\_\_\_ (higher / lower) activation energy.
2. The minus sign in  $J = -D \, dC/dx$  means flux points \_\_\_\_\_ (up / down) the concentration gradient.
3. True / False: In Fick's second law the concentration profile is constant in time. \_\_\_\_\_
4. To double the case depth at fixed temperature you must increase the time by a factor of \_\_\_\_\_.
5. On an Arrhenius plot of  $\ln D$  versus  $1/T$ , the slope equals \_\_\_\_\_.

## 15. Practice Problems

★ Interstitial diffusion is faster than vacancy diffusion because:

- (a) More sites are available and the activation energy is lower
- (b) Interstitial atoms are larger
- (c) Vacancy diffusion requires grain boundaries
- (d) Interstitial diffusion does not follow Fick's laws

(p. 146)

★ Fick's first law states  $J = -D \, dC/dx$ . The negative sign indicates:

- (a) Flux is opposite to the concentration gradient direction
- (b) The diffusion coefficient is negative
- (c) Flow is from high to low concentration only at steady state
- (d) Concentration increases with time

(p. 146)

★★ In carburizing, to double the case depth at the same temperature the time must be increased by a factor of:

- (a) 2
- (b) 4

(c)  $\sqrt{2}$

(d) 8

(p. 146)

★★ At a given temperature, carbon diffuses faster in  $\alpha$ -Fe (BCC) than in  $\gamma$ -Fe (FCC) because:

(a) BCC has a lower atomic packing factor (0.68 vs. 0.74)

(b) BCC has higher density

(c) Carbon solubility is higher in BCC

(d) BCC has no grain boundaries

(p. 146)

★★★ The activation energy  $Q_d$  for diffusion is determined from:

(a) The slope of an Arrhenius plot ( $\ln D$  vs.  $1/T$ )

(b) The intercept of  $\ln D$  vs.  $\ln t$

(c) Fick's first law

(d) The error-function table

(p. 146)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is diffusion?

---

**Back:** Mass transport by atomic motion driven by a concentration (chemical potential) gradient.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Vacancy vs interstitial diffusion — which is faster and why?

---

**Back:** Interstitial is faster: small atoms (C, H, N) move through gaps between host atoms, needing no vacancy and a lower activation energy.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** State Fick's first law and when it applies.

---

**Back:**  $J = -D \, dC/dx$ . Applies to steady-state diffusion where the concentration profile does not change with time.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What does the error-function solution describe?

---

**Back:** Nonsteady diffusion into a semi-infinite solid with fixed surface concentration:  $(C - C_0)/(C_S - C_0) = 1 - \text{erf}(x/2\sqrt{Dt})$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Write the Arrhenius relation for diffusivity.

---

**Back:**  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$ . A plot of  $\ln D$  vs  $1/T$  gives slope  $-Q_d/R$  and intercept  $\ln D_0$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is the diffusion length and what is it NOT?

---

**Back:**  $\sqrt{Dt}$  is the characteristic penetration depth. It is NOT a sharp concentration front or exact case boundary.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

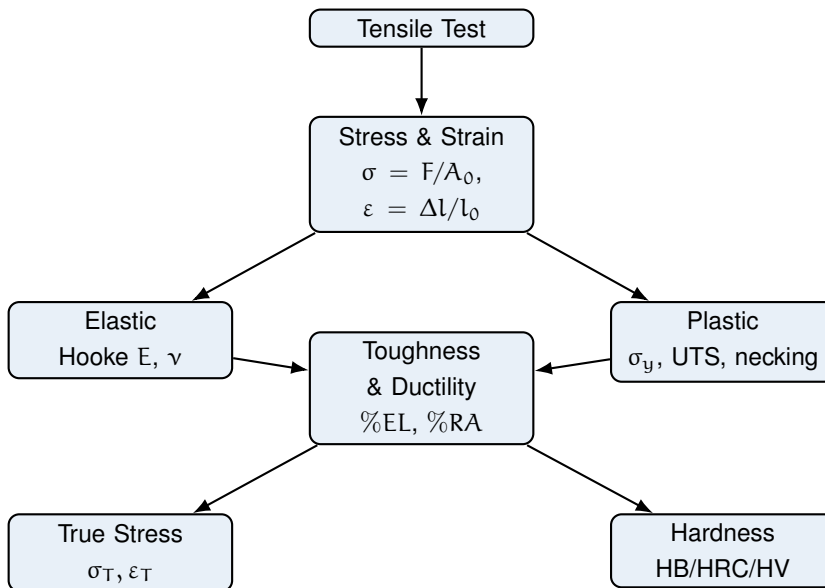
### Cheat Sheet

- **Two mechanisms:** vacancy (substitutional, slower) | interstitial (C/H/N, faster).
- **Fick 1 (steady):**  $J = -D \, dC/dx$ ; membrane:  $J = D(C_A - C_B)/\Delta x$ .
- **Fick 2 (transient):**  $\partial C/\partial t = D \, \partial^2 C/\partial x^2$ .
- **Error fn:**  $\frac{C - C_0}{C_S - C_0} = 1 - \operatorname{erf}\left(\frac{x}{2\sqrt{Dt}}\right)$ .
- **Arrhenius:**  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$ ; always use Kelvin.
- **Diffusion length:**  $\sqrt{Dt}$ ; case depth  $\propto \sqrt{t}$  at fixed  $T$ .
- **Orders of magnitude:** dropping  $\sim 200^\circ\text{C}$  cuts  $D$  by a factor of  $\sim 5$ .
- **Typical  $D_0$ ,  $Q_d$ :** C in  $\alpha\text{-Fe}$ :  $1.1 \times 10^{-6}$ , 87; C in  $\gamma\text{-Fe}$ :  $2.0 \times 10^{-5}$ , 142 (kJ/mol).
- **Pitfalls:** use K not  $^\circ\text{C}$ ; keep the minus sign; assume constant  $D$  for erf.

# Chapter 6

## Mechanical Properties of Metals

### 1. Roadmap



The chapter starts with the standard tensile test, which produces the engineering stress–strain curve. From that single curve we read every major property: stiffness ( $E$ ), the elastic–plastic boundary ( $\sigma_y$ ), peak load (UTS), energy absorption (toughness), and stretch before failure (ductility). We then correct the curve for the shrinking cross-section (true stress and strain) and finish with hardness, a fast surface probe that correlates directly with tensile strength.

### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Sketch and label** the engineering stress–strain curve: elastic region, yield, UTS, necking, and fracture.
2. **Compute**  $E$ ,  $\sigma_y$  (0.2% offset),  $\sigma_{TS}$ , %EL, and %RA from test data.
3. **Apply** Hooke’s law and Poisson’s ratio to elastic deformation.
4. **Convert** between engineering and true stress/strain.
5. **Interpret** toughness and resilience as areas under the curve.

6. **Relate** Brinell/Rockwell/Vickers hardness to tensile strength.

### 3. Why This Matters

Mechanical properties decide whether a bracket bends, a cable snaps, or a car crumples safely. Every structural design starts by comparing the applied stress with the material's yield and tensile strength, while ductility and toughness govern how a part fails — gracefully or catastrophically. In exams this chapter is high-yield: curve-reading, offset-yield, and true-stress conversions appear almost every year. In practice, engineers quote these numbers from a datasheet before selecting any metal.

### 4. Intuition First

#### Intuition First

Think of a metal bar as a bundle of tiny springs (atomic bonds). Pull gently and the springs stretch, then snap back when released — this is *elastic* deformation, and the spring stiffness is Young's modulus  $E$ . Pull harder and atomic planes start sliding permanently: the bar stays longer even after release — this is *plastic* deformation, beginning at the yield point. Keep pulling and the bar first strengthens (atoms tangle and resist sliding), reaches a peak load, then thins locally into a “neck” and finally tears. Stiffness, strength, and stretchiness are three independent personalities: a material can be stiff but brittle, or soft but very ductile.

### 5. Visual

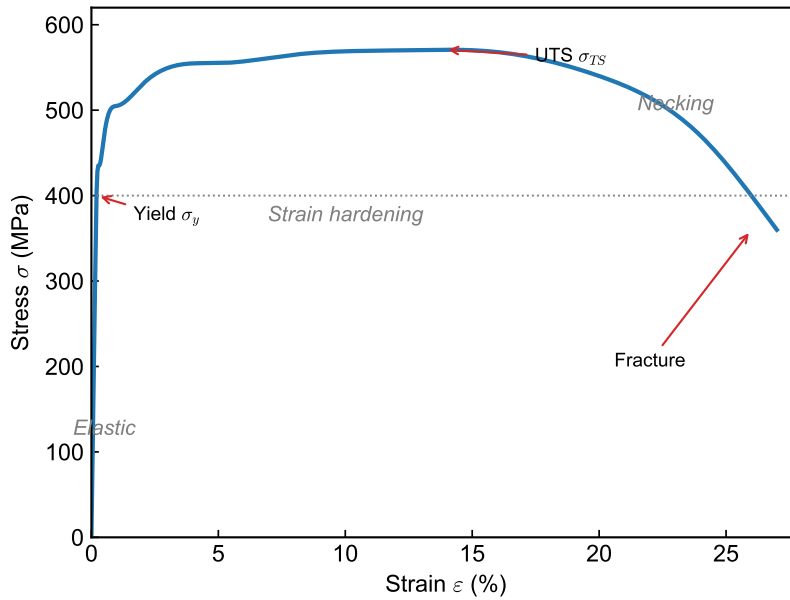
(one figure per key concept)

**Elastic vs. plastic regions.** The elastic region is the straight line whose slope is  $E$ ; beyond yield the curve bends over into permanent (plastic) deformation.

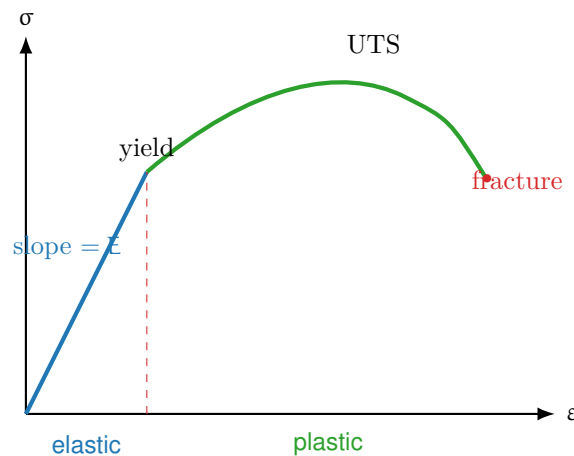
**Yield by 0.2% offset.** When yield is gradual, draw a line parallel to the elastic slope starting at  $\epsilon = 0.002$ ; its intersection with the curve defines  $\sigma_y$ .

**Engineering vs. true stress–strain.** Engineering stress uses the fixed  $A_0$  and falls after UTS; true stress uses the instantaneous area  $A_i$  and keeps rising to fracture.

**Ductility geometry (%EL and %RA).** %EL compares gauge length before and after; %RA compares cross-sectional area before and at the neck.

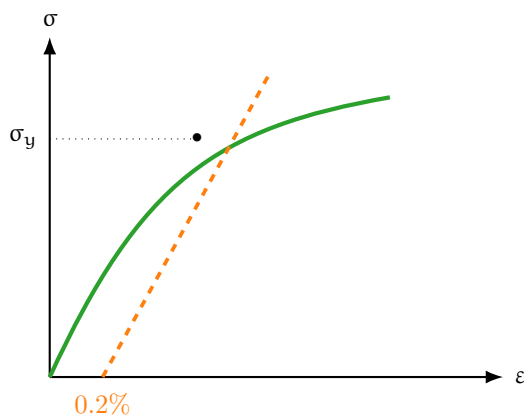


**Figure 6.1.** Figure 6.1 — Engineering stress–strain curve: elastic region, yield point, ultimate tensile strength, necking, and fracture. Area under the curve is toughness.

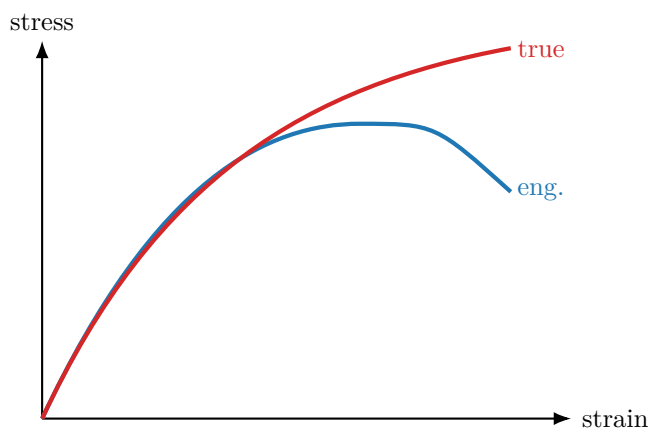


**Figure 6.2.** Figure 6.2 — Elastic (linear, recoverable) vs. plastic (curved, permanent) deformation.

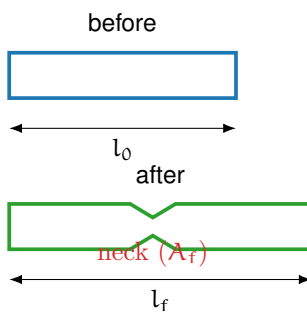




**Figure 6.3.** Figure 6.3 — 0.2% offset construction for yield strength.



**Figure 6.4.** Figure 6.4 — Engineering curve (drops after necking) vs. true curve (rises to fracture).



**Figure 6.5.** Figure 6.5 — %EL from gauge length change; %RA from cross-section reduction at the neck.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **E (Young's modulus):** slope of elastic line; steels  $\approx 207$  GPa, Al  $\approx 69$  GPa, Cu  $\approx 110$  GPa.
- **Poisson's ratio  $\nu$ :** metals  $\approx 0.33$ ; range 0.25–0.35.
- $\sigma_y$ : onset of plastic flow (use 0.2% offset if gradual).
- **UTS:** peak of the engineering curve; necking starts here.
- **Toughness** = area under whole curve; **Resilience** =  $\sigma_y^2/2E$  = area under elastic part.
- **Ductility:** %EL and %RA; report gauge length (50 mm standard).
- **Hardness–strength (steels):**  $\sigma_{TS}$  (MPa)  $\approx 3.45 \times \text{HB}$ .

## 7. Compare Box

### Elastic vs. Plastic Deformation

| Elastic                                 | Plastic                           |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Recoverable; bar returns to $l_0$       | Permanent; bar stays deformed     |
| Linear, $\sigma = E\varepsilon$ (Hooke) | Nonlinear, strain hardening       |
| Bond stretching only                    | Atomic planes slip (dislocations) |
| Below $\sigma_y$                        | Above $\sigma_y$                  |

### Engineering vs. True Stress–Strain

| Engineering                                     | True                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| $\sigma = F/A_0$ , $\varepsilon = \Delta l/l_0$ | $\sigma_T = F/A_i$ , $\varepsilon_T = \ln(l_i/l_0)$ |
| Uses fixed original area                        | Uses instantaneous area                             |
| Curve drops after UTS                           | Curve rises to fracture                             |
| Design/reporting standard                       | Physically accurate; $\sigma_T = K\varepsilon_T^n$  |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Using  $A_i$  with engineering stress. Why:** engineering stress is defined with  $A_0$ ; only true stress uses instantaneous area.
- **Confusing UTS with fracture strength. Why:** UTS is the peak; fracture occurs later at lower *engineering* stress after necking.
- **Forgetting the offset. Why:** many metals have no sharp yield;  $\sigma_y$  needs the 0.2% offset line.
- **Reporting %EL without gauge length. Why:** elongation localizes at the neck, so %EL depends on  $l_0$ .
- **Mixing up stiffness and strength. Why:**  $E$  (stiffness) and  $\sigma_y$  (strength) are independent; a stiff metal can be weak.
- **Applying  $3.45 \times HB$  to all materials. Why:** the hardness–strength factor is calibrated for steels only.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                                  | Meaning                 | Units               | Variables                         | Assump-<br>tions    | Limitations           | Eng.<br>meaning            |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| $\sigma = F/A_0$                                         | Engineering stress      | MPa                 | F load, $A_0$ orig. area          | Uniform, axial load | Ignores area change   | Design stress vs. strength |
| $\epsilon = \Delta l/l_0$                                | Engineering strain      | —                   | $\Delta l$ , $l_0$ gauge          | Uniform strain      | Only pre-necking      | How much it stretches      |
| $E = \sigma/\epsilon$                                    | Young's modulus (Hooke) | GPa                 | $\sigma$ , $\epsilon$             | Elastic, linear     | Below $\sigma_y$ only | Stiffness of material      |
| $\nu = -\epsilon_{\text{trans}}/\epsilon_{\text{axial}}$ | Poisson's ratio         | —                   | lateral/axial strain              | Elastic, isotropic  | Metals $\approx 0.33$ | Lateral contraction        |
| $\sigma_T = \sigma(1 + \epsilon)$                        | True stress             | MPa                 | $\sigma$ , $\epsilon$ eng. values | Constant volume     | Valid to necking      | Real stress on atoms       |
| $\epsilon_T = \ln(1 + \epsilon)$                         | True strain             | —                   | $\epsilon$ eng. strain            | Constant volume     | Valid to necking      | Cumulative strain          |
| $\%EL = \frac{\Delta l}{l_0} \times 100$                 | Percent elongation      | %                   | $\Delta l$ , $l_0$                | Report $l_0$        | Gauge dependent       | Ductility measure          |
| $\%RA = \frac{A_0 - A_f}{A_0} \times 100$                | Percent area reduction  | %                   | $A_0$ , $A_f$ neck                | Round section       | Needs neck area       | Ductility (local)          |
| $HB = \frac{2P}{\pi D(D - \sqrt{D^2 - d^2})}$            | Brinell hardness        | kgf/mm <sup>2</sup> | P load, D ball, d indent          | Standard ball/load  | Not thin/hard parts   | Fast strength proxy        |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Example

**Problem:** A rod of  $E = 200$  GPa carries  $\sigma = 400$  MPa elastically. Find the strain.

**Thinking:** Below yield, use Hooke's law  $\varepsilon = \sigma/E$ ; keep units consistent (MPa/MPa).

**Solution:**

$$\varepsilon = \frac{\sigma}{E} = \frac{400 \times 10^6}{200 \times 10^9} = 0.002.$$

### Intermediate

#### Example

**Problem:** A steel bar ( $A_0 = 100 \text{ mm}^2$ ) is loaded to  $F = 50$  kN at engineering strain  $\varepsilon = 0.10$ . Find engineering stress, true stress, and true strain.

**Thinking:** Engineering stress uses  $A_0$ ; then convert with  $\sigma_T = \sigma(1 + \varepsilon)$  and  $\varepsilon_T = \ln(1 + \varepsilon)$ .

**Solution:**

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma &= \frac{50\,000}{100 \times 10^{-6}} = 500 \text{ MPa}, \\ \sigma_T &= 500(1 + 0.10) = 550 \text{ MPa}, \\ \varepsilon_T &= \ln(1.10) = 0.0953.\end{aligned}$$

## Advanced

### Example

**Problem:** A steel has  $\sigma_y = 500$  MPa and  $E = 200$  GPa. Find the modulus of resilience, and estimate  $\sigma_{TS}$  if its Brinell hardness is  $HB = 250$ .

**Thinking:** Resilience is the elastic-triangle area  $U_r = \sigma_y^2/2E$ . For steels, use  $\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 \times HB$ .

**Solution:**

$$U_r = \frac{\sigma_y^2}{2E} = \frac{(500 \times 10^6)^2}{2(200 \times 10^9)} = 0.625 \text{ MJ/m}^3,$$

$$\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 \times 250 = 862 \text{ MPa.}$$

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Designers rarely load a part to its tensile strength — they load it below yield, protected by a safety factor  $N$  ( $\sigma_{\text{working}} = \sigma_y/N$ , with  $N \approx 1.5\text{--}4$ ). The choice between two metals is a trade-off: high strength buys thinner, lighter parts, but usually costs ductility and toughness, so a component may fail suddenly instead of bending as a warning. Toughness (area under the curve) is what absorbs impact in a car crash box, while stiffness ( $E$ ) — not strength — controls how much a beam deflects. Understanding which property governs a given failure mode is the core engineering skill this chapter teaches.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Automotive crash structures:** high-toughness steels absorb impact energy by plastic deformation.
- **Aerospace:** high specific-strength Al and Ti alloys minimize weight while meeting yield limits.
- **Quality control:** portable hardness testers estimate  $\sigma_{TS}$  on the shop floor without destroying parts.
- **Metal forming:** the strain-hardening exponent  $n$  ( $\sigma_T = K\varepsilon_T^n$ ) sets how far sheet can stretch before necking in stamping.
- **Fasteners:** bolt grades are specified directly by proof stress and  $\sigma_{TS}$ .

## 13. Summary

The tensile test converts load and elongation into an engineering stress–strain curve that encodes a material’s mechanical identity. The linear elastic region gives stiffness through Hooke’s law,  $\sigma = E\varepsilon$ , with lateral contraction set by Poisson’s ratio. Yielding marks the elastic–plastic boundary, found by the 0.2% offset when gradual; the curve then rises to the ultimate tensile strength, necks, and fractures. Ductility (%EL, %RA) measures stretch before failure, while toughness is the total area absorbed and resilience the elastic part  $\sigma_y^2/2E$ . Because engineering values ignore the shrinking cross-section, true stress and strain correct them for accurate plastic-region work. Finally, hardness offers a quick, near-nondestructive strength estimate: for steels,  $\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 \times \text{HB}$ . The single most important equation is  $\sigma = E\varepsilon$ .

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. The slope of the elastic region equals \_\_\_\_\_.
2. True / False: necking begins at the yield point.
3. Yield strength for a gradual curve is found by the \_\_\_\_\_% offset.
4. True / False: true stress is always greater than engineering stress in tension.
5. Toughness is the \_\_\_\_\_ under the stress-strain curve.
6. For steels,  $\sigma_{TS} \approx \text{_____} \times \text{HB}$ .

## 15. Practice Problems

- ★ A material with  $E = 200 \text{ GPa}$  is stressed to  $\sigma = 400 \text{ MPa}$  elastically. Compute the elastic strain. (p. 146)
- ★ State where necking begins on the engineering stress-strain curve and why. (p. 146)
- ★★ A copper rod at  $\sigma = 300 \text{ MPa}$ ,  $\varepsilon = 0.05$  — find its true stress and true strain. (p. 146)
- ★★ A specimen ( $l_0 = 50 \text{ mm}$ ,  $A_0 = 90 \text{ mm}^2$ ) fractures at  $l_f = 63 \text{ mm}$ ,  $A_f = 42 \text{ mm}^2$ . Compute %EL and %RA. (p. 146)
- ★★★ Steel with  $\sigma_y = 500 \text{ MPa}$  and  $E = 200 \text{ GPa}$ : compute the modulus of resilience in  $\text{MJ/m}^3$ . (p. 146)
- ★★★ A Brinell test uses  $P = 3000 \text{ kgf}$ ,  $D = 10 \text{ mm}$ , giving  $d = 3.2 \text{ mm}$ . Compute HB and estimate  $\sigma_{TS}$  for steel. (p. 146)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does Young's modulus  $E$  represent, and how is it read from the curve?

---

**Back:** Stiffness (resistance to elastic deformation); it is the slope of the linear elastic region,  $E = \sigma/\epsilon$ .

### Flash Card

**Front:** How is yield strength found when there is no sharp yield point?

---

**Back:** 0.2% offset method: draw a line parallel to the elastic slope from  $\epsilon = 0.002$ ; its intersection with the curve is  $\sigma_y$ .

### Flash Card

**Front:** Engineering vs. true stress after UTS — which rises, which falls?

---

**Back:** Engineering stress falls (fixed  $A_0$ ); true stress keeps rising because it uses the shrinking instantaneous area  $A_i$ .

### Flash Card

**Front:** Convert engineering to true values.

---

**Back:**  $\sigma_T = \sigma(1 + \epsilon)$  and  $\epsilon_T = \ln(1 + \epsilon)$ , valid up to the onset of necking.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Define toughness and resilience in terms of the curve.

---

**Back:** Toughness = total area under the whole curve (energy to fracture).  
Resilience = area under the elastic part =  $\sigma_y^2/2E$ .



**Flash Card**

**Front:** Give the two ductility measures and their formulas.

**Back:**  $\%EL = \frac{l_f - l_0}{l_0} \times 100$  and  $\%RA = \frac{A_0 - A_f}{A_0} \times 100$ .

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Hardness–strength rule for steels?

**Back:**  $\sigma_{TS} \text{ (MPa)} \approx 3.45 \times HB$  — calibrated for steels only, not all metals.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is Poisson’s ratio and its typical metal value?

**Back:**  $\nu = -\epsilon_{\text{trans}}/\epsilon_{\text{axial}}$ , the ratio of lateral contraction to axial extension;  $\approx 0.33$  for metals.

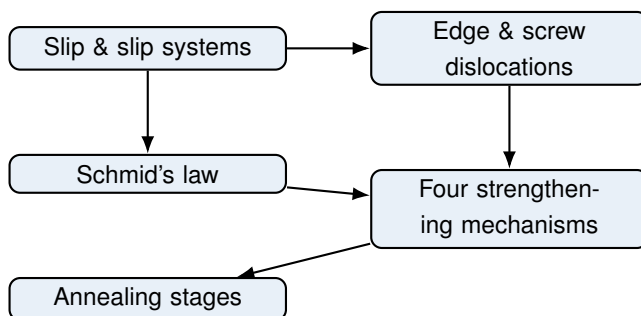
**17. Cheat Sheet****Cheat Sheet**

- **Stress/strain:**  $\sigma = F/A_0$ ,  $\epsilon = \Delta l/l_0$ .
- **Elastic:**  $\sigma = E\epsilon$ ; shear  $\tau = G\gamma$ ;  $E = 2G(1 + \nu)$ ;  $\nu \approx 0.33$ .
- **Yield:**  $\sigma_y$  at 0.2% offset. **UTS:** peak; necking starts here.
- **True:**  $\sigma_T = \sigma(1 + \epsilon)$ ,  $\epsilon_T = \ln(1 + \epsilon)$ ; plastic  $\sigma_T = K\epsilon_T^n$ .
- **Ductility:**  $\%EL = \frac{\Delta l}{l_0} \times 100$ ,  $\%RA = \frac{A_0 - A_f}{A_0} \times 100$ .
- **Energy:** toughness  $= \int \sigma d\epsilon$ ; resilience  $= \sigma_y^2/2E$ .
- **Hardness:**  $HB = \frac{2P}{\pi D(D - \sqrt{D^2 - d^2})}$ ; steels  $\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 HB$ .
- **Typical E:** steel 207, Cu 110, Al 69 GPa.

# Chapter 7

## Dislocations and Strengthening Mechanisms

### 1. Roadmap



Plastic deformation is carried by dislocations. We first learn how slip proceeds on close-packed planes and directions, then quantify the resolved shear stress with Schmid's law. Four mechanisms (grain-size, solid-solution, strain hardening, and precipitation) all strengthen a metal by impeding dislocation motion. Finally we examine how heating a cold-worked metal reverses the damage through recovery, recrystallization, and grain growth.

### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Slip systems** — Count the number of slip systems for FCC, BCC, and HCP and state their plane/direction families.
2. **Schmid's law** — Compute the resolved shear stress  $\tau_R$  and the tensile yield stress  $\sigma_y$  for a given crystal orientation.
3. **Dislocation types** — Distinguish edge, screw, and mixed dislocations by their Burgers vector geometry.
4. **Four mechanisms** — Explain grain-size, solid-solution, strain-hardening, and precipitation strengthening and write their governing relations.
5. **Hall–Petch** — Use  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$  to predict the grain-size effect.
6. **Annealing** — Describe recovery, recrystallization, and grain growth and the factors controlling  $T_{rx}$ .

### 3. Why This Matters

This chapter is the heart of mechanical behavior and carries heavy weight on undergraduate finals, the FE/PE exams, and graduate entrance tests. Every structural metal you rely on – steel in a bridge, aluminium in an aircraft skin, titanium in an implant – owes its strength to deliberately engineered dislocation obstacles. Understanding these mechanisms lets you choose a material and a heat treatment instead of guessing, and it explains the universal strength versus ductility trade-off that governs formability and failure.

### 4. Intuition First

#### Intuition First

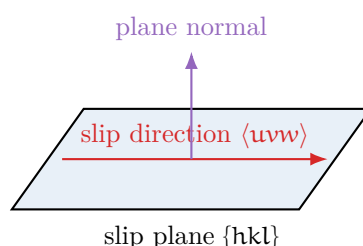
Imagine a carpet that you want to slide across a floor. Pushing the whole carpet at once is hard. But if you bunch a small ripple into it and then walk that ripple across the carpet, the carpet moves one section at a time with very little force. A dislocation is that ripple: a line defect that lets a crystal deform piece by piece rather than all at once.

Strength, then, is simply how hard it is to move that ripple. Throw in walls (grain boundaries), obstacles (solute atoms, second-phase particles), or tangle the ripples together (more dislocations), and the ripple gets stuck – the metal gets stronger. The price you pay is that a stuck ripple also makes the metal less able to deform further, so it becomes less ductile.

### 5. Visual

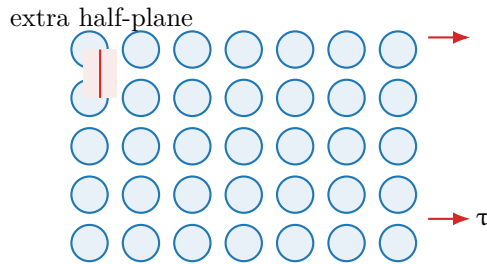
(one figure per key concept)

**Slip plane and slip direction.** A slip system is the combination of a slip plane and a slip direction lying in that plane. Shear translates the top of the crystal along the slip direction.



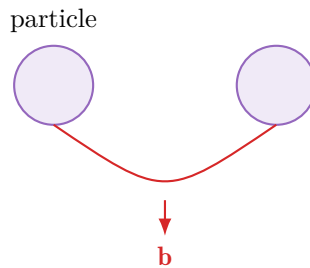
**Figure 7.1.** Figure 7.1 — A slip system: a close-packed plane and a close-packed direction within it.

**Edge dislocation motion under shear.** An edge dislocation is an extra half-plane of atoms. Shear stress pushes the half-plane sideways; as it advances one lattice spacing the crystal has slipped.



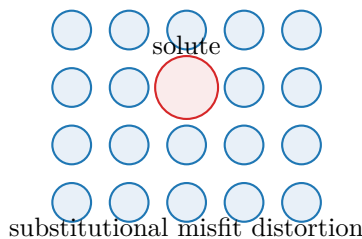
**Figure 7.2.** Figure 7.2 — An edge dislocation (extra half-plane, red) moves under applied shear, producing slip.

**Orowan bypass of hard particles.** When a particle is too strong to cut, the dislocation bows around it and leaves a dislocation loop behind. The required stress grows as particle spacing shrinks.

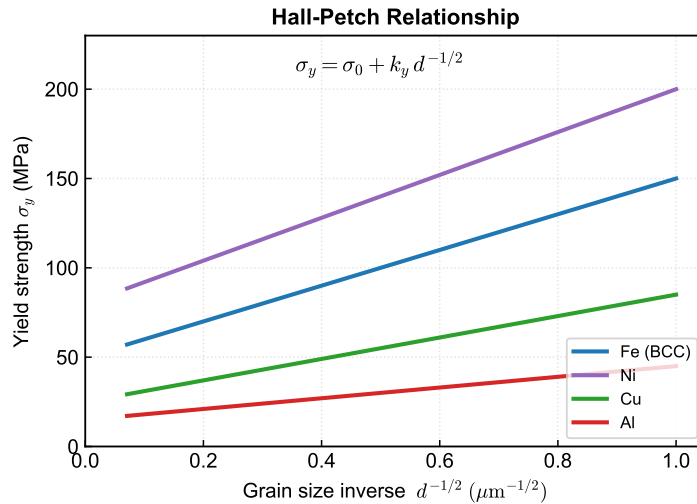


**Figure 7.3.** Figure 7.3 — Orowan looping: the dislocation bows between closely spaced hard precipitates.

**Solid-solution distortion.** A solute atom of different size distorts the surrounding lattice, creating a strain field that interacts with passing dislocations.



**Figure 7.4.** Figure 7.4 — A larger solute atom strains the lattice and pins dislocations.



**Figure 7.5.** Figure 7.5 — Yield strength rises as grain size  $d$  decreases, following  $\sigma_y \propto d^{-1/2}$ .

**Hall–Petch effect.**

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **FCC:** 4  $\{111\}$  planes  $\times$  3  $\langle 110 \rangle$  directions = **12** slip systems.
- **BCC:**  $\{110\}, \{112\}, \{123\}$  with  $\langle 111 \rangle$  = **48** slip systems.
- **HCP:** only  $\{0001\}$  basal with  $\langle 11\bar{2}0 \rangle$  = **3** slip systems (limited ductility).
- **Edge dislocation:**  $\mathbf{b}$  perpendicular to the dislocation line.
- **Screw dislocation:**  $\mathbf{b}$  parallel to the dislocation line.
- **Schmid factor:**  $m = \cos \phi \cos \lambda$ ; max  $m = 0.5$  at  $\phi = \lambda = 45^\circ$ .
- **All four mechanisms** strengthen by *impeding dislocation motion*.
- **Recovery**  $\sim 0.3T_m$ , **recrystallization**  $\sim 0.4T_m$ , **grain growth**  $> 0.5T_m$ .

## 7. Compare Box

### Edge vs Screw vs Mixed Dislocations

| Relation of $\mathbf{b}$ to line                  | Motion / character                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edge: $\mathbf{b} \perp$ line (extra half-plane)  | Glides only in its slip plane; climb needs diffusion.        |
| Screw: $\mathbf{b} \parallel$ line (helical ramp) | Glides on any plane containing the line; enables cross-slip. |
| Mixed: angle between $\mathbf{b}$ and line        | Combination; most real dislocations are mixed.               |

### Cutting vs Orowan Bypass of Particles

| Shear / cutting regime                | Orowan bypass regime                  |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Small, coherent particles             | Large, incoherent particles           |
| Dislocation cuts through the particle | Dislocation bows around, leaves loops |
| Strength rises with particle size     | Strength falls as particles coarsen   |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Mistake 1:** Measuring  $\phi$  and  $\lambda$  from each other. **Why:** Both angles are measured from the *tensile axis*; they lie in different planes.
- **Mistake 2:** Assuming HCP is as ductile as FCC. **Why:** HCP has only 3 slip systems, so it deforms on few planes and is brittle at room temperature.
- **Mistake 3:** Believing smaller grains always help. **Why:** Below  $\sim 1 \mu\text{m}$  grain-boundary sliding dominates and Hall–Petch can invert.
- **Mistake 4:** Treating recrystallization temperature as a fixed constant. **Why:** It depends on cold-work amount, purity, and time ( $T_{rx} \approx 0.4T_m$  is only a rule of thumb).
- **Mistake 5:** Forgetting cold work trades strength for ductility. **Why:** Strain hardening raises  $\sigma_y$  but lowers the uniform elongation.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                  | Meaning                     | Units | Variables                         | Assump-<br>tions                     | Limitations                    | Eng.<br>meaning             |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| $\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda$ | Resolved shear stress       | MPa   | $\sigma, \phi, \lambda$           | Single slip system, uniaxial tension | One active system only         | Drives slip in a crystal    |
| $\sigma_y = \tau_{CRSS} / m$             | Tensile yield of crystal    | MPa   | $m = \cos \phi \cos \lambda$      | Schmid factor known                  | No work hardening              | Orientation sets yield      |
| $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$     | Hall–Petch relation         | MPa   | $d$ grain size                    | Polycrystal, $d$ uniform             | Breaks for $d < 1 \mu\text{m}$ | Finer grains = stronger     |
| $\sigma_T = K \epsilon_T^n$              | Hollomon (strain hardening) | MPa   | $n$ exponent, $K$ coeff.          | Isotropic, monotonic tension         | Pre-necking only               | Higher $n$ = more formable  |
| $\tau = G b / L$                         | Orowan bypass stress        | MPa   | $L$ particle spacing, $b$ Burgers | Hard, non-shearable particles        | Not for cutting regime         | Closer particles = stronger |

## 10. Worked Examples

## Basic

## Example

**Problem:** A single crystal has  $\phi = 50^\circ$  and  $\lambda = 40^\circ$ , with  $\tau_{\text{CRSS}} = 1.0$  MPa. Find the Schmid factor and the tensile yield stress.

**Thinking:** Schmid's law separates the orientation (through  $m$ ) from the material resistance ( $\tau_{\text{CRSS}}$ ). Compute  $m$  first, then invert.

**Solution:**

$$m = \cos 50^\circ \cos 40^\circ = 0.643 \times 0.766 = 0.493,$$

$$\sigma_y = \frac{\tau_{\text{CRSS}}}{m} = \frac{1.0}{0.493} = 2.03 \text{ MPa.}$$

## Intermediate

## Example

**Problem:** Steel:  $\sigma_0 = 100$  MPa,  $k_y = 0.74 \text{ MPa} \cdot \text{m}^{1/2}$ . Compare yield strength at  $d = 50 \text{ } \mu\text{m}$  and  $d = 5 \text{ } \mu\text{m}$ .

**Thinking:** Convert  $d$  to metres, then apply Hall–Petch. Smaller  $d$  means larger  $d^{-1/2}$ , hence higher strength.

**Solution:**

$$d = 50 \text{ } \mu\text{m} : \sigma_y = 100 + 0.74/(50 \times 10^{-6})^{1/2} = 100 + 105 = 205 \text{ MPa,}$$

$$d = 5 \text{ } \mu\text{m} : \sigma_y = 100 + 0.74/(5 \times 10^{-6})^{1/2} = 100 + 331 = 431 \text{ MPa.}$$

Halving the grain size does not double strength; the square-root law gives a diminishing return.



## Advanced

### Example

**Problem:** A cold-worked metal follows  $\sigma_T = K\varepsilon_T^n$  with  $n = 0.4$  and  $K = 800$  MPa. Compare true stress at  $\varepsilon_T = 0.1$  and  $\varepsilon_T = 0.3$ . Which is more formable, this or a metal with  $n = 0.15$ ?

**Thinking:** Hollomon is a power law: higher  $n$  raises stress more slowly with strain, so the material can be stretched further before necking.

**Solution:**

$$\varepsilon_T = 0.1 : \sigma_T = 800(0.1)^{0.4} = 800 \times 0.398 = 318 \text{ MPa},$$

$$\varepsilon_T = 0.3 : \sigma_T = 800(0.3)^{0.4} = 800 \times 0.618 = 494 \text{ MPa}.$$

The  $n = 0.4$  metal (FCC-like) is far more formable than the  $n = 0.15$  (BCC-like) one; deep drawing favours high  $n$ .

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Hall–Petch explains why nanocrystalline alloys can reach strengths above 1 GPa, yet also why they can fail by grain-boundary sliding rather than dislocation glide. Engineers exploit the square-root law with diminishing returns: cutting grain size from 50 to 5  $\mu\text{m}$  nearly doubles yield strength, but another decade of refinement costs far more processing for little gain and risks brittleness. That is why real alloys *stack* mechanisms – fine grains plus precipitation plus solid solution – rather than pushing any single one to its limit.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Al–Cu (2xxx series) aerospace alloy:** solution-treat at 550°C, quench, age at 160–190°C so coherent  $\theta''$  and  $\theta'$  precipitates give peak strength; overaging to incoherent  $\theta$  ( $\text{CuAl}_2$ ) weakens it.
- **Steel:** combine grain refinement (normalizing), C/Mn solid solution, carbide precipitation, and cold rolling to reach  $\sim 800$  MPa total strengthening.
- **Brass:** Zn substitutionally dissolved in Cu for solid-solution strengthening of cartridge cases.
- **Sheet forming:** high- $n$  FCC metals (Cu, Al, austenitic stainless) are chosen for deep drawing because they strain-harden without necking.
- **Annealing of cold-rolled sheet:** recrystallization relieves hardness and restores ductility before further forming.

## 13. Summary

Plastic deformation proceeds by dislocation glide on slip systems: FCC (12), BCC (48), and HCP (3). Schmid's law,  $\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda$ , predicts when a given orientation yields. All four strengthening mechanisms – grain-size reduction (Hall–Petch,  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ ), solid-solution strengthening (strain-field pinning), strain hardening ( $\sigma_T = K \epsilon_T^n$ ), and precipitation hardening (shearing or Orowan bypass) – raise strength by blocking dislocation motion, at the cost of ductility. Heating a cold-worked metal reverses the damage through recovery ( $\sim 0.3T_m$ ), recrystallization ( $\sim 0.4T_m$ ), and grain growth ( $> 0.5T_m$ ). The single most important equation is the Hall–Petch relation: **finer grains are stronger**.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. FCC crystals have \_\_\_\_\_ slip systems; HCP have \_\_\_\_\_.
2. True / False: The maximum Schmid factor is 0.5 when  $\phi = \lambda = 45^\circ$ .
3. Fill in: Hall–Petch is  $\sigma_y = \text{_____} + k_y d^{-1/2}$ .
4. True / False: Recrystallization fully restores the original strength and ductility.
5. Order the annealing stages from lowest to highest temperature: \_\_\_\_\_.
6. True / False: Interstitial carbon strengthens Fe about 100× more per atom than substitutional Mn.

## 15. Practice Problems

★ According to Schmid's law, the resolved shear stress  $\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda$  is maximized for a fixed  $\sigma$  when:

- (a)  $\phi = 90^\circ, \lambda = 0^\circ$
- (b)  $\phi = 45^\circ, \lambda = 45^\circ$
- (c)  $\phi = 0^\circ, \lambda = 90^\circ$
- (d)  $\phi = 30^\circ, \lambda = 60^\circ$

(p. 147)

★ How many slip systems does an FCC metal possess?

- (a) 3
- (b) 12
- (c) 48
- (d) 4

(p. 147)

★★ Using Hall–Petch with  $\sigma_0 = 100 \text{ MPa}$  and  $k_y = 0.74 \text{ MPa} \cdot \text{m}^{1/2}$ , decreasing grain size from 10  $\mu\text{m}$  to 2.5  $\mu\text{m}$  increases yield strength by approximately what factor?

- (a)  $\sqrt{2}$

- (b) 2
- (c) 4
- (d) 10

(p. 147)

★★ During annealing of a cold-worked metal, which stage causes complete restoration of original strength and ductility?

- (a) Recovery
- (b) Recrystallization
- (c) Grain growth
- (d) All three equally

(p. 147)

★★★ Precipitation hardening in Al–Cu is most effective when particles are:

- (a) Very large and widely spaced
- (b) Small, coherent, and closely spaced
- (c) Fully dissolved in the matrix
- (d) Located only at grain boundaries

(p. 147)

★★★ Which material is expected to have the highest strain-hardening exponent  $n$ ?

- (a) Fully annealed copper (FCC)
- (b) Tungsten (BCC)
- (c) Magnesium (HCP)
- (d) Glass

(p. 147)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is a slip system?

---

**Back:** A slip plane combined with a slip direction within that plane; the combination on which dislocation glide occurs.

## Flash Card

**Front:** State Schmid's law and define  $m$ .

**Back:**  $\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda = \sigma m$ , where  $m$  (the Schmid factor) is  $\cos \phi \cos \lambda$ , the orientation factor for a given slip system.

## Flash Card

**Front:** What does Hall-Petch say?

**Back:**  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ : yield strength increases as grain size  $d$  decreases.

## Flash Card

**Front:** Edge vs screw dislocation?

**Back:** Edge:  $\mathbf{b}$  is perpendicular to the line (extra half-plane). Screw:  $\mathbf{b}$  is parallel to the line (helical ramp).

## Flash Card

**Front:** What is Orowan bypass?

**Back:** When precipitates are too hard to cut, the dislocation bows around them, leaving loops; the stress  $\tau = Gb/L$  rises as particle spacing  $L$  shrinks.

## Flash Card

**Front:** Recovery vs recrystallization vs grain growth?

**Back:** Recovery ( $\sim 0.3T_m$ ): dislocation rearrangement. Recrystallization ( $\sim 0.4T_m$ ): new strain-free grains, full softening. Grain growth ( $> 0.5T_m$ ): grains coarsen, slight weakening.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

### Cheat Sheet

**Slip systems:** FCC 12 =  $\{111\}\langle 110 \rangle$ ; BCC 48 =  $\{110/112/123\}\langle 111 \rangle$ ; HCP 3 =  $\{0001\}\langle 11\bar{2}0 \rangle$ .

**Schmid:**  $\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda = \sigma m$ ;  $\sigma_y = \tau_{CRSS}/m$ ; max  $m = 0.5$  at  $45^\circ/45^\circ$ .

**Hall–Petch:**  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ . Finer grains  $\rightarrow$  stronger (saturates  $d < 1 \mu\text{m}$ ).

**Solid solution:** solute strain field pins dislocations;  $\Delta\sigma \propto G\epsilon^{3/2}\sqrt{c}$ ; interstitial C  $\sim 100\times$  Mn per atom.

**Strain hardening:**  $\sigma_T = K\epsilon_T^n$ ; FCC  $n = 0.3\text{--}0.5$ , BCC  $0.15\text{--}0.25$ , HCP  $< 0.1$ .

**Precipitation:** cutting (coherent, small) vs Orowan (incoherent, large); Al–Cu peak at  $\theta''/\theta'$ , overage to  $\theta$ .

**Annealing:** recovery  $\sim 0.3T_m \rightarrow$  recrystallization  $\sim 0.4T_m \rightarrow$  grain growth  $> 0.5T_m$ .

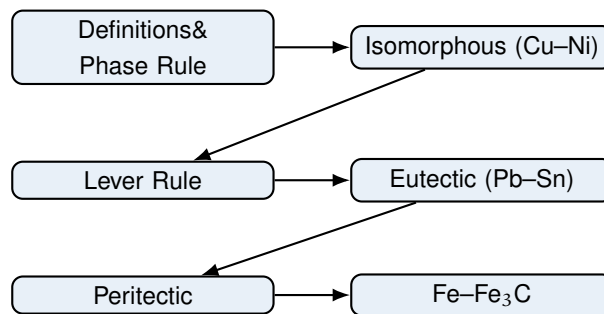
**Big idea:** every mechanism blocks dislocation motion  $\rightarrow$  stronger but less ductile.

# Chapter 8

## Phase Diagrams

### 1. Roadmap

A phase diagram is the map that tells an engineer what phases exist, what they are made of, and how much of each is present at any temperature and overall composition. This chapter builds from the simplest possible case upward to the iron-carbon system that underpins all steel.



### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Define** the terms phase, component, solubility limit, and microstructure, and state the Gibbs phase rule  $F = C - P + 2$  (or  $C - P + 1$  at fixed pressure).
2. **Read** a binary isomorphous diagram (Cu–Ni): locate liquidus, solidus, and the two-phase field, and name the phases present.
3. **Apply** the lever rule to compute the mass fractions of each phase from a tie line.
4. **Recognize** the eutectic reaction ( $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$ ) in Pb–Sn and the peritectic reaction ( $L + \delta \rightarrow \gamma$ ).
5. **Navigate** the Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C diagram: identify the peritectic, eutectic, and eutectoid invariant points and the resulting microconstituents (ferrite, austenite, cementite, pearlite, ledeburite).
6. **Compute** phase fractions and microconstituent fractions in hypoeutectoid and hypereutectoid steels.

### 3. Why This Matters

Phase diagrams are the single most frequently tested topic on undergraduate materials exams and on FE/PE metallurgy sections, and they are the foundation for heat-treatment and alloy-design problems. In real engineering, every casting, weld, braze, and heat treatment follows a path across one or more phase diagrams. A steel that is quenched, a solder joint that is melted, and a turbine blade that is directionally solidified are all governed by the phase boundaries you learn here. If you can read a diagram and run the lever rule, you can predict microstructure, and microstructure predicts properties. Mastery here repays itself in nearly every later chapter on mechanical behavior, phase transformations, and processing.

### 4. Intuition First

#### Intuition First

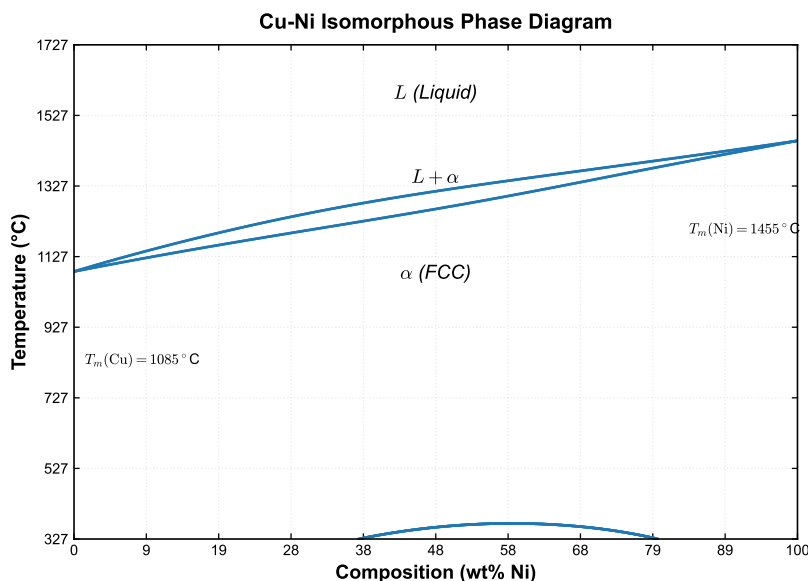
Imagine a crowded dance floor (the liquid) where everyone is free to move. As the room cools, dancers pair off and lock into a tidy grid (the solid). In an *isomorphous* system the two atoms get along so well that the grid can hold any mixture—copper and nickel dissolve in each other at every ratio. In a *eutectic* system they do not get along: at one special cool temperature the liquid breaks up into two separate, neatly layered solids at once, like oil and water freezing side by side.

The *lever rule* is just a seesaw. Picture a balance beam on a fulcrum placed at the overall composition  $C_0$ . The ends of the beam are the two phase compositions  $C_\alpha$  and  $C_\beta$ . The heavier the load you want at the right end, the closer the fulcrum must sit to that end. The fraction of each phase is simply how much beam sits on the opposite side of the fulcrum.

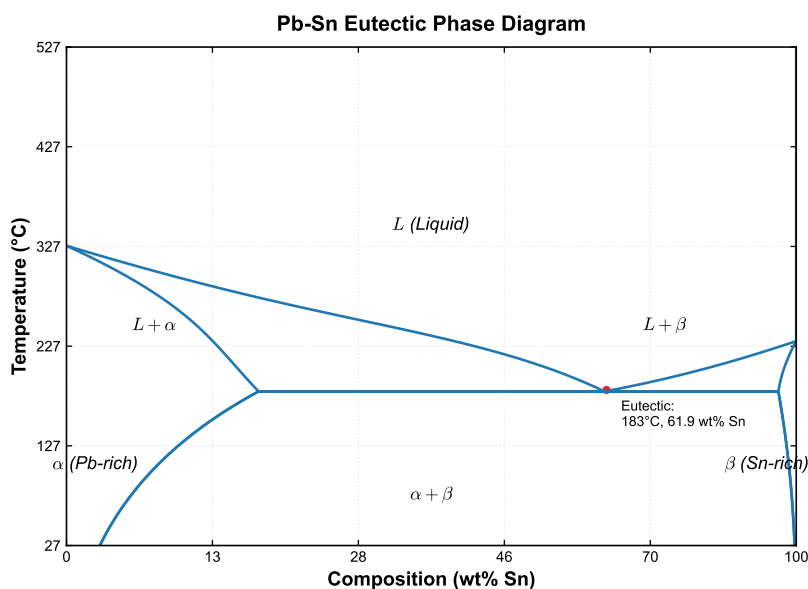
### 5. Visual

(one figure per key concept)

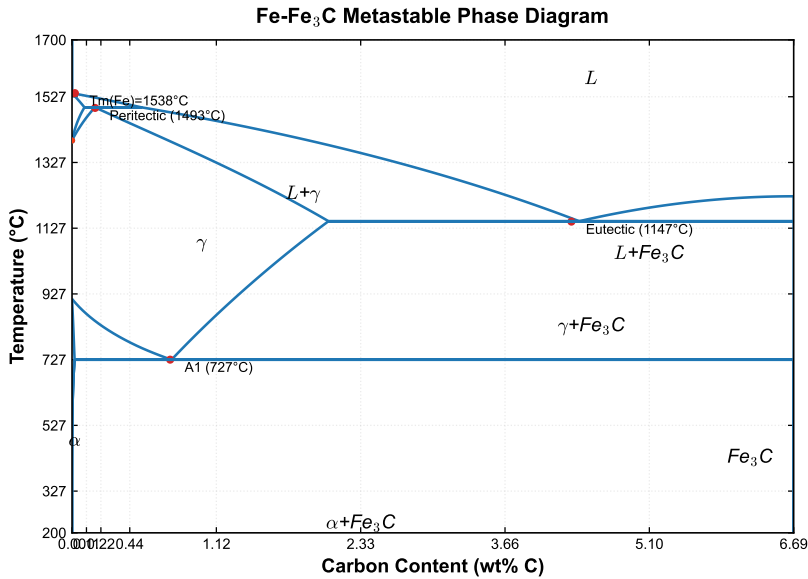




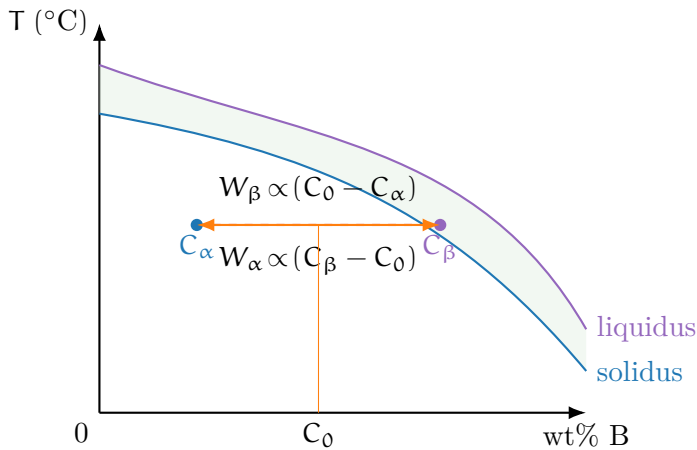
**Figure 8.1.** Figure 8.1 — Cu–Ni isomorphous diagram. Above the liquidus only liquid *L* exists; below the solidus only solid  $\alpha$  (FCC) exists; between them *L* +  $\alpha$ . Melting points: Cu 1085°C, Ni 1455°C; x-axis is wt% Ni.



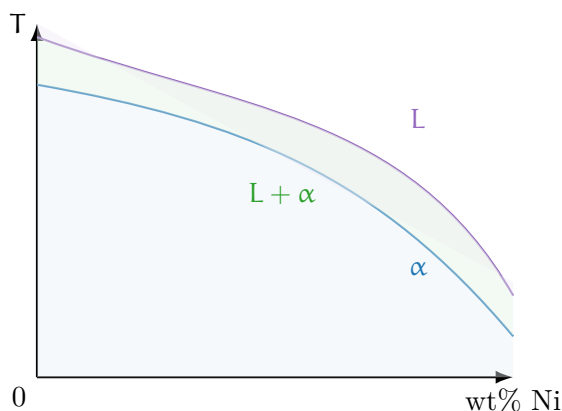
**Figure 8.2.** Figure 8.2 — Pb–Sn eutectic diagram. The eutectic point at 61.9 wt% Sn and 183°C is where  $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$  occurs isothermally. Solvus lines bound the limited solid solubility of each phase.



**Figure 8.3.** Figure 8.3 — Fe-Fe<sub>3</sub>C metastable diagram with three invariant reactions: peritectic (P, 1493°C), eutectic (C, 1147°C), and eutectoid (S, 727°C). Cementite Fe<sub>3</sub>C contains 6.67 wt% C.



**Figure 8.4.** Figure 8.4 — Lever rule construction. At fixed T the tie line (dashed) joins the equilibrium phase compositions C<sub>α</sub> and C<sub>β</sub>; the overall composition C<sub>0</sub> divides the lever into arms whose lengths are inversely proportional to the opposite phase mass fraction.



**Figure 8.5.** Figure 8.5 — Isomorphous regions. Above the liquidus: single-phase liquid  $L$ . Below the solidus: single-phase solid  $\alpha$ . Between them: two-phase  $L + \alpha$  where a tie line gives the equilibrium compositions.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **Phase rule:**  $F = C - P + 2$ ; at fixed  $P$ ,  $F = C - P + 1$ .
- **Isomorphous:** complete solid solubility (Cu–Ni). Liquidus = all liquid above; solidus = all solid below.
- **Lever rule:** read  $C_\alpha$  and  $C_\beta$  from the *ends* of the tie line.
- **Eutectic:**  $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$  at fixed  $T$  (Pb–Sn: 61.9 wt% Sn, 183°C).
- **Peritectic:**  $L + \alpha \rightarrow \beta$  (Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C: 1493°C).
- **Eutectoid:**  $\gamma \rightarrow \alpha + \text{Fe}_3\text{C}$  at 727°C gives *pearlite*.
- **Fe<sub>3</sub>C (cementite):** 6.67 wt% C; metastable but the practical diagram.
- **Hypoeutectoid** (< 0.76% C): proeutectoid ferrite + pearlite. **Hyper-eutectoid** (> 0.76% C): proeutectoid cementite + pearlite.

## 7. Compare Box

### Invariant Reactions

| Eutectic                                                                                                                                             | Peritectic                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$<br>Occurs from a <i>liquid</i> only<br><br>Example: Pb–Sn at 61.9 wt% Sn<br>Microstructure: lamellar $\alpha + \beta$ | $L + \alpha \rightarrow \beta$<br>Consumes a <i>liquid</i> + <i>solid</i> to make a new solid<br>Example: Fe–Fe <sub>3</sub> C at 1493°C ( $L + \delta \rightarrow \gamma$ )<br>New phase envelopes the existing phase |
| Eutectoid                                                                                                                                            | Solidus vs Solvus                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| $\gamma \rightarrow \alpha + \text{Fe}_3\text{C}$ (solid state)<br><br>Example: steel at 727°C, 0.76 wt% C<br>Product: pearlite (no liquid involved) | <b>Solidus:</b> boundary of liquid/solid field<br><b>Solvus:</b> limit of solid solubility in a solid phase<br>Found inside single-solid regions (e.g. $\alpha$ in Pb–Sn)                                              |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Mistake 1: Reading compositions from the overall  $C_0$ , not the tie-line ends. Why:** The lever rule uses the phase-boundary compositions  $C_\alpha$  and  $C_\beta$  at the tie-line intersections, never the alloy's overall composition.
- **Mistake 2: Forgetting the phase rule's "2" becomes "1" at fixed pressure. Why:** Materials problems almost always fix  $P$ , so  $F = C - P + 1$ ; using  $+2$  gives the wrong degrees of freedom.
- **Mistake 3: Confusing eutectic, eutectoid, and peritectic. Why:** Eutectic starts from liquid; eutectoid occurs entirely in the solid; peritectic consumes a solid and liquid together.
- **Mistake 4: Treating  $\text{Fe}_3\text{C}$  as the true equilibrium phase. Why:** Graphite is the stable phase; the  $\text{Fe}-\text{Fe}_3\text{C}$  diagram is metastable but used because cementite forms faster.
- **Mistake 5: Using Celsius in thermodynamic formulas that need Kelvin. Why:** Arrhenius-type relations require absolute temperature; always convert before computing.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                                       | Meaning                           | Units         | Variables                                             | Assump-<br>tions                                      | Limitations                  | Eng.<br>meaning                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| $F = C - P + 2$                                               | Degrees of freedom                | —             | C components, P phases                                | Equilibrium; T, P variable                            | Fixed P needs +1 form        | How many variables you may set |
| $W_{\alpha} = \frac{C_{\beta} - C_0}{C_{\beta} - C_{\alpha}}$ | Mass fraction of $\alpha$         | dimensionless | Tie-line ends $C_{\alpha}, C_{\beta}$ ; overall $C_0$ | Two-phase equilibrium                                 | Only in a 2-phase field      | Fraction of one solid phase    |
| $W_{\beta} = \frac{C_0 - C_{\alpha}}{C_{\beta} - C_{\alpha}}$ | Mass fraction of $\beta$          | dimensionless | same as above                                         | Two-phase equilibrium                                 | Only in a 2-phase field      | Fraction of second phase       |
| $W_{\alpha} + W_{\beta} = 1$                                  | Closure check                     | dimensionless | phase fractions                                       | mass conservation                                     | —                            | Always verify the sum          |
| $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$                                | Eutectic reaction                 | —             | phases at eutectic T                                  | Invariant, $F = 0$ at fixed P                         | Only at the eutectic point   | Lamellar two-solid product     |
| $L + \alpha \rightarrow \beta$                                | Peritectic reaction               | —             | phases at peritectic T                                | Invariant, $F = 0$ at fixed P                         | Only at the peritectic point | New solid envelopes old        |
| $W_p = \frac{0.76 - C}{0.76 - 0.022}$                         | Pearlite fraction (hypoeutectoid) | dimensionless | $C_0$ overall wt% C; 0.022 = max ferrite solubility   | Slow cool, lever rule on $\alpha/\text{Fe}_3\text{C}$ | Below eutectoid only         | Microconstituent amount        |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Example

**Problem:** State the Gibbs phase rule value  $F$  for a binary (two-component) alloy in a two-phase region at fixed pressure.

**Thinking:** Use  $F = C - P + 1$  with  $C = 2$  and  $P = 2$ . One variable (temperature) can still be chosen; the phase compositions are then fixed by the boundaries.

**Solution:**

$$F = C - P + 1 = 2 - 2 + 1 = 1.$$

So  $F = 1$ : you may vary  $T$ , but then the phase compositions are locked.

## Intermediate

## Example

**Problem:** For a Cu–Ni alloy with overall composition  $C_0 = 35$  wt% Ni at  $T = 1250^\circ\text{C}$ , the tie line gives  $C_L = 32$  wt% Ni and  $C_S = 43$  wt% Ni. Find the mass fractions of liquid and solid  $\alpha$ .

**Thinking:** Apply the lever rule using the tie-line ends. The solid arm runs from  $C_0$  to  $C_L$ ; the liquid arm runs from  $C_S$  to  $C_0$ .

**Solution:**

$$W_L = \frac{C_0 - C_S}{C_L - C_S} = \frac{35 - 43}{32 - 43} = \frac{-8}{-11} = 0.727,$$

$$W_S = \frac{C_L - C_0}{C_L - C_S} = \frac{32 - 35}{32 - 43} = \frac{-3}{-11} = 0.273.$$

Check:  $W_L + W_S = 1.000$ . Liquid is 72.7%, solid 27.3%.

## Advanced

## Example

**Problem:** A hypoeutectoid steel has  $C_0 = 0.40$  wt% C. Estimate the mass fractions of proeutectoid ferrite ( $\alpha$ ) and pearlite after slow cooling below the eutectoid. (Use 0.022 wt% C as the maximum solubility of C in ferrite at  $727^\circ\text{C}$ , and 0.76 wt% C for pearlite.)

**Thinking:** Treat pearlite as a mixture at the eutectoid composition (0.76% C) and ferrite as the phase at 0.022% C; apply the lever rule across that two-phase region.

**Solution:**

$$W_p = \frac{C_0 - 0.022}{0.76 - 0.022} = \frac{0.40 - 0.022}{0.738} = \frac{0.378}{0.738} = 0.512,$$

$$W_\alpha = 1 - W_p = 0.488.$$

Thus 51.2% pearlite and 48.8% proeutectoid ferrite.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

The lever rule is the engineer's tool for turning a diagram into a number that controls properties. In casting, the fraction of solid in the mushy  $L + \alpha$  zone decides whether a part feeds cleanly or shrinks and cracks; the same two-phase region in welding sets the size of the heat-affected zone. In steel, the pearlite fraction set by the lever rule fixes hardness and tensile strength—more pearlite means a stronger but less ductile part. Heat-treatment recipes (quench, anneal, normalize) are simply chosen paths that stop the cooling trajectory at a desired microconstituent fraction. Reading the diagram correctly is therefore the difference between a part that meets spec and one that fails in service.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Soldering and brazing (Pb–Sn, SAC):** The eutectic composition melts at the lowest temperature, letting joints form without fully melting the base metal.
- **Steelmaking and heat treatment:** The Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C diagram guides annealing, normalizing, and quench paths to reach target pearlite/ferrite/cementite fractions.
- **Alloy design (Cu–Ni):** Complete solubility gives monotonic property tuning for condenser tubes and coinage.
- **Single-crystal turbine blades:** Directional solidification follows the liquidus/solidus path to avoid grain boundaries.
- **Cast iron production:** The eutectic/ledeburite region controls fluidity and the final graphite or cementite microstructure.

## 13. Summary

Phase diagrams summarize equilibrium between phases as a function of temperature and overall composition, and the Gibbs phase rule  $F = C - P + 1$  (at fixed pressure) tells you how many variables remain free. Isomorphous systems such



as Cu–Ni show complete liquid and solid solubility bounded by a liquidus and solidus. Inside any two-phase field the lever rule converts a horizontal tie line into exact mass fractions:  $W_\alpha = (C_\beta - C_0)/(C_\beta - C_\alpha)$  and  $W_\beta = (C_0 - C_\alpha)/(C_\beta - C_\alpha)$ . Eutectic systems (Pb–Sn) solidify isothermally into lamellar mixtures, while peritectic and eutectoid reactions ( $L + \delta \rightarrow \gamma$  and  $\gamma \rightarrow \alpha + \text{Fe}_3\text{C}$ ) shape the Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C diagram. The single most important equation of the chapter is the lever rule, because everything else—microconstituent fractions, heat-treatment selection, and property prediction—follows from it.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. The Gibbs phase rule at fixed pressure is written  $F = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ .
2. For a binary two-phase region, the number of degrees of freedom is  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ .
3. True / False: The eutectic reaction occurs entirely in the solid state.  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$
4. The phases that coexist at the eutectic point of a binary system number  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ .
5. The eutectoid reaction in steel is  $\gamma \rightarrow \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$  and occurs at  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$  °C.
6. True / False: In the lever rule,  $C_\alpha$  and  $C_\beta$  are read from the ends of the tie line.  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$
7. Hypoeutectoid steels contain proeutectoid  $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$  plus pearlite.

## 15. Practice Problems

- ★ State the Gibbs phase rule for a binary system at fixed pressure and identify what each symbol means. (p. 147)
- ★★ For a Pb–Sn alloy with overall composition  $C_0 = 40 \text{ wt\% Sn}$  held at  $200^\circ\text{C}$ , a tie line gives  $C_L = 46 \text{ wt\% Sn}$  and  $C_\alpha = 18 \text{ wt\% Sn}$ . Compute the mass fraction of liquid using the lever rule. (p. 147)
- ★★ A Cu–Ni alloy contains  $C_0 = 50 \text{ wt\% Ni}$  at  $1300^\circ\text{C}$ , where the tie line reads  $C_L = 44 \text{ wt\% Ni}$  and  $C_S = 56 \text{ wt\% Ni}$ . Find the mass fractions of liquid and solid  $\alpha$ , and verify they sum to 1. (p. 147)

- \*\*\* A steel of composition  $C_0 = 0.60 \text{ wt\% C}$  is slowly cooled below the eutectoid temperature. Using  $0.022 \text{ wt\% C}$  for maximum ferrite solubility and  $0.76 \text{ wt\% C}$  for pearlite, calculate the mass fractions of proeutectoid ferrite and pearlite. (p. 147)
- \*\*\* At the eutectic point of a binary system at fixed pressure, how many phases coexist and what is the value of  $F$ ? Explain why this is called an invariant reaction. (p. 147)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does the Gibbs phase rule  $F = C - P + 1$  tell you?

**Back:**  $F$  is the number of independent intensive variables (e.g. temperature or composition) you may change while keeping the number of phases fixed, at constant pressure.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Define the liquidus and solidus lines.

**Back:** Liquidus: the boundary above which only liquid exists. Solidus: the boundary below which only solid exists. Between them the alloy is a two-phase liquid + solid mixture.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Write the lever rule for  $W_\alpha$  and name its parts.

**Back:**  $W_\alpha = (C_\beta - C_0)/(C_\beta - C_\alpha)$ , where  $C_\alpha$  and  $C_\beta$  are the tie-line-end phase compositions and  $C_0$  is the overall composition.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is a eutectic reaction? Give the Pb–Sn example.

---

**Back:** A eutectic is  $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$  at a fixed temperature. In Pb–Sn it occurs at 61.9 wt% Sn and 183°C, producing a lamellar ( $\alpha + \beta$ ) microstructure.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What microconstituents form in a hypoeutectoid steel?

---

**Back:** Proeutectoid ferrite ( $\alpha$ ) plus pearlite. Hypereutectoid steels instead form proeutectoid cementite plus pearlite.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is the peritectic reaction in Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C?

---

**Back:** At 1493°C:  $L + \delta \rightarrow \gamma$  (austenite). A new solid phase forms by reaction of the liquid with an existing solid phase.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

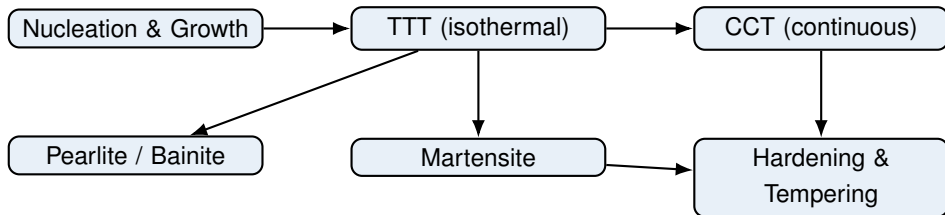
### Cheat Sheet

- **Phase rule:**  $F = C - P + 2$  (or  $+1$  at fixed  $P$ ).
- **Lever rule (2-phase):**  $W_\alpha = (C_\beta - C_0)/(C_\beta - C_\alpha)$ ,  $W_\beta = (C_0 - C_\alpha)/(C_\beta - C_\alpha)$ . Read  $C_\alpha, C_\beta$  from tie-line *ends*.
- **Isomorphous (Cu–Ni):** liquidus/solidus bound  $L$  and  $\alpha$ ; full solubility.
- **Eutectic (Pb–Sn):**  $L \rightarrow \alpha + \beta$  at 61.9 wt% Sn, 183°C.
- **Peritectic (Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C):**  $L + \delta \rightarrow \gamma$  at 1493°C.
- **Eutectoid (Fe–Fe<sub>3</sub>C):**  $\gamma \rightarrow \alpha + \text{Fe}_3\text{C}$  at 727°C  $\rightarrow$  pearlite. Cementite = 6.67 wt% C.
- **Steel microconstituents:** hypo ( $< 0.76\%$  C) = ferrite + pearlite; hyper ( $> 0.76\%$  C) = cementite + pearlite.
- **Key numbers:** eutectic Pb–Sn 61.9%/183°C; eutectoid 0.76%/727°C; peritectic 0.17%/1493°C.

# Chapter 9

## Phase Transformations

### 1. Roadmap



### 2. Learning Objectives

1. Distinguish the nucleation and growth stages of a phase transformation.
2. Read a TTT diagram: identify incubation time, the nose, and the transformation products.
3. Separate diffusion-controlled products (pearlite, bainite) from the diffusionless martensitic transformation.
4. Compute the  $M_s$  temperature from carbon content and explain retained austenite.
5. Interpret CCT diagrams, critical cooling rate, and the meaning of hardenability.
6. Select a heat-treatment path (austenitize, quench, temper, anneal) for a given property target.

### 3. Why This Matters

Phase transformations decide whether a steel component is soft and ductile or hard and brittle. Roughly a third of typical exam questions on kinetics use TTT/CCT diagrams, and the same logic governs every quenched or tempered part in a car, tool, or aircraft. Getting the cooling path wrong means a cracked gear or a spring that snaps; getting it right means tailoring strength and toughness on demand. Understanding these curves is therefore both an exam skill and a daily engineering necessity.

## 4. Intuition First

### Intuition First

Imagine cold honey poured into a freezer. If you hold it at one fixed cold temperature, it slowly crystallizes at a steady rate — that is an *isothermal* transformation. But if you instead just leave it on the counter to cool gradually, it passes through a range of temperatures while it sets — that is *continuous cooling*, and the result can be very different. Steel behaves the same way. Quench it fast enough and the atoms freeze in place before they can shuffle into an equilibrium pattern: you get martensite, a strained, super-hard trap. Cool it slowly and the carbon and iron have time to rearrange into soft layered pearlite. The transformation diagram simply maps “how cold, how long” to “what you get”.

## 5. Visual

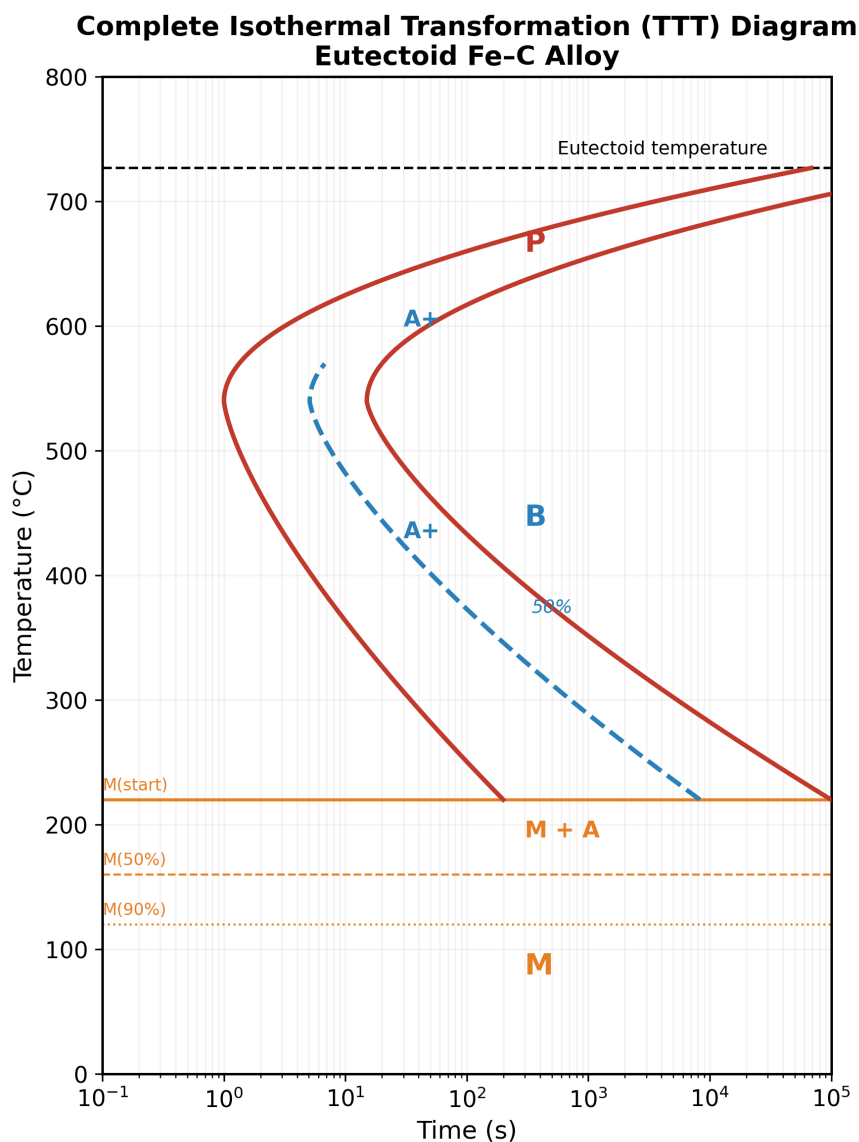
(one figure per key concept)

**Concept A — The TTT diagram (isothermal).** The complete C-curve for eutectoid steel shows the pearlite region above the nose and the bainite region below it, with the  $M_s/M_f$  lines marking where martensite begins and ends.

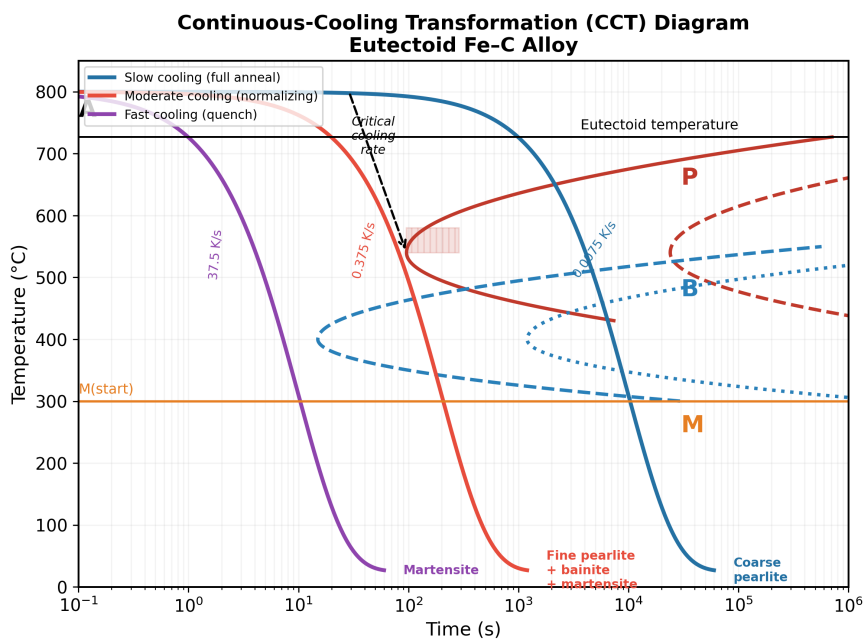
**Concept B — The CCT diagram (continuous cooling).** Under continuous cooling the curves shift to longer times and lower temperatures, and bainite can be suppressed. Different cooling rates give pearlite, a mixed structure, or full martensite.

**Concept C — A cooling path drawn on the TTT diagram.** The solid curve cools fast enough to dodge the nose and land in the martensite zone; the dashed curve lingers in the nose and forms pearlite. This picture is the heart of hardenability.

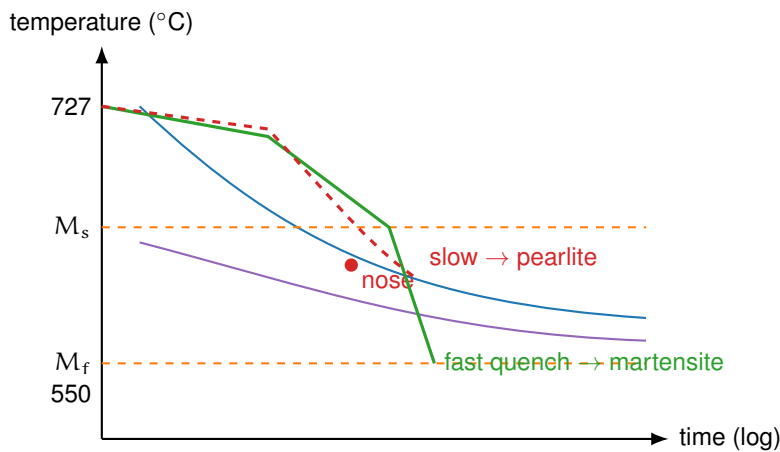
**Concept D — Microconstituent comparison.** Pearlite is layered plates, bainite is fine needles, and martensite is a strained lath/plate array. Their morphology explains their strength.



**Figure 9.1.** Figure 9.1 — Complete TTT diagram for a eutectoid steel: pearlite and bainite C-curves,  $M_s$  and  $M_f$  lines, and the transformation products at each isothermal hold temperature.

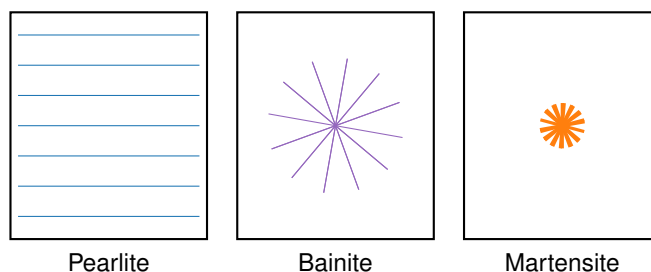


**Figure 9.2.** Figure 9.2 — CCT diagram with superimposed cooling curves. Slower cooling yields pearlite; faster cooling avoids the nose and forms martensite.



**Figure 9.3.** Figure 9.3 — Two cooling paths on the TTT diagram. The fast path bypasses the nose and finishes as martensite; the slow path crosses the pearlite region.





**Figure 9.4.** Figure 9.4 — Schematic morphologies: pearlite (layered ferrite/cementite), bainite (fine acicular), and martensite (strained laths).

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **TTT** = Time-Temperature-Transformation; *isothermal* (hold at fixed T).
- **CCT** = Continuous-Cooling Transformation; curves shift right and down vs. TTT.
- **Nose** = shortest time before transformation starts (compromise of driving force vs. diffusivity).
- **Pearlite**: above the nose,  $\sim 550\text{--}727^\circ\text{C}$ , layered, medium hardness.
- **Bainite**: below the nose,  $\sim 250\text{--}550^\circ\text{C}$ , acicular, high hardness.
- **Martensite**: below  $M_s$ , diffusionless shear, very hard and brittle.
- **Tempering**: reheat martensite ( $150\text{--}600^\circ\text{C}$ )  $\rightarrow$  tempered martensite, tougher.
- **Hardenability** = depth hardened on quench; raised by Mn, Cr, Mo, Ni.

## 7. Compare Box

### Pearlite vs. Bainite vs. Martensite

| Pearlite                                          | Bainite                             | Martensite                            |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Diffusion-controlled, layered ferrite + cementite | Diffusion-controlled, fine acicular | Diffusionless shear, supersaturated C |
| Forms above TTT nose (550–727°C)                  | Forms below nose (250–550°C)        | Forms below $M_s$ only                |
| Medium hardness; coarse → fine toward nose        | High hardness                       | Very hard, brittle                    |

### Isothermal (TTT) vs. Continuous Cooling (CCT)

| TTT diagram                             | CCT diagram                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Constant-temperature hold               | Cooling through a temperature range             |
| C-curves at shortest times              | Curves shifted to longer times, lower T         |
| Bainite always reachable                | At high cooling rates bainite can be suppressed |
| Used to plan isothermal heat treatments | Used to plan real quenches                      |

## 8. Common Mistakes

### Common Mistakes

- **Mistake 1:** Reading a TTT diagram as if it were continuous cooling. **Why:** TTT curves are isothermal; real quenches follow CCT, which is shifted right and down. Use the correct diagram for the process.
- **Mistake 2:** Drawing martensite as a point on the equilibrium Fe–C phase diagram. **Why:** Martensite is metastable and diffusionless; it never appears on the equilibrium diagram. It forms only on rapid quench below  $M_s$ .
- **Mistake 3:** Treating the  $M_s$  formula as exact. **Why:**  $M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt\% C})$  is empirical and approximate; alloying elements beyond carbon shift it further. Treat it as a first estimate, not a precise value.
- **Mistake 4:** Confusing hardenability with hardness. **Why:** Hardenability is the *depth* that hardens on quench (a Jominy distance), not the surface hardness itself, which depends on carbon content.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                | Meaning                                          | Units                | Variables                                  | Assump-<br>tions         | Limitations                   | Eng.<br>meaning                                                       |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $y = 1 - \exp(-kt^n)$                  | Fraction transformed vs. time (Avrami)           | –                    | $y$ fraction, $k$ rate, $n$ exponent (1–4) | Isothermal, constant $T$ | Only valid at fixed $T$       | Predicts transformation completion                                    |
| $M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt\% C})$ | Martensite start temperature                     | $^{\circ}\text{C}$   | wt% C carbon mass fraction                 | Plain carbon steel       | Ignores other alloys          | Lower C $\rightarrow$ lower $M_s \rightarrow$ more retained austenite |
| $\dot{T}_{\text{crit}}$ (concept)      | Minimum cooling rate that avoids the nose        | $^{\circ}\text{C/s}$ | –                                          | Defined by TTT nose      | Not a single universal number | Sets quench severity needed                                           |
| $H = H(T_{\text{temp}})$               | Tempering: hardness falls as tempering $T$ rises | HRC                  | $T_{\text{temp}}$ temper temperature       | Martensitic start        | Embrittlement ranges exist    | Trade hardness for toughness                                          |

## 10. Worked Examples

## Basic

### Example

**Problem:** Find the approximate  $M_s$  for a 0.4 wt% C plain-carbon steel.

**Thinking:** The empirical relation uses only the carbon content; we substitute directly. Higher carbon lowers  $M_s$ , so a smaller number than 520 is expected.

**Solution:**

$$M_s = 520 - 320(0.4) = 520 - 128 = \mathbf{392^\circ\text{C}}.$$

At room temperature this steel is fully below  $M_s$ , so on a fast quench it transforms essentially completely to martensite.

## Intermediate

### Example

**Problem:** An isothermal heat treatment quenches a 1080 (eutectoid) steel to 650°C, holds 10 s, then water-quenches to room temperature. What microstructure results?

**Thinking:** First read the TTT nose location. At 650°C the pearlite region sits just above the nose; 10 s is long enough to start but not complete pearlite, then the quench below  $M_s$  makes martensite from the remaining austenite.

**Solution:** A mixed microstructure of coarse pearlite plus martensite. The partial pearlite softens the part; the martensite portion keeps it hard. Selection of hold time tunes the hardness-toughness balance.

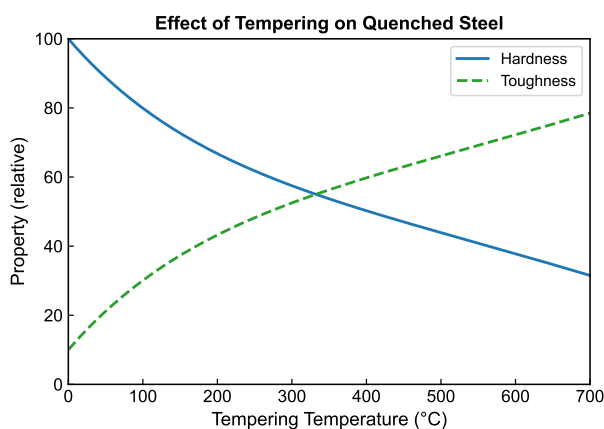
## Advanced

## Example

**Problem:** A 0.4 wt% C, 50 mm diameter round bar is water-quenched, requiring  $\sim 55$  HRC at the surface. Will it harden through?

**Thinking:** Connect the Fe–C diagram (hypoeutectoid, austenitize at  $850^{\circ}\text{C}$ ), the TTT nose (critical rate about  $100^{\circ}\text{C/s}$ ), and the CCT cooling profile. Surface and center cool at different rates.

**Solution:** Surface cools at  $\sim 150^{\circ}\text{C/s}$  ( $>$  critical, martensite forms, hardness OK). Center cools at only  $\sim 30^{\circ}\text{C/s}$  (slower than critical, pearlite forms, not hard enough). **Fix:** use a more hardenable steel (e.g. 4340) or increase quench severity (brine, agitation). The figure below shows the tempering step used after quenching to recover toughness.



**Figure 9.5.** Figure 9.5 — Tempering of martensite: reheating between 150 and  $600^{\circ}\text{C}$  decomposes the metastable structure into  $\alpha$  plus fine carbides.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

Hardenability, not hardness, is what lets a large part be useful. A thin knife blade hardens through even in mild steel, but a thick axle needs alloying (Mn, Cr, Mo, Ni) to slow pearlite/bainite formation so the center also reaches martensite. The Jominy end-quench test turns this into a single hardness-versus-distance curve. The engineering trade is unavoidable: martensite is hard but brittle, so nearly every quenched part is tempered afterward — sacrificing some hardness to gain the toughness that prevents catastrophic failure in service.

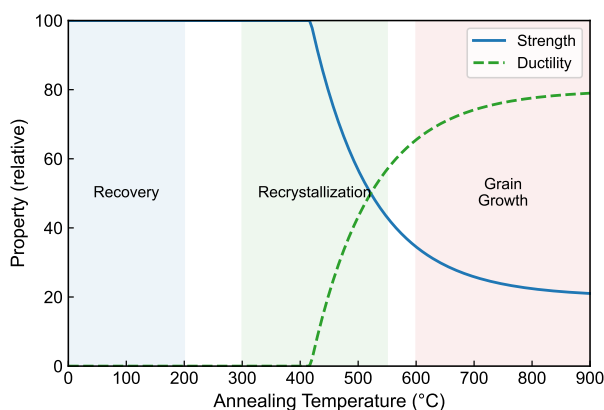
## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Automotive:** Quenched-and-tempered gears, crankshafts, and springs rely on martensite plus tempering for strength with toughness.
- **Tooling:** Cutting tools use high-carbon martensite tempered at low temperature to keep an edge.
- **Aerospace:** High-hardenability low-alloy steels (e.g. 4340) give deep, uniform hardness in large forgings.
- **Annealing:** Full annealing (slow cool) softens steel for machining and forming; the figure below shows the soft lamellar/spheroidized result.

## 13. Summary

Phase transformations in steel are governed by two kinetic maps: the TTT diagram (isothermal) and the CCT diagram (continuous cooling). Holding above the TTT nose forms pearlite; below it forms bainite; quenching below  $M_s$  forms martensite by a diffusionless shear. Hardenability — the depth that reaches martensite — is increased by alloying and controls whether a real part hardens through. Because martensite is brittle, quenched parts are normally tempered to trade a little hardness for much-needed toughness. The single equation to remember is the Avrami law  $y = 1 - \exp(-kt^n)$ , describing how far a transformation has progressed at time  $t$ .



**Figure 9.6.** Figure 9.6 — Annealing: a slow furnace cool produces soft, machinable pearlite or spheroidized cementite, the opposite of a quench.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. Pearlite forms \_\_\_\_\_ the TTT nose, bainite forms \_\_\_\_\_ it.
2. True / False: Martensite appears on the equilibrium Fe-C phase diagram. \_\_\_\_\_
3. The  $M_s$  temperature \_\_\_\_\_ (increases / decreases) as carbon content rises.
4. A faster cooling rate shifts the resulting microstructure toward \_\_\_\_\_.
5. Tempering raises toughness by \_\_\_\_\_ (raising / lowering) hardness.

## 15. Practice Problems

★ Which phase transformation in steel is diffusionless?

- (a) Pearlite formation
- (b) Martensite formation
- (c) Bainite formation
- (d) Spheroidite formation

★ The nose of a TTT diagram represents:

- (a) The minimum time for transformation to begin
- (b) The highest temperature for any transformation
- (c) The point where martensite starts
- (d) The completion of transformation

(p. 148)

★★ For a 0.6 wt% C steel, the approximate  $M_s$  temperature is:

- (a) 520°C
- (b) 328°C
- (c) 200°C
- (d) 727°C

(p. 148)

★★ Tempering of martensite is performed to:

- (a) Increase hardness
- (b) Improve toughness while reducing hardness
- (c) Form pearlite
- (d) Increase the  $M_s$  temperature

(p. 148)

★★★ A 50 mm diameter 0.4 wt% C bar is water-quenched but the center is soft. Explain why using the CCT diagram and critical cooling rate, and propose one fix.

(p. 148)

★★★ Which alloying element is most effective at increasing hardenability?

- (a) Mo (molybdenum)
- (b) Al (aluminum)
- (c) Si (silicon)
- (d) S (sulfur)

(p. 148)



## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does TTT stand for, and what process does it describe?

**Back:** Time-Temperature-Transformation: transformation kinetics at a constant (isothermal) holding temperature.

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is the nose of a TTT diagram?

**Back:** The point of shortest incubation time before transformation starts; a balance between driving force and atomic diffusivity.

### Flash Card

**Front:** How do pearlite, bainite, and martensite differ in formation?

**Back:** Pearlite and bainite are diffusion-controlled (above / below the nose); martensite is a diffusionless shear below  $M_s$ .

### Flash Card

**Front:** State the approximate  $M_s$  formula for plain carbon steel.

**Back:**  $M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt\% C})$  in  $^{\circ}\text{C}$ ; higher carbon gives lower  $M_s$ .

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is hardenability, and how is it measured?

**Back:** The depth to which steel hardens on quenching; measured by the Jominy end-quench test (hardness vs. distance).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why is martensite tempered after quenching?

**Back:** Martensite is brittle; tempering (150–600°C) forms tempered martensite, trading hardness for toughness.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** How does a CCT diagram differ from a TTT diagram?

**Back:** CCT curves shift to longer times and lower temperatures; bainite can be suppressed at high cooling rates.

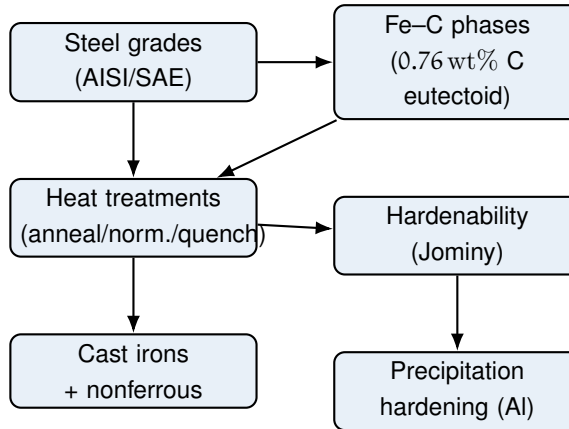
**17. Cheat Sheet****Cheat Sheet**

- **TTT:** isothermal; C-curves. **CCT:** continuous; shifted right/down.
- **Nose:** fastest start of transformation.
- **Pearlite:** 550–727°C, layered, medium hardness.
- **Bainite:** 250–550°C, acicular, high hardness.
- **Martensite:**  $< M_s$ , diffusionless, very hard/brittle.
- $M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt\% C})$  (°C, plain C steel).
- **Avrami:**  $y = 1 - \exp(-kt^n)$ .
- **Critical cooling rate:** minimum rate to dodge nose  $\rightarrow$  martensite.
- **Hardenability:** depth hardened; raised by Mn, Cr, Mo, Ni.
- **Tempering:** reheat 150–600°C; hardness  $\downarrow$ , toughness  $\uparrow$ .

# Chapter 10

## Applications and Processing of Metal Alloys

### 1. Roadmap



### 2. Learning Objectives

1. **Classify steels** by carbon content and by AISI/SAE four-digit designation.
2. **Read the Fe–C system:** locate the eutectoid (0.76 wt% C) and explain pearlite, cementite, and martensite.
3. **Select a heat treatment** (full anneal, normalize, quench & temper, spheroidize, process anneal) for a given property target.
4. **Explain hardenability** and interpret the Jominy end-quench test.
5. **Contrast cast irons** (gray, white, ductile, malleable) by graphite morphology.
6. **Describe precipitation hardening** of aluminum alloys through its three stages.

### 3. Why This Matters

This chapter is the bridge between atomic structure and the parts you actually hold: gears, turbine blades, engine blocks, and body panels. On undergraduate and FE/PE exams it is a reliable source of classification, selection, and short-answer questions. For engineers the payoff is direct – the same steel chemistry

can be soft enough to machine or hard enough to cut, purely by changing its heat treatment. Choosing the wrong process wastes material, energy, and sometimes lives, so the ability to match microstructure to service requirement is a core professional skill.

#### 4. Intuition First

##### Intuition First

Think of a steel part as a deck of cards. Heating it to the high-temperature *austenite* state shuffles the carbon atoms into a uniform, face-centered arrangement. How you cool that deck decides the final hand. Cool it slowly in the furnace and the cards re-stack into soft, layered *pearlite*. Quench it in water and the cards freeze mid-shuffle into a tangled, very hard but brittle *martensite*. Then a gentle reheat – tempering – lets the cards relax just enough to stop being brittle. Add a pinch of other elements (Cr, Ni, Mo) and the deck stays "frozen" deeper inside, which is what we call *hardenability*.

#### 5. Visual

(one figure per key concept)

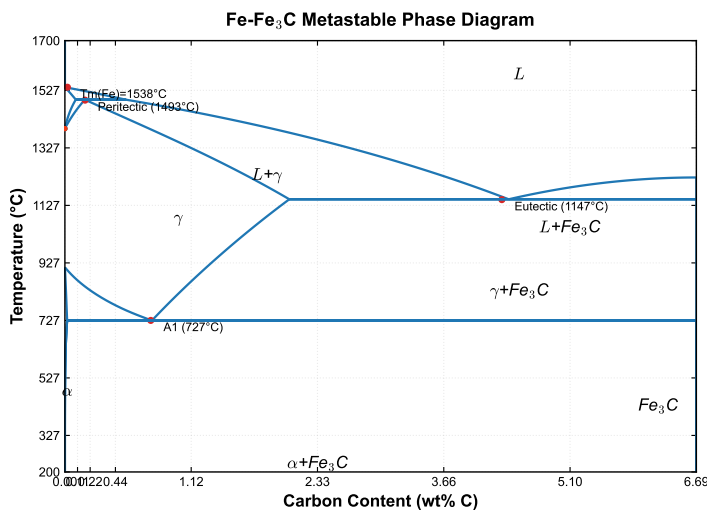
**Concept 1 – The Fe–C phases and the eutectoid.** The figure below shows the iron–carbon equilibrium diagram. The eutectoid point at 0.76 wt% C is where austenite splits into pearlite (alternating ferrite and cementite). Steels lie between 0.008 and 2.14 wt% C; cast irons are richer.

**Concept 2 – The annealing of cold-worked metal.** Three temperature-ordered stages convert a deformed, work-hardened part back toward soft, strain-free metal.

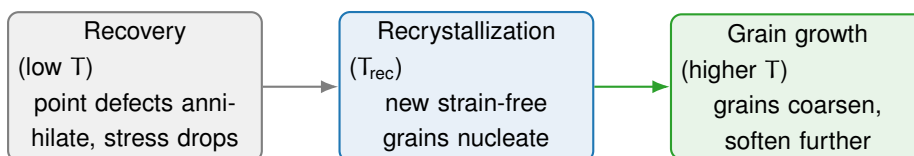
**Concept 3 – The quench-and-temper cycle.** Austenitize, quench to martensite, then temper to trade a little hardness for toughness.

**Concept 4 – Tempering response.**

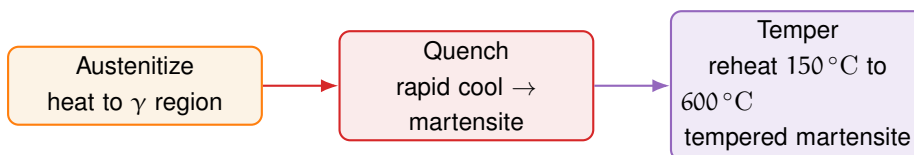
**Concept 5 – Precipitation hardening sequence.** Solution treat, quench to a supersaturated solid solution, then age to grow fine precipitates that block dislocations.



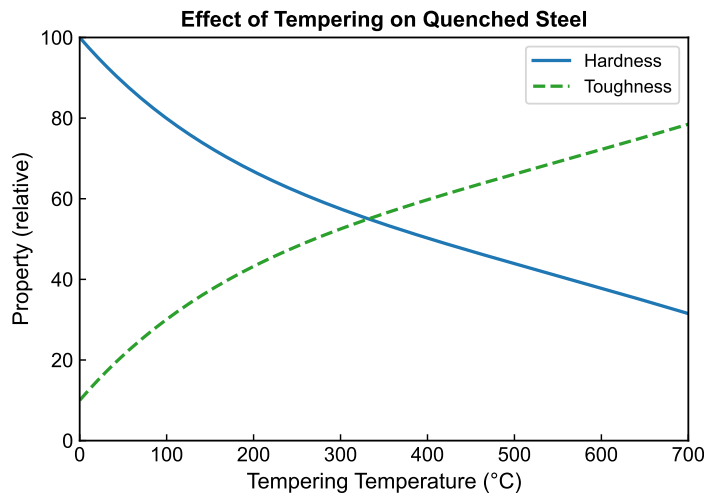
**Figure 10.1.** Figure 10.1 — Iron–carbon phase diagram highlighting the eutectoid composition at 0.76 wt% C.



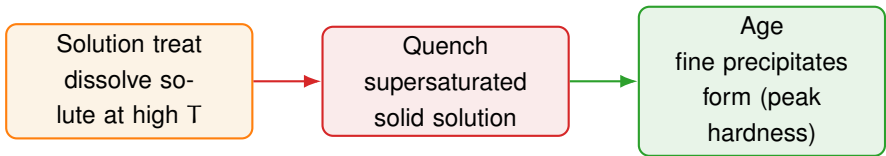
**Figure 10.2.** Figure 10.2 — Annealing stages ordered by increasing temperature: recovery, recrystallization, grain growth.



**Figure 10.3.** Figure 10.3 — Heat-treatment cycle: austenitize → quench → temper.



**Figure 10.4.** Figure 10.4 — As tempering temperature rises, hardness falls and toughness rises; the balance is chosen for service.



**Figure 10.5.** Figure 10.5 — Precipitation-hardening (age-hardening) sequence for aluminum alloys.

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- Steels: 0.008–2.14 wt% C. Cast irons: >2.14 wt% C.
- AISI/SAE: first two digits = *alloy type*; last two = *C in hundredths of wt%*. 1045 = 0.45 % C plain carbon.
- Low-C <0.25 %: not hardenable by heat treatment. Medium-C 0.25–0.60 %: quench & temper. High-C 0.60–1.40 %: tools/dies.
- Eutectoid = 0.76 wt% C → pearlite (ferrite + cementite lamellae).
- Full anneal = furnace cool (softest). Normalize = air cool. Quench & temper = hardest + tough.
- Cast iron types depend on **graphite morphology**: flake (gray), spheroidal (ductile), temper carbon (malleable), cementite (white).
- Hardenability  $\neq$  hardness: it is *depth* of martensite, measured by the Jominy end-quench test.

## 7. Compare Box

### Annealing vs. Normalizing vs. Quench & Temper

| Full anneal / normalize                                | Quench & temper                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Cool from $\gamma$ to soft pearlite (furnace or air).  | Rapid quench to martensite, then reheat to temper. |
| Low-to-medium hardness, high machinability.            | High strength with controlled toughness.           |
| Used when shape is final and softness helps machining. | Used for shafts, gears, tools needing strength.    |
| No martensite formed.                                  | Martensite is the starting, then tempered phase.   |

| Gray vs. Ductile vs. White vs. Malleable Cast Iron         |                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Gray / ductile (graphite)                                  | White / malleable (cementite)                        |
| Graphite as flakes (gray) or spheres (ductile).            | Carbon as cementite / temper carbon – hard, brittle. |
| Good damping (gray), strong & ductile (ductile).           | Very hard, wear-resistant, brittle.                  |
| Engine blocks, pipes, automotive parts.                    | Wear surfaces, annealed-to-ductile fittings.         |
| Property set by graphite <i>morphology</i> , not just % C. | Property set by carbide formation.                   |

8. Common Mistakes

Common Mistakes

- **Mistake 1: Reading the SAE carbon number as a percent.** SAE 1045 is 0.45 % C, not 45 % C – the last two digits are hundredths of a percent. **Why:** the scale is compressed by a factor of 100.
- **Mistake 2: Assuming all steels harden by heat treatment.** Low-C steels (<0.25 % C) form too little martensite; strengthen them by cold work instead. **Why:** martensite needs enough carbon to transform usefully.
- **Mistake 3: Confusing hardness with hardenability.** A shallow-hardening steel can still reach high surface hardness; hardenability is about how *deep* martensite forms. **Why:** the Jominy curve is about distance, not peak value.
- **Mistake 4: Treating cast irons as one material.** Their behavior is governed by graphite *morphology* (flake vs. spheroidal), not only carbon content. **Why:** ductile iron is far tougher than gray iron at similar composition.



## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                                       | Meaning                               | Units            | Variables                      | Assump-<br>tions                | Limitations                            | Eng.<br>meaning                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| $C_0 = 0.76$                                                  | Eutectoid carbon content of Fe–C      | wt% C            | $C_0$ : eutectoid % C          | Equilibrium, slow cool          | Not valid far from eutectoid           | Separates hypoeutectoid/-eutectoid/hypereutectoid steels |
| $T_{\text{temper}} = 150^\circ\text{C to } 600^\circ\text{C}$ | Tempering and slow after quench       | $^\circ\text{C}$ | $T_{\text{temper}}$ : reheat T | Martensitic start structure     | Above $600^\circ\text{C}$ over-softens | Higher T $\rightarrow$ softer, tougher                   |
| HRC(d)                                                        | Jominy hardness at distance d         | HRC              | d: distance from quenched end  | Standard 1 in $\times$ 4 in bar | Relative, not absolute                 | Lower curve slope = higher hardenability                 |
| Recovery < Recryst. < Growth                                  | Annealing temperature bands (ordered) | $^\circ\text{C}$ | stages by rising T             | Cold-worked metal               | Exact T alloy-specific                 | Pick T to control final grain size                       |
| Solution $\rightarrow$ Quench $\rightarrow$ Age               | Precipitation-hardening stages        | –                | three-stage sequence           | Supersaturated solid solution   | Overaging lowers strength              | Peak hardness at optimum aging time                      |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Example

**Problem:** What is the carbon content of SAE 4140 steel, and what alloying family does it belong to?

**Thinking:** The first two digits give the alloy type and the last two give carbon in hundredths of a percent. "41" is the Cr–Mo (chromoly) family, and "40" is 0.40% C.

**Solution:** SAE 4140 is a chromium–molybdenum steel with 0.40 wt% C, suitable for quench-and-temper to high strength.

## Intermediate

### Example

**Problem:** A connecting rod must resist high cyclic loads and needs both strength and toughness. Recommend a steel and treatment.

**Thinking:** High strength plus fatigue resistance points to medium-carbon alloy steel given a quench-and-temper at a moderate tempering temperature.

**Solution:** Use SAE 4140 (medium-C, Cr–Mo) and apply quench & temper at about 400 °C. This gives tempered martensite: a strong core with enough toughness to survive fatigue.

## Advanced

### Example

**Problem:** Two bars, SAE 1040 (plain C) and SAE 4340 (Ni–Cr–Mo), are quenched from the same section. Which keeps martensite deeper, and why?

**Thinking:** Hardenability – not hardness – governs depth. Alloying elements shift the transformation (C) curves to the right, so pearlite/bainite start later during cooling.

**Solution:** SAE 4340 keeps martensite to far greater depth (still ~53 HRC near 50 mm in Jominy testing versus 1040 dropping to 35 HRC by 12 mm). Its alloy content makes slow cooling still form martensite, so large sections can be through-hardened.

## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

The central engineering idea is *microstructure is a design variable*. The same 0.40 % C bar can be a soft, machinable blank (full anneal), a tough shaft (quench & temper at 400 °C), or a wear-resistant edge (quench & low temper at 200 °C) – purely by process choice. Hardenability decides whether a thick part hardens all the way through; that is why 4340, not 1040, is chosen for large fatigue-critical sections. Mistaking hardness for hardenability, or ignoring graphite morphology in cast iron, is how parts fail in service.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Automotive:** low-C 1008 panels are cold-worked and process-annealed for formability; 4140 shafts and 8620 case-carburized gears for strength with a tough core.
- **Cutting tools & dies:** high-C W1 / O1 steels are quenched and lightly tempered, or spheroidized first for machinability then hardened.
- **Engine blocks & pipes:** gray cast iron for damping and machinability; ductile iron where toughness is needed.
- **Aerospace:** age-hardened Al (2xxx, 6xxx, 7xxx) for airframes; Ti–6Al–4V and nickel superalloys (Inconel) for high-temperature turbine and implant service.

## 13. Summary

Steels are Fe–C alloys classified by carbon content and AISI/SAE grade; the eutectoid at 0.76 wt% C marks the boundary to pearlite formation. Heat treatment converts austenite into the desired microstructure: slow cooling gives soft pearlite, rapid quenching gives hard martensite, and tempering trades hardness for toughness. Hardenability – measured by the Jominy test – describes how deeply martensite forms and is raised by alloying elements. Cast irons are defined by graphite morphology, and aluminum alloys gain strength by precipitation hardening through solution, quench, and aging. The single most important number to

remember is the eutectoid composition, 0.76 wt% C.

## 14. Quick Review

### Quick Review

1. The eutectoid composition of the Fe–C system is \_\_\_\_\_ wt% C.
2. True / False: Hardenability and hardness mean the same thing.  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. SAE 1045 contains \_\_\_\_\_ % carbon.
4. List the three annealing stages in temperature order:  
\_\_\_\_\_.
5. True / False: Low-carbon steels can be hardened by quench and temper.  
\_\_\_\_\_

## 15. Practice Problems

★ SAE 4140 steel has approximately what carbon content?

- (a) 0.14 % C
- (b) 0.40 % C
- (c) 1.40 % C
- (d) 4.0 % C

(p. 149)

★ Gray cast iron gets its name from:

- (a) the gray appearance of graphite flakes on a fractured surface
- (b) the color of cementite
- (c) the heat treatment applied
- (d) the nickel content

(p. 149)

★★ Which heat treatment produces the softest, most machinable condition in high-C steel?

- (a) Quench and temper
- (b) Spheroidize anneal

- (c) Normalize
- (d) Process anneal

(p. 149)

★★ A steel with 0.10 % C is cold rolled to increase strength. This strengthening method is:

- (a) Precipitation hardening
- (b) Strain hardening (work hardening)
- (c) Quench hardening
- (d) Solid-solution strengthening

(p. 149)

★★★ Why can SAE 4340 be through-hardened in a larger cross-section than SAE 1040 after the same quench? Reference hardenability and the Jominy test in your answer.

(p. 149)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What does the last two digits of an AISI/SAE number mean?

**Back:** Carbon content in hundredths of wt%. 1045 = 0.45 % C.

### Flash Card

**Front:** What is the eutectoid composition of Fe–C?

**Back:** 0.76 wt% C; austenite there transforms to pearlite on slow cooling.

### Flash Card

**Front:** Hardenability vs. hardness – what is the difference?

**Back:** Hardness = surface strength reached. Hardenability = how deeply martensite forms (Jominy distance).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Name the three annealing stages in order of rising temperature.

---

**Back:** Recovery (defects annihilate), recrystallization (new grains), grain growth (coarsening).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What distinguishes gray from ductile cast iron?

---

**Back:** Graphite morphology: gray = flakes (brittle in tension); ductile = spheroids (strong, ductile).

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What are the three stages of precipitation hardening?

---

**Back:** Solution heat treatment, rapid quench to a supersaturated solid solution, then aging to form precipitates.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Which steel class cannot be hardened by heat treatment and why?

---

**Back:** Low-carbon steel ( $<0.25\% \text{ C}$ ); too little carbon to form useful martensite – use cold work instead.

## 17. Cheat Sheet

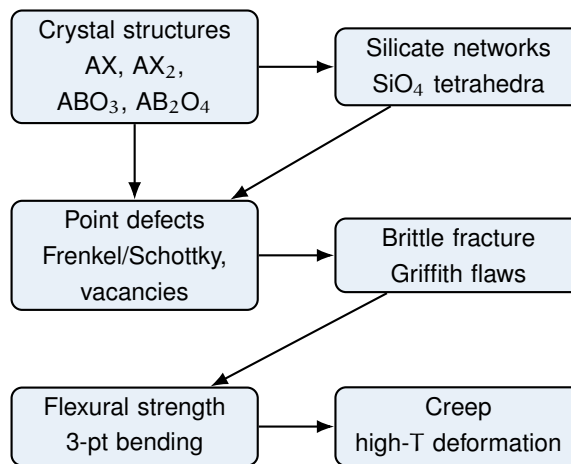
### Cheat Sheet

- **Steel grade:** 1st two digits = type (10xx plain, 11xx resulfurized, 41xx Cr-Mo, 43xx Ni-Cr-Mo, 61xx Cr-V); last two = C in hundredths %.
- **Carbon classes:** Low  $<0.25\%$  (cold work), Medium  $0.25\text{--}0.60\%$  (quench & temper), High  $0.60\text{--}1.40\%$  (tools).
- **Eutectoid:**  $0.76\text{ wt}\% \text{ C} \rightarrow$  pearlite.
- **Heat treatments:** anneal (furnace cool, softest) | normalize (air cool) | quench & temper ( $150^\circ\text{C}$  to  $600^\circ\text{C}$ ) | spheroidize (below  $A_1$ ) | process anneal (recovery).
- **Hardenability:** depth of martensite; Jominy end-quench; alloying shifts C-curves right.
- **Cast irons:** gray (flake), white (cementite), ductile (spheroidal), malleable (temper carbon).
- **Nonferrous:** Al age-hardenable (2xxx/6xxx/7xxx), Cu brasses/bronzes, Ti-6Al-4V, Ni superalloys (Inconel).
- **Precipitation hardening:** solution  $\rightarrow$  quench  $\rightarrow$  age (peak then over-age).

# Chapter 11

## Structures and Properties of Ceramics

### 1. Roadmap



This chapter traces the chain from *atomic structure* (how ions pack and bond) to *engineering behaviour* (why ceramics are hard but brittle, and how they fail). Master the structure-to-property logic: radius-ratio predicts coordination, defects set the flaw population, flaws set the strength, and high temperature turns slow diffusion into creep.



## 2. Learning Objectives

### Key Points

- Given cation and anion radii, predict the coordination number and crystal structure using the radius-ratio rule.
- Describe the AX, AX<sub>2</sub>, ABO<sub>3</sub> (perovskite), and AB<sub>2</sub>O<sub>4</sub> (spinel) structures and name key examples.
- Explain why silicate structures are built from SiO<sub>4</sub><sup>4-</sup> tetrahedra and how network modifiers form glass.
- Distinguish Frenkel, Schottky, and non-stoichiometric (anion/cation vacancy) defects and their charge compensation.
- Apply the Griffith criterion to relate flaw size to fracture stress and compute flexural strength.
- Describe brittle fracture, the influence of flaws, and the mechanisms of ceramic creep.

## 3. Why This Matters

Ceramics dominate every field that needs hardness, heat resistance, or electrical function that metals cannot deliver: cutting tools, engine components, capacitors, piezoelectric sensors, and thermal-barrier coatings. On exams they test the radius-ratio rule, the Griffith equation, and defect terminology heavily. In practice the single biggest engineering problem with ceramics is *reliability* — strength scatters because failure starts at random flaws, so designers use statistical (Weibull) criteria instead of a single safety factor. Understanding flaws is the difference between a reliable component and a sudden catastrophic failure.

## 4. Intuition First

### Intuition First

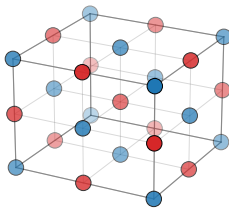
Imagine ceramics as a rigid 3-D jigsaw puzzle of charged balls. The big negatively charged balls (oxygen anions) form a cage; the small metal cations squeeze into the gaps. If a cation is too big for the gap it pushes the cage apart and demands more neighbours; if it is tiny it rattles in a small pocket with few neighbours. That geometric fit *is* the radius-ratio rule.

Now picture a pane of glass with a tiny scratch. Pull on it and the scratch behaves like the tip of a whip — stress piles up enormously at that one sharp point. Ceramics cannot yield to relieve that pile-up, so the crack simply runs. This is why a hairline flaw, not the bulk material, decides when a ceramic breaks. Heat it enough, though, and the balls slowly diffuse and slide past each other: that is creep.

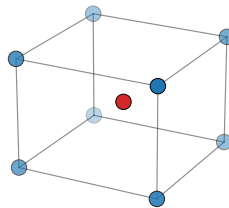
## 5. Visual

(one figure per key concept)

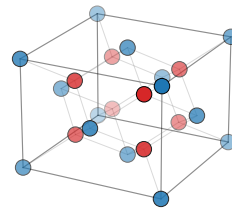
Rock-salt NaCl  
(AX, octahedral CN = 6)



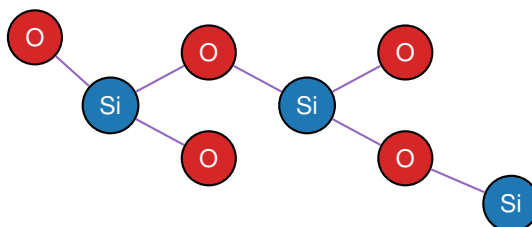
Cesium chloride CsCl  
(AX, cubic CN = 8)



Fluorite CaF<sub>2</sub>  
(AX<sub>2</sub>, Ca CN = 8, F CN = 4)



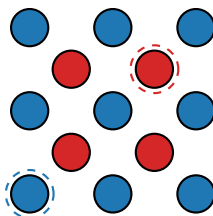
**Figure 11.1.** Figure 11.1 — Representative ceramic crystal cells: rock-salt NaCl (AX, octahedral CN = 6), cesium chloride CsCl (AX, cubic CN = 8), and fluorite CaF<sub>2</sub> (AX<sub>2</sub>, Ca CN = 8, F CN = 4). Blue = anion, red = cation; faint grey bonds show the coordination polyhedron.



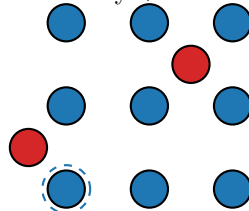
SiO<sub>2</sub> network: corner-sharing SiO<sub>4</sub> tetrahedra

**Figure 11.2.** Figure 11.2 — Silicate structure built from SiO<sub>4</sub><sup>4−</sup> tetrahedra. Each Si (blue) bonds to four O (red); adjacent tetrahedra share only corner oxygens, giving the open 3-D SiO<sub>2</sub> network.

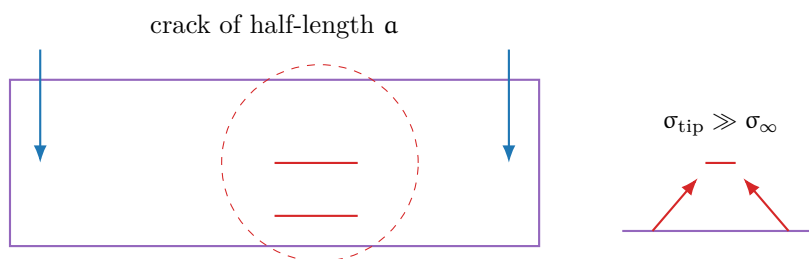
Schottky pair: one cation + one anion vacancy



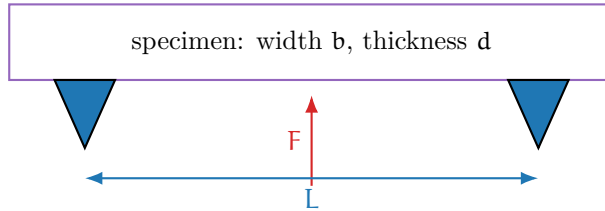
Frenkel pair: vacancy + interstitial (same ion)



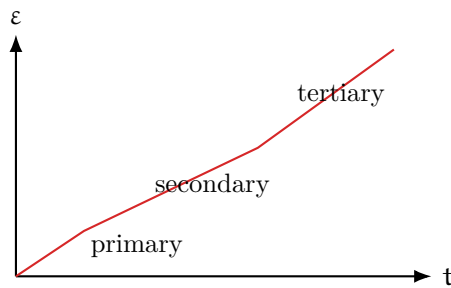
**Figure 11.3.** Figure 11.3 — Defects in ionic ceramics. Left: a Schottky pair (one cation and one anion vacancy) preserves stoichiometry. Right: a Frenkel defect (vacancy plus interstitial of the same ion) leaves composition unchanged.



**Figure 11.4.** Figure 11.4 — Griffith flaw and crack-tip stress concentration. A small internal crack concentrates the remotely applied stress  $\sigma_\infty$  at its tip by roughly a factor of  $2\sqrt{a/\rho}$ ; ceramics cannot relieve it plastically, so the crack runs.



**Figure 11.5.** Figure 11.5 — Three-point flexural test geometry. A center load  $F$  is applied between two supports separated by span  $L$ ; flexural strength is computed from the maximum load at fracture.



**Figure 11.6.** Figure 11.6 — Creep curve of a ceramic under constant load: primary (decelerating), secondary (steady-state, slope = minimum creep rate), and tertiary (accelerating to failure).

## 6. Memory Box

### Memory Box

- **Ceramic** = compound of metal + nonmetal; ionic, covalent, or mixed bonding; inorganic, nonmetallic (includes glass).
- **Radius ratio**  $r_C/r_A$ :  $> 0.732 \rightarrow \text{CN } 8$ ;  $0.414\text{--}0.732 \rightarrow 6$ ;  $0.225\text{--}0.414 \rightarrow 4$ ;  $0.155\text{--}0.225 \rightarrow 3$ .
- **AX**: NaCl (6:6), CsCl (8:8), ZnS (4:4). **AX<sub>2</sub>**: CaF<sub>2</sub> (8:4), TiO<sub>2</sub> rutile (6:3).
- **ABO<sub>3</sub> perovskite**: CaTiO<sub>3</sub>, BaTiO<sub>3</sub>, PZT. **AB<sub>2</sub>O<sub>4</sub> spinel**: MgAl<sub>2</sub>O<sub>4</sub>, Fe<sub>3</sub>O<sub>4</sub>.
- **Silicates**: built from SiO<sub>4</sub><sup>4-</sup> tetrahedra; modifiers (Na<sub>2</sub>O, CaO) break Si–O–Si bridges  $\rightarrow$  glass.
- **Defects**: Frenkel = vacancy + interstitial (same ion); Schottky = paired vacancies (keeps stoichiometry).
- **Fracture**:  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a})$ ; compressive strength  $5\text{--}10\times$  tensile.
- **Creep** in ceramics is diffusion-controlled and dominates at high T / fine grains.

## 7. Compare Box

### Defect families in ceramics

| Frenkel defect                                                                    | Schottky defect                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A vacancy paired with an interstitial of the <i>same</i> ion.                     | A cation vacancy paired with an anion vacancy.                            |
| Composition (atom ratios) unchanged; density barely changes.                      | Composition unchanged; density <i>decreases</i> (mass loss, same volume). |
| Common for small cations (e.g. Ag <sup>+</sup> , cations in close-packed arrays). | Common in strongly ionic compounds (e.g. NaCl, MgO).                      |

**Strength vs. toughness**

| <b>Strength (flexural / tensile)</b>                                                                          | <b>Toughness (<math>K_{Ic}</math>)</b>                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Depends on the largest flaw present; scatter is large.<br>Raised by removing flaws (fine powders, polishing). | A material property; small for ceramics ( $0.5\text{--}5 \text{ MPa}\sqrt{\text{m}}$ ).<br>Raised by toughening (transformation, fibers, cracks bridging). |
| High strength <b>does not</b> imply high toughness.                                                           | A tough ceramic can absorb more energy before failure.                                                                                                     |

**8. Common Mistakes****Common Mistakes**

- **Mistake 1:** Thinking all ceramics are crystalline. **Why:** soda-lime glass and many silicates are amorphous; “ceramic” means inorganic and nonmetallic, glass included.
- **Mistake 2:** Confusing the two Griffith forms  $\sigma_f = \sqrt{2E\gamma_s/(\pi a)}$  and  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a})$ . **Why:** the first uses surface energy (ideal brittle solid); the second uses fracture toughness and is the practical engineering form. Use the toughness form unless told otherwise.
- **Mistake 3:** Assuming higher strength means higher toughness. **Why:** strength depends on flaw size, while  $K_{Ic}$  is intrinsic; glass fibers can be very strong yet very brittle.
- **Mistake 4:** Forgetting charge neutrality in defect chemistry. **Why:** a single cation vacancy leaves net negative charge; it must be compensated (another vacancy or a lower-valence substitution).
- **Mistake 5:** Treating compressive and tensile strength as equal. **Why:** flaws are closed (not opened) under compression, so compressive strength is  $5\text{--}10\times$  the tensile value.

## 9. Formula Sheet

| Formula                                      | Meaning                            | Units           | Variables                                                   | Assump-<br>tions                          | Limitations                           | Eng.<br>meaning                     |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| $r_C/r_A$<br>rules                           | Predicts CN<br>from ionic<br>radii | –               | $r_C, r_A$                                                  | Hard<br>spheres,<br>electrostatic         | Covalency<br>distorts                 | Choose<br>crystal<br>structure      |
| $\rho = \frac{n' \sum A}{V_c N_A}$           | Theoretical<br>ceramic<br>density  | $\text{g/cm}^3$ | $n'$ f.u./cell,<br>$\sum A$ atomic<br>wt, $V_c$ cell<br>vol | Perfect<br>crystal                        | Porosity<br>lowers<br>measured $\rho$ | Compare to<br>measured<br>density   |
| $\sigma_f = \sqrt{\frac{2E\gamma_s}{\pi a}}$ | Griffith<br>(surface<br>energy)    | MPa             | $E, \gamma_s, a$                                            | Perfectly<br>brittle,<br>through<br>crack | Ignores<br>plasticity                 | Flaw size $\rightarrow$<br>strength |
| $\sigma_f = \frac{K_{Ic}}{Y\sqrt{\pi a}}$    | Griffith<br>(toughness)            | MPa             | $K_{Ic}, Y, a$                                              | Linear elastic                            | Not for<br>ductile /<br>R-curve       | Design<br>against<br>fracture       |
| $\sigma_{fs} = \frac{3FL}{2bd^2}$            | Flexural<br>strength<br>(3-pt)     | MPa             | $F, L, b, d$                                                | Beam, center<br>load                      | 4-pt uses<br>$3F(L - l)/(2bd^2)$      | Bend-test<br>strength               |
| $R = \frac{\sigma_f k}{\alpha E(1 - \nu)}$   | Thermal-<br>shock<br>resistance    | –               | $k, \alpha, E, \nu$                                         | Elastic, no<br>phase change               | Approximate                           | Resist<br>quenching                 |
| $P_f = 1 - e^{-(\sigma/\sigma_0)^m}$         | Weibull<br>failure prob.           | –               | $\sigma_0, m$                                               | Random flaw<br>population                 | Needs large<br>data set               | Reliability<br>design               |

## 10. Worked Examples

### Basic

#### Radius-ratio prediction for MgO

**Problem:**  $r_{\text{Mg}^{2+}} = 0.072 \text{ nm}$ ,  $r_{\text{O}^{2-}} = 0.140 \text{ nm}$ . Predict the coordination number and structure.

**Thinking:** Compute the ratio and map it onto the radius-ratio bands.

**Solution:**

$$\frac{r_C}{r_A} = \frac{0.072}{0.140} = 0.514$$

This lies in 0.414–0.732, so CN = 6 (octahedral); MgO adopts the rock-salt (NaCl) structure.

## Intermediate

## Griffith fracture from flaw size

**Problem:** A glass plate has  $K_{Ic} = 0.8 \text{ MPa}\sqrt{\text{m}}$  and a surface crack  $a = 0.1 \text{ mm}$ . Find the fracture stress (take  $Y \approx 1$ ).

**Thinking:** Use the toughness form of Griffith; convert mm to m.

**Solution:**

$$\sigma_f = \frac{0.8}{1.0\sqrt{\pi(0.1 \times 10^{-3})}} = \frac{0.8}{\sqrt{3.14 \times 10^{-4}}} = \frac{0.8}{0.0177} = \mathbf{45.2 \text{ MPa}}$$

Reducing the crack to  $a = 0.01 \text{ mm}$  gives  $\sigma_f = 143 \text{ MPa}$ : smaller flaws  $\rightarrow$  higher strength (the reason glass fibers beat bulk glass).

## Advanced

## Flexural strength from a bend test

**Problem:** A ceramic beam of width  $b = 5 \text{ mm}$ , thickness  $d = 3 \text{ mm}$ , span  $L = 30 \text{ mm}$  fractures at center load  $F = 120 \text{ N}$  in a 3-point test. Compute  $\sigma_{fs}$ .

**Thinking:** Convert all lengths to metres, then use the 3-point flexural formula.

**Solution:**

$$\sigma_{fs} = \frac{3FL}{2bd^2} = \frac{3(120)(30 \times 10^{-3})}{2(5 \times 10^{-3})(3 \times 10^{-3})^2} = \frac{10.8}{9.0 \times 10^{-8}} = \mathbf{120 \text{ MPa}}$$

This is the flexural (modulus of rupture) strength; it exceeds the true tensile strength because the stress peak is localized and ceramics fail where the largest flaw sits.



## 11. Engineering Insight

### Engineering Insight

The governing engineering truth for ceramics is: *strength is a flaw statistic, not a material constant*. Two identically specified alumina parts can fail at very different stresses because one happens to contain a larger pore or surface scratch. This is why ceramic design uses a *survival probability* (Weibull) rather than a fixed safety factor, and why processing quality (powder purity, sintering density, surface finish) matters more than the nominal composition. Toughening strategies — transformation toughening in zirconia, fiber/whisker reinforcement, and crack bridging — all work by making a running crack spend more energy, raising the effective  $K_{Ic}$ . For high-temperature parts, the limit is creep: fine-grained ceramics creep faster (grain-boundary diffusion), so coarse grains or single crystals are preferred when dimensional stability under load is critical.

## 12. Industrial Applications

### Industrial Applications

- **Dielectrics & capacitors:**  $\text{BaTiO}_3$  perovskite has  $\epsilon_r > 1000$ ; PZT (lead zirconate titanate) is the standard piezoelectric for sensors, actuators, and ultrasonic transducers.
- **Cutting tools & wear parts:**  $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$  and SiC retain hardness at temperature; SiC and ZnO act as varistors for surge protection.
- **Thermal management:** AlN and BeO ( $k > 200 \text{ W/m}\cdot\text{K}$ ) are heat-sink substrates; YSZ ( $\text{ZrO}_2$ ,  $k \approx 2 \text{ W/m}\cdot\text{K}$ ) is a thermal-barrier coating on turbine blades.
- **Transparent & functional:** ITO ( $\text{In}_2\text{O}_3\text{:Sn}$ ) for transparent electrodes; YBCO as a high- $T_c$  superconductor.
- **Structural & glass:** soda-lime and borosilicate glass, porcelain, and glass-ceramics (CorningWare) for cookware and telescope mirrors.

### 13. Summary

Ceramic behaviour follows directly from structure. The radius-ratio rule converts ionic sizes into coordination numbers and thus into AX, AX<sub>2</sub>, perovskite (ABO<sub>3</sub>), or spinel (AB<sub>2</sub>O<sub>4</sub>) structures. Silicates are built from corner-sharing SiO<sub>4</sub><sup>4-</sup> tetrahedra, and modifiers turn the network into glass. Point defects — Frenkel, Schottky, and non-stoichiometric vacancies — are governed by charge neutrality. Because ceramics are brittle, the largest flaw, not the bulk, sets the strength through the Griffith relation  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a})$ ; compressive strength is 5–10× tensile. At elevated temperature, diffusion-driven creep limits service life. *Most important equation:*  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a})$  — flaw size is destiny.

### 14. Quick Review

#### Quick Review

1. A radius ratio  $r_C/r_A = 0.514$  gives coordination number \_\_\_\_\_.
2. True / False: All ceramics are crystalline. \_\_\_\_\_
3. The Griffith equation shows fracture stress scales with  $1/\sqrt{\text{_____}}$ .
4. A Frenkel defect is a \_\_\_\_\_ paired with an interstitial of the same ion.
5. Flexural strength uses a \_\_\_\_\_-point bend test.
6. Fill: Ceramic compressive strength is roughly \_\_\_\_\_ times its tensile strength.
7. True / False: Higher strength always means higher fracture toughness. \_\_\_\_\_

### 15. Practice Problems

★ The radius ratio  $r_C/r_A = 0.45$  predicts a coordination number of:

- (a) 4
- (b) 6
- (c) 8
- (d) 12

★ Soda-lime glass is an example of:

- (a) A crystalline ceramic
- (b) An amorphous (glassy) ceramic
- (c) A metal-matrix composite
- (d) A polymer

(p. 149)

★★ Which factor is most responsible for the low tensile strength of ceramics?

- (a) Low elastic modulus
- (b) Pre-existing flaws that concentrate stress
- (c) High thermal expansion
- (d) Ionic bonding

(p. 149)

★★ The Griffith equation  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a})$  predicts that reducing flaw size from 100  $\mu\text{m}$  to 25  $\mu\text{m}$  increases strength by a factor of:

- (a) 1.5
- (b) 2
- (c) 2.5
- (d) 4

(p. 149)

★★★ A ceramic beam ( $b = 4 \text{ mm}$ ,  $d = 3 \text{ mm}$ ,  $L = 40 \text{ mm}$ ) fractures in a 3-point test at  $F = 200 \text{ N}$ . Compute its flexural strength in MPa. (p. 149)

★★★ Distinguish a Schottky defect from a Frenkel defect and state why each preserves electroneutrality and stoichiometry. (p. 149)

## 16. Flash Cards

### Flash Card

**Front:** What coordination number does  $r_C/r_A = 0.60$  predict?

**Back:** CN = 6 (octahedral); it falls in the 0.414–0.732 band.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Give the Griffith fracture equation in toughness form.

---

**Back:**  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic} / (Y\sqrt{\pi a})$ ;  $a$  is flaw size,  $Y$  a geometry factor.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is a Frenkel defect?

---

**Back:** A vacancy paired with an interstitial of the SAME ion; total composition unchanged.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What is a Schottky defect?

---

**Back:** A cation vacancy paired with an anion vacancy; keeps stoichiometry, lowers density.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Why is ceramic compressive strength much higher than tensile?

---

**Back:** Under compression, flaws close instead of opening; stress concentration cannot drive a crack.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** What building block forms all silicate structures?

---

**Back:** The  $\text{SiO}_4^{4-}$  tetrahedron; tetrahedra share corners to build networks, sheets, or chains.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Write the 3-point flexural strength formula.

**Back:**  $\sigma_{fs} = 3FL/(2bd^2)$  with span L, load F, width b, thickness d.

**Flash Card**

**Front:** Name one perovskite and one spinel with formula.

**Back:** Perovskite  $ABO_3$  (e.g.  $BaTiO_3$ ); spinel  $AB_2O_4$  (e.g.  $MgAl_2O_4$ ).

**17. Cheat Sheet****Cheat Sheet**

**Crystal structures:**  $AX = NaCl(6:6), CsCl(8:8), ZnS(4:4); AX_2 = CaF_2(8:4), rutile(6:3); ABO_3$  perovskite;  $AB_2O_4$  spinel.

**Radius ratio:**  $> 0.732 \rightarrow 8; 0.414-0.732 \rightarrow 6; 0.225-0.414 \rightarrow 4; 0.155-0.225 \rightarrow 3$ .

**Silicates:**  $SiO_4^{4-}$  tetrahedra; modifiers ( $Na_2O, CaO$ )  $\rightarrow$  glass; soda-lime  $\approx 72\% SiO_2/14\% Na_2O/10\% CaO$ .

**Defects:** Frenkel = vac + interstitial (same ion); Schottky = vac pair (stoichiometric). Charge neutrality always.

**Fracture:**  $\sigma_f = K_{Ic}/(Y\sqrt{\pi a}); \sigma_f \approx \sqrt{2E\gamma_s/(\pi a)}$ . Compressive  $\approx 5-10\times$  tensile.

**Toughness:**  $K_{Ic} \approx 0.5-5 \text{ MPa}\sqrt{m}$  (metals 20–200).

**Flexural (3-pt):**  $\sigma_{fs} = 3FL/(2bd^2)$ .

**Creep:** diffusion-controlled; fine grains / high T  $\rightarrow$  faster.

**Density:**  $\rho = n' \sum A/(V_c N_A)$ .

**Key numbers:**  $K_{Ic}$  glass  $\approx 0.8$ ;  $BaTiO_3$   $\epsilon_r > 1000$ ;  $Al_2O_3$   $k \approx 30$ ; YSZ  $k \approx 2 \text{ W/m}\cdot\text{K}$ .

# Appendix A

## Master Formula Index

Scan this once before the exam. Each row: formula (left) vs. meaning + units (right).

### Ch 2–3 — Atomic Structure & Crystal Structures

|                                                 |                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\rho = \frac{nA}{V_c N_A}$                     | Theoretical density; g/cm <sup>3</sup> . n atoms/cell, A at. wt, V <sub>c</sub> cell vol. |
| $APF = \frac{n(4/3)\pi R^3}{V_c}$               | Atomic packing factor (0–1); higher = denser packing.                                     |
| $a = 2\sqrt{2}R$ (FCC), $a = 4R/\sqrt{3}$ (BCC) | Lattice parameter from atomic radius; nm.                                                 |
| $d_{hkl} = \frac{a}{\sqrt{h^2 + k^2 + l^2}}$    | Interplanar spacing (cubic); nm.                                                          |
| $n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$                     | Bragg's law; $\lambda$ wavelength, $\theta$ glancing angle.                               |

### Ch 4 — Imperfections in Solids

|                                      |                                                            |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| $N_v = N e^{-Q_v/kT}$                | Equilibrium vacancy count; $k = 8.62 \times 10^{-5}$ eV/K. |
| $N_v/N = e^{-Q_v/kT}$                | Vacancy fraction; grows with T.                            |
| $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ | Hall–Petch: finer grains = stronger; MPa.                  |

### Ch 5 — Diffusion

|                                                                                       |                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| $J = -D \frac{dC}{dx}$                                                                | Fick's 1st law (steady state); kg/(m <sup>2</sup> s).       |
| $\frac{\partial C}{\partial t} = D \frac{\partial^2 C}{\partial x^2}$                 | Fick's 2nd law (transient profile).                         |
| $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$                                                               | Arrhenius diffusivity; m <sup>2</sup> /s, R = 8.314 J/molK. |
| $\frac{C - C_0}{C_s - C_0} = 1 - \operatorname{erf}\left(\frac{x}{2\sqrt{Dt}}\right)$ | Carburizing / semi-infinite solid solution.                 |

### Ch 6 — Mechanical Properties

|                                                                                      |                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\sigma = F/A_0$ , $\epsilon = \Delta l/l_0$                                         | Engineering stress (MPa) / strain.                                           |
| $E = \sigma/\epsilon$                                                                | Young's modulus (Hooke); GPa.                                                |
| $\nu = -\epsilon_{\text{trans}}/\epsilon_{\text{axial}}$                             | Poisson's ratio (metals $\approx 0.33$ ).                                    |
| $\sigma_T = \sigma(1 + \epsilon)$ , $\epsilon_T = \ln(1 + \epsilon)$                 | True stress / true strain (to necking).                                      |
| $\%EL = \frac{\Delta l}{l_0} \times 100$ , $\%RA = \frac{A_0 - A_f}{A_0} \times 100$ | Ductility: elongation / reduction of area.                                   |
| $HB = \frac{2P}{\pi D(D - \sqrt{D^2 - d^2})}$                                        | Brinell hardness; strength proxy ( $\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 HB$ for steel). |

## Ch 7 — Dislocations & Strengthening

$$\tau_R = \sigma \cos \phi \cos \lambda$$

$$\sigma_y = \tau_{CRSS}/m$$

$$\sigma_T = K\epsilon_T^n$$

$$\tau = Gb/L$$

Schmid: resolved shear stress;  $\phi, \lambda$  angles to slip.

Crystal tensile yield;  $m = \cos \phi \cos \lambda$ .

Hollomon strain hardening; higher  $n$  = more formable.

Orowan bypass stress;  $L$  particle spacing.

## Ch 8 — Phase Diagrams

$$F = C - P + 2$$

$$W_\alpha = \frac{C_\beta - C_0}{C_\beta - C_\alpha}$$

$$W_\beta = \frac{C_0 - C_\alpha}{C_\beta - C_\alpha}$$

Gibbs phase rule (use +1 at fixed  $P$ ).

Lever rule mass fraction of  $\alpha$ .

Lever rule mass fraction of  $\beta$  ( $W_\alpha + W_\beta = 1$ ).

## Ch 9 — Phase Transformations

$$y = 1 - \exp(-kt^n)$$

$$M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt}\% \text{ C})$$

Avrami fraction transformed (isothermal);  $n \approx 1-4$ .

Martensite start temperature ( $^{\circ}\text{C}$ ), plain carbon steel.

## Ch 11 — Ceramics & Fracture

$$r_C/r_A \text{ rules}$$

$$\sigma_f = \sqrt{\frac{2E\gamma_s}{\pi a}}$$

$$\sigma_f = \frac{K_{Ic}}{Y\sqrt{\pi a}}$$

$$\sigma_{fs} = \frac{3FL}{2bd^2}$$

$$P_f = 1 - e^{-(\sigma/\sigma_0)^m}$$

Radius-ratio  $\rightarrow$  coordination number / structure.

Griffith fracture (brittle); MPa.

Griffith / toughness form;  $K_{Ic}$  fracture toughness.

Flexural strength, 3-pt bend; MPa.

Weibull failure probability;  $m$  shape,  $\sigma_0$  scale.

## Appendix B

### Answer Key

#### Answers — Chapter 01

- ★ **C. Semiconductors.** The five primary families are Metals, Ceramics, Polymers, Composites, and Advanced materials. Semiconductors are an *advanced*-material subclass (e.g. Si), not a primary classification on their own.
- ★ **B. Structure.** In the MSE paradigm, Processing creates the Structure; Structure is what directly determines Properties, which in turn enable Performance.
- ★★ **C. Nickel superalloy.** At 900°C (above the useful range of Al, ceramics are brittle, and Nylon melts), nickel superalloys retain strength and resist creep; they are the standard jet-turbine-blade material.
- ★★ **B. A polymer-matrix composite.** CFRP = carbon-fiber reinforcement in a polymer (epoxy) matrix; the matrix is polymer, so it is a PMC, not a metal or ceramic composite.
- ★★★ Theoretical density and likely metal.

$$V_c = (0.2866 \times 10^{-7} \text{ cm})^3 = 2.355 \times 10^{-23} \text{ cm}^3,$$
$$\rho = \frac{nA}{V_c N_A} = \frac{2(55.85)}{(2.355 \times 10^{-23})(6.022 \times 10^{23})} = \frac{111.7}{14.18} \approx 7.88 \text{ g/cm}^3.$$

With  $n = 2$  (BCC) and  $A = 55.85 \text{ g/mol}$  the metal is **iron** ( $\alpha$ -Fe, handbook  $\approx 7.87 \text{ g/cm}^3$ ).

#### Answers — Chapter 02

- ★ **B. Covalent.** Covalent bonds are highly directional (localized shared-electron pairs) and give very high stiffness/hardness (e.g. diamond).
- ★ **A. Ionic.**  $\Delta\chi = 3.16 - 0.93 = 2.23 > 1.7$ , so the Na–Cl bond is predominantly ionic (NaCl).
- ★★ **A. Elastic modulus.** The modulus is the *curvature* (second derivative) of the  $E(r)$  well at  $r_0$ ; well depth  $E_0$  gives the melting point, asymmetry gives thermal expansion.
- ★★ **B. Ionic.** Very high  $T_m$ , electrical insulating behavior, and brittle fracture are the signature property set of ionic bonding (e.g. MgO,  $\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3$ ).



\*\*\* **A. Non-directional (metallic).** The delocalized electron sea lets atomic planes slide past one another without breaking bonds, giving metals their ductility.

\*\*\*  $\Delta\chi = 2.55 - 1.90 = 0.65$ .

$$F_{\text{ionic}} = 1 - e^{-(\Delta\chi/2)^2} = 1 - e^{-(0.65/2)^2} = 1 - e^{-0.1056} = 1 - 0.900 \approx 0.10 \text{ (about 10\%).}$$

SiC is therefore *mostly covalent* (with only  $\sim 10\%$  ionic character); this mixed character is why SiC is a hard, covalent-ceramic semiconductor.

## Answers — Chapter 03

- ★ **b. 2.** A BCC cell has 8 corners  $\times 1/8 + 1$  body center =  $1 + 1 = 2$  atoms.
- ★ **c. 0.74.** FCC (and HCP) are close-packed:  $\text{APF} = 4(4/3)\pi R^3 / (2\sqrt{2}R)^3 \approx 0.74$ . BCC is 0.68.
- ★★ **b. 0.362 nm.** For FCC,  $a = 2\sqrt{2}R = 2\sqrt{2}(0.128) \approx 0.362$  nm.
- ★★ **b. (110).** The first BCC reflection (smallest  $h + k + l$  even) is (110) at  $2\theta \approx 44.8^\circ$  ( $d_{110} = a/\sqrt{2} = 0.2027$  nm).
- \*\*\* **b. (111), (200), (220).** FCC allows only all-even or all-odd ( $hkl$ ). The allowed  $h^2 + k^2 + l^2$  sequence is 3, 4, 8, ... giving planes (111), (200), (220) as the first three peaks.

## Answers — Chapter 04

- ★ **A. Increases exponentially with temperature.**  $N_v/N = \exp(-Q_v/kT)$ ; as  $T$  rises the exponent becomes less negative, so vacancy fraction grows steeply (use kelvin).
- ★ **B. Perpendicular to the dislocation line.** For an edge dislocation the Burgers vector  $\mathbf{b}$  is perpendicular to the line (the extra half-plane edge); screw is the parallel case.
- ★★ **B. Increase strength.** Hall-Petch:  $\sigma_y = \sigma_0 + k_y d^{-1/2}$ ; smaller  $d$  gives a larger  $d^{-1/2}$ , so yield strength rises.
- ★★ **C. High melting point.** Hume-Rothery rules are: atomic radii within  $\sim 15\%$ , same crystal structure, similar electronegativity, same valence. Melting point is not a rule.

- ★★ **B. An array of dislocations.** A low-angle (tilt) grain boundary is modeled as a wall of edge dislocations; high-angle boundaries are misoriented crystal lattices.
- ★★★ **C. Removes a cation-anion pair from the lattice.** A Schottky defect is a paired cation + anion vacancy (neutral, lowers density); a Frenkel defect keeps the ion inside the lattice as a vacancy-interstitial pair.

## Answers — Chapter 05

- ★ **A. More sites are available and the activation energy is lower.** Interstitial atoms hop through the numerous gaps between host atoms, needing no vacancy, so  $Q_d$  is lower and diffusion is faster than vacancy (substitutional) diffusion.
- ★ **A. Flux is opposite to the concentration gradient direction.** The minus sign in  $J = -D dC/dx$  means atoms flow "downhill" from high to low concentration.
- ★★ **b. 4.** Case depth  $\propto \sqrt{Dt}$ ; to double the depth at fixed  $T$  you need  $(2)^2 = 4 \times$  the time.
- ★★ **A. BCC has a lower atomic packing factor (0.68 vs 0.74).** The more open BCC lattice gives carbon more and larger interstitial sites, so C diffuses faster in  $\alpha$ -Fe (BCC) than in  $\gamma$ -Fe (FCC).
- ★★★ **A. The slope of an Arrhenius plot ( $\ln D$  vs.  $1/T$ ).**  $D = D_0 \exp(-Q_d/RT)$ ; a plot of  $\ln D$  vs  $1/T$  is a straight line of slope  $-Q_d/R$ , so  $Q_d = -(\text{slope})R$ .

## Answers — Chapter 06

- ★ Elastic strain  $\epsilon = \sigma/E = 400/200000 = \mathbf{0.002}$  (0.2%). Hooke's law applies below yield.
- ★ Necking begins at the **ultimate tensile strength (UTS)**, the peak of the engineering stress-strain curve. Beyond UTS the cross-section locally narrows faster than strain hardening can compensate, so the load drops and a neck forms.
- ★★ True stress  $\sigma_T = \sigma(1+\epsilon) = 300(1+0.05) = \mathbf{315 \text{ MPa}}$ ; true strain  $\epsilon_T = \ln(1+\epsilon) = \ln(1.05) = \mathbf{0.0488}$ .
- ★★  $\%EL = (l_f - l_0)/l_0 \times 100 = (63 - 50)/50 \times 100 = \mathbf{26\%}$ .  $\%RA = (A_0 - A_f)/A_0 \times 100 = (90 - 42)/90 \times 100 = \mathbf{53.3\%}$ .

\*\*\* Modulus of resilience  $U_r = \sigma_y^2 / (2E) = (500 \times 10^6)^2 / (2 \cdot 200 \times 10^9) = 2.5 \times 10^{17} / 4.0 \times 10^{11} = \mathbf{0.625 \text{ MJ/m}^3}$ .

\*\*\* Brinell hardness:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{HB} &= \frac{2P}{\pi D(D - \sqrt{D^2 - d^2})} = \frac{2(3000)}{\pi(10)(10 - \sqrt{100 - 10.24})} = \frac{6000}{\pi(10)(10 - 9.474)} \\ &= \frac{6000}{16.52} \approx \mathbf{363}. \end{aligned}$$

Estimated tensile strength (steels):  $\sigma_{TS} \approx 3.45 \text{ HB} \approx 3.45(363) = \mathbf{1252 \text{ MPa}}$ .

## Answers — Chapter 07

- ★ **B.**  $\phi = 45^\circ$ ,  $\lambda = 45^\circ$ . Schmid factor  $m = \cos \phi \cos \lambda$  is maximized at  $m = 0.5$  when both angles are  $45^\circ$ , giving the largest resolved shear stress for a given  $\sigma$ .
- ★ **b. 12.** FCC has 4 {111} planes  $\times$  3  $\langle 110 \rangle$  directions = 12 slip systems (BCC 48, HCP 3).
- ★★ **b. 2 (approximately).** With  $\sigma_0 = 100 \text{ MPa}$ ,  $k_y = 0.74 \text{ MPa}\cdot\text{m}^{1/2}$ :  $d = 10 \text{ }\mu\text{m} \Rightarrow \sigma_y = 100 + 0.74/(10^{-5})^{1/2} = 100 + 234 = 334 \text{ MPa}$ ;  $d = 2.5 \text{ }\mu\text{m} \Rightarrow \sigma_y = 100 + 0.74/(2.5 \times 10^{-6})^{1/2} = 100 + 468 = 568 \text{ MPa}$ . The  $d^{-1/2}$  term doubles (grain size cut by 4), giving a total factor of about 1.7; the nearest listed choice is **2**.
- ★★ **b. Recrystallization.** Recovery lowers stored energy but only partially softens; recrystallization forms new strain-free grains and *fully* restores the original softness and ductility. Grain growth then slightly coarsens/softens further.
- \*\*\* **B. Small, coherent, and closely spaced.** Coherent, fine precipitates are cut/sheared (or Orowan-bypassed at very small spacing), maximizing the obstacle density to dislocation motion; this is the peak-aged condition. Large/widely spaced particles are weaker.
- \*\*\* **A. Fully annealed copper (FCC).** FCC metals have the highest strain-hardening exponent ( $n \approx 0.3\text{--}0.5$ ); BCC ( $\sim 0.15\text{--}0.25$ ) and HCP ( $< 0.1$ ) are lower, glass essentially none.

## Answers — Chapter 08

- ★ Gibbs phase rule at fixed pressure:  $\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{C} - \mathbf{P} + \mathbf{1}$ , where C = number of components, P = number of phases, and F = degrees of freedom (independent

intensive variables you may set). At ordinary (variable-T,P) conditions use +2.

★★ Lever rule, liquid fraction:

$$W_L = \frac{C_0 - C_\alpha}{C_L - C_\alpha} = \frac{40 - 18}{46 - 18} = \frac{22}{28} \approx \mathbf{0.786} \text{ (78.6\%)}.$$

(Solid  $\alpha$  fraction = 0.214; check sums to 1.)

★★ Cu-Ni:  $C_0 = 50$ ,  $C_L = 44$ ,  $C_S = 56$  wt% Ni.

$$W_L = \frac{C_0 - C_S}{C_L - C_S} = \frac{50 - 56}{44 - 56} = \frac{-6}{-12} = 0.50,$$

$$W_S = \frac{C_L - C_0}{C_L - C_S} = \frac{44 - 50}{44 - 56} = \frac{-6}{-12} = 0.50.$$

**50%** liquid and **50%** solid  $\alpha$ ;  $W_L + W_S = 1.00$  confirmed.

★★★ Hypoeutectoid ( $C_0 = 0.60$  wt% C):

$$W_P = \frac{C_0 - 0.022}{0.76 - 0.022} = \frac{0.60 - 0.022}{0.738} = \frac{0.578}{0.738} \approx \mathbf{0.783} \text{ (78.3\% pearlite)},$$

$$W_\alpha = 1 - W_P \approx \mathbf{0.217} \text{ (21.7\% proeutectoid ferrite)}.$$

★★★ At the eutectic point (fixed pressure) **three phases coexist** ( $L + \alpha + \beta$ ) and  $F = 0$ . It is called *invariant* because with  $P = 3$ ,  $C = 2$  and fixed  $P$ ,  $F = C - P + 1 = 0$ : temperature and all phase compositions are locked, and the reaction proceeds isothermally.

## Answers — Chapter 09

- ★ **B. Martensite formation.** Martensite is a diffusionless shear transformation that occurs on rapid quench below  $M_s$ ; pearlite and bainite are diffusion-controlled, spheroidite forms by coarsening.
- ★ **A. The minimum time for transformation to begin.** The nose is the C-curve's closest approach to the time axis (shortest incubation); it is the easiest point to avoid (or hit) during cooling.
- ★★ **B. 328°C.**  $M_s \approx 520 - 320(\text{wt\% C}) = 520 - 320(0.6) = 520 - 192 = 328^\circ\text{C}$  for a plain-carbon steel.
- ★★ **B. Improve toughness while reducing hardness.** Tempering reheats martensite ( $150\text{--}600^\circ\text{C}$ ), decomposing it to tempered martensite; hardness falls but toughness rises, averting brittle failure.

- \*\*\* The bar's **center cools more slowly than the critical cooling rate**, so its path on the CCT diagram crosses the pearlite/bainite region instead of dodging the nose → it forms soft pearlite, not martensite. *Fix*: use a higher-hardenability steel (e.g. 4340, with Ni–Cr–Mo shifting the C-curves right) or increase quench severity (brine, agitation).
- \*\*\* **A. Mo (molybdenum)**. Molybdenum is among the strongest hardenability boosters (along with Cr, Mn, and B); Al, Si, and S are much weaker for this purpose.

## Answers — Chapter 10

- ★ **B. 0.40% C**. In AISI/SAE, the last two digits are carbon in hundredths of a wt%; "40" ⇒ 0.40 wt% C (the "41" prefix = Cr–Mo family).
- ★ **A. The gray appearance of graphite flakes on a fractured surface**. Gray cast iron's fracture surface looks gray because graphite exists as flakes; the name refers to that appearance, not to cementite or heat treatment.
- ★★ **B. Spheroidize anneal**. Spheroidizing (just below  $A_1$ ) turns cementite into rounded globules, giving the softest, most machinable condition for high-C steel. Full anneal is next; normalize and quench-and-temper are harder.
- ★★ **B. Strain hardening (work hardening)**. Cold rolling multiplies dislocation density, raising strength via  $\tau \propto Gb\sqrt{\rho}$ ; it is not precipitation, quench, or solid-solution hardening.
- \*\*\* SAE 4340 has much higher **hardenability** than 1040 because its Ni–Cr–Mo alloying shifts the transformation (C) curves to the right, lowering the critical cooling rate. Even the center of a large section then cools faster than the critical rate and forms martensite. The Jominy end-quench test shows 4340 holding high hardness to large distance (deep), whereas 1040's hardness drops sharply a few mm from the quenched end.

## Answers — Chapter 11

- ★ **b. 6**. Radius ratio 0.45 lies in the 0.414–0.732 band, predicting octahedral coordination (CN = 6), e.g. rock-salt structure.
- ★ **b. An amorphous (glassy) ceramic**. Soda-lime glass is non-crystalline; "ceramic" means inorganic and nonmetallic, which includes glass, not only crystals.

★★ **B. Pre-existing flaws that concentrate stress.** Ceramics cannot yield to relax stress, so a sharp flaw raises the local stress by  $\sim 2\sqrt{a/\rho}$  and triggers brittle crack growth; this flaw sensitivity, not bonding or modulus, governs the low tensile strength.

★★ **B. 2.** Griffith:  $\sigma_f \propto 1/\sqrt{a}$ . Reducing  $a$  from 100  $\mu\text{m}$  to 25  $\mu\text{m}$  is a  $4\times$  smaller flaw, so strength rises by  $\sqrt{4} = 2\times$ .

★★★ 3-point flexural strength:

$$\sigma_{fs} = \frac{3FL}{2bd^2} = \frac{3(200)(40 \times 10^{-3})}{2(4 \times 10^{-3})(3 \times 10^{-3})^2} = \frac{24}{7.2 \times 10^{-8}} \approx \mathbf{3.33 \times 10^8 \text{ Pa} = 333 \text{ MPa}}.$$

★★★ **Schottky defect:** a paired cation vacancy + anion vacancy removed from the lattice; it stays charge-neutral (equal  $\pm$  removed) and stoichiometric, and lowers density (mass leaves, volume roughly same). **Frenkel defect:** a vacancy plus an interstitial of the *same* ion (ion relocated into a gap); also neutral and stoichiometric, with density essentially unchanged. Both preserve electroneutrality and composition because the vacancy/interstitial charges balance.